

IDIOMS

Direction :- [Q .1. to Q .762.] Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiom/phrase given in **Bold/Underline** in the following Questions.

Examination wise Questions

SSC CGL 2025 Tier - I

Q.1. Bite the bullet

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To give up easily
- (b) To avoid a difficult situation
- (c) To face a difficult or unpleasant situation with courage
- (d) To make a quick decision without thinking

Q.2. Bend over backwards

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To perform a difficult physical feat
- (b) To exert oneself greatly to help someone or achieve something
- (c) To avoid responsibility
- (d) To show extreme flexibility

Q.3. To carry coals to Newcastle

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To perform a necessary task
- (b) To do something pointless or superfluous
- (c) To transport goods efficiently
- (d) To engage in a difficult but rewarding endeavor

Q.4. To throw in the towel

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To clean up a mess
- (b) To admit defeat
- (c) To start a fight
- (d) To give a gift

Q.5. To have an ace up one's sleeve

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To be secretly dishonest in a game.
- (b) To possess a hidden advantage or secret resource.
- (c) To be overly confident in one's abilities.
- (d) To wear a lucky charm during a competition.

Q.6. Lose one's nerve

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To become angry suddenly.
- (b) To lose confidence and courage.
- (c) To suffer a physical injury to a nerve.
- (d) To relax after a period of stress

Q.7. Beat around the bush

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To speak directly about something
- (b) To avoid talking about the main point

(c) To damage something carelessly

(d) To take unnecessary risks

Q.8. TO PAY THROUGH THE NOSE

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To pay a very low price
- (b) To negotiate a good deal
- (c) To pay an excessively high price
- (d) To pay in installments

Q.9. To carry the can

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To transport goods efficiently
- (b) To take responsibility for a mistake or failure
- (c) To finish a difficult task
- (d) To make a quick decision

Q.10. Throw down the gauntlet

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To refuse a challenge
- (b) To accept defeat
- (c) To issue a challenge or dare someone
- (d) To surrender gracefully

Q.11. Ride roughshod over

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To act with total disregard for others' feelings or rights
- (b) To overcome a difficult situation with patience
- (c) To follow rules and traditions strictly
- (d) To handle a matter with extreme caution

Q.12. Ride for a fall

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To take unnecessary risks likely to end in failure
- (b) To recover quickly after a setback
- (c) To depend on someone unreliable
- (d) To move ahead with full confidence

Q.13. To upset the applecart

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To knock over a fruit stand
- (b) To spoil a plan or disturb a situation
- (c) To organise things neatly
- (d) To make a pleasant surprise

Q.14. Cry over spilt milk

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To regret something that cannot be undone
- (b) To celebrate an old memory
- (c) To waste time waiting for something
- (d) To complain without reason

Q.15. To send someone to Coventry

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To dispatch someone on an important mission
- (b) To ostracise or deliberately ignore someone
- (c) To send someone to a historical city for education

(d) To give someone a difficult task

Q.16. To dine with Duke Humphrey

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To eat a lavish meal with a wealthy person
- (b) To go without food
- (c) To attend a formal banquet
- (d) To share a meal in good company

Q.17. Cut the Gordian knot

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Face an impossible situation
- (b) Solve a difficult problem boldly
- (c) Avoid taking decisions
- (d) Create confusion

Q.18. To tilt at windmills

SSC CGL 17/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To fight imaginary enemies
- (b) To oppose one's benefactors
- (c) To win by deceit
- (d) To exploit an opportunity cleverly

Q.19. To tilt at windmills

SSC CGL 17/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To challenge powerful institutions
- (b) To engage in a pointless or quixotic struggle
- (c) To embrace impossible dreams
- (d) To cleverly overcome obstacles

Q.20. To throw one's hat into the ring

SSC CGL 17/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To surrender in a contest
- (b) To enter a competition or election
- (c) To withdraw support
- (d) To show disinterest

Q.21. To turn over a new leaf

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To read a new book
- (b) To plant something new
- (c) To change the appearance of something
- (d) To start afresh

Q.22. To look daggers at someone

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To admire someone secretly
- (b) To playfully tease someone
- (c) To stare at someone with anger or hatred
- (d) To examine something very closely

Q.23. To send someone to Coventry

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To send someone on a difficult mission
- (b) To ostracize someone
- (c) To give someone a formal warning
- (d) To dismiss someone from their Position

Q.24. Achilles' heel

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) A strong point or advantage
- (b) A minor injury to the foot
- (c) A hidden weakness or vulnerability
- (d) A point of no return

Q.25. Eat humble pie

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To refuse to admit a mistake
- (b) To be forced to admit one's error and apologize humbly
- (c) To eat a plain and simple meal
- (d) To show false modesty

Q.26. To run with the hare and hunt with the hounds

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To be friendly with both sides in a conflict
- (b) To stay neutral in all situations
- (c) To act rashly without thinking
- (d) To support the weaker side

Q.27. Through thick and thin

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To navigate difficult terrain
- (b) To be loyal and supportive in all circumstances
- (c) To experience varying fortunes in life
- (d) To alternate between periods of success and failure

Q.28. To give the go-by

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To ignore or avoid someone or something deliberately
- (b) To approve without hesitation
- (c) To pass an examination easily
- (d) To support someone secretly

Q.29. To have cold feet

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To feel physically cold
- (b) To be apprehensive or nervous about doing something
- (c) To refuse to compromise
- (d) To run away from danger

Q.30. A nine days' wonder

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) A profound discovery that changes the world.
- (b) A lengthy and detailed project that takes a long time to complete.
- (c) Something that causes intense excitement or interest for a very short period.
- (d) A spectacular event that happens once every nine years.

Q.31. Call the shots

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To be in control and make important decisions
- (b) To act carelessly without planning
- (c) To criticize someone openly
- (d) To ignore authority

Q.32. Make no bones about

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To speak frankly and without hesitation
- (b) To hide one's true feelings
- (c) To argue over small matters
- (d) To regret one's decisions

Q.33. Get on like a house on fire

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To start an argument suddenly
- (b) To become very friendly very quickly
- (c) To destroy a relationship through anger
- (d) To avoid social interactions

Q.34. Doing sterling work

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Performing ordinary duties with reluctance
- (b) Doing outstanding and valuable work
- (c) Completing a task hurriedly and carelessly
- (d) Working only for monetary gain

Q.35. To tuck one's tail

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To hide something valuable
- (b) To retreat in fear or shame
- (c) To prepare for a journey
- (d) To show defiance

Q.36. To have an axe to grind

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To have a tool for cutting wood
- (b) To be particularly skilled at something
- (c) To have a selfish motive
- (d) To prepare for a difficult task

Q.37. At sixes and sevens

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) In a state of confusion or disorder
- (b) Perfectly planned and arranged
- (c) Extremely cautious
- (d) Proud and arrogant

Q.38. Mad as a March hare

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Extremely busy or hard-working
- (b) Completely insane or unpredictable
- (c) Very shy and quiet
- (d) Excited but disciplined

Q.39. To take up the gauntlet

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To decline an invitation
- (b) To ignore an insult
- (c) To accept a challenge or invitation to fight
- (d) To pick up a dropped item carefully

Q.40. To have a chip on one's shoulder

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To remain calm despite provocation
- (b) To avoid confrontation by staying

silent

- (c) To show excessive pride in one's achievements
- (d) To feel angry or resentful about something that happened in the past

Q.41. Throw one's weight about

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To act arrogantly or bossily
- (b) To lose control
- (c) To show weakness
- (d) To work efficiently

Q.42. Cut the mustard

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Fail to meet expectations
- (b) Behave foolishly
- (c) Take unnecessary risks
- (d) Meet the required standard

Q.43. To skate on thin ice

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To glide smoothly and effortlessly
- (b) To be in a risky or precarious situation
- (c) To perform a graceful dance
- (d) To enjoy a winter sport safely

Q.44. At one's wit's end

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To be extremely clever and resourceful
- (b) To be utterly perplexed and not know what to do next
- (c) To have reached a definitive conclusion
- (d) To be on the verge of solving a complex problem

Q.45. Be the low man on the totem pole

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To hold the least important or lowest position in a group
- (b) To be the most experienced member of a team
- (c) To lead others with humility
- (d) To take responsibility for others' mistakes

Q.46. Take silk

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Become a senior barrister or lawyer
- (b) Wear expensive clothes
- (c) Leave a job suddenly
- (d) Delay an important task

Q.47. Play it by ear

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To play a musical instrument without sheet music
- (b) To listen carefully to a conversation
- (c) To decide how to deal with a situation as it develops, rather than by having a fixed plan
- (d) To ignore advice and do what one wants

Q.48. Come up trumps

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Fail unexpectedly
- (b) Succeed unexpectedly or achieve a desired result
- (c) Take a long time to complete a task
- (d) Avoid responsibility

Q.49. Shun someone

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Avoid or ignore someone deliberately
- (b) Support someone in trouble
- (c) Argue with someone repeatedly
- (d) Follow someone's advice strictly

Q.50. Be the chaperone

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Supervise or accompany young people in social situations
- (b) Interrupt someone's private conversation
- (c) Act as a mediator in a financial dispute
- (d) Avoid taking responsibility

Q.51. Beat a dead horse

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To revive a lost cause
- (b) To flog an animal for no reason
- (c) To dwell on a topic that is already resolved or futile
- (d) To invest time in a failing project

Q.52. In the dark

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Unable to see physically
- (b) Feeling sad or depressed
- (c) Unaware of the true facts or details about something
- (d) Hiding from everyone

Q.53. To open a Pandora's Box

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To unleash a multitude of troubles
- (b) To solve a long-standing mystery
- (c) To reveal a pleasant surprise
- (d) To discover ancient secrets

Q.54. A storm is brewing

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) A literal thunderstorm is approaching
- (b) Trouble or conflict is likely to happen soon
- (c) Someone is preparing a surprise party
- (d) Calm and peace is prevailing

Q.55 To bite the hand that feeds you

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To show ingratitude towards a benefactor
- (b) To harm someone physically
- (c) To refuse help when offered
- (d) To struggle against oppression

Q.56. Out of one's depth

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To be swimming in deep water

- (b) To be feeling overwhelmed by emotions
- (c) To be in a situation too difficult for one's abilities
- (d) To lose consciousness

Q.57. To throw dust in one's eyes

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To clean someone's eyes with dust
- (b) To ignore someone's presence
- (c) To confuse or mislead someone deliberately
- (d) To cause minor irritation

Q.58. Break the bank

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Spend all one's money
- (b) Win a lottery
- (c) Save a lot of money
- (d) Borrow from a bank

Q.59. Lay it on the line

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To relax completely
- (b) To play a game carefully
- (c) To speak frankly and honestly
- (d) To hide the truth

Q.60. Throw caution to the wind.

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To destroy evidence of a past crime
- (b) to do something without worrying about the risk or negative results
- (c) To make a dramatic entrance
- (d) To sever all connections with friends

Q.61. What does the phrase "go back to square one" mean ?

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To start over after a failure
- (b) To complete a task successfully
- (c) To take a short break from work
- (d) To finalize a project

Q.62. In the nick of time

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Too early
- (b) A little late
- (c) Just before it was too late
- (d) Without any preparation

Q.63. To come clean

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To tidy up a messy place
- (b) To take a bath
- (c) To emerge from a difficult situation unscathed
- (d) To confess something, especially something wrong

Q.64. To blow hot and cold

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To experience extreme temperature changes
- (b) to keep changing one's attitude or opinion.

- (c) To argue passionately for both sides of an issue
- (d) To have a fluctuating fever

Q.65. To step up to the plate

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To offer someone food
- (b) to take responsibility and perform well when needed.
- (c) To serve food to guests
- (d) To begin a new game

Q.66. What does the idiom "He is under the weather today and won't attend the meeting" mean ?

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) He is feeling unwell.
- (b) He is frustrated with the weather.
- (c) He is extremely happy.
- (d) He is traveling to another city.

Q.67. Cut to the chase

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Avoid unnecessary details and get to the point
- (b) Delay a discussion
- (c) Overcomplicate a story
- (d) Speak vaguely

Q.68. Through thick and thin

SSC CGL 14/10/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To navigate difficult terrain
- (b) To be loyal and supportive in all circumstances
- (c) To experience varying fortunes in life
- (d) To alternate between periods of success and failure

Q.69. Cut from the same cloth

SSC CGL 14/10/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To wear identical outfits.
- (b) of the same nature
- (c) To share a common ancestry.
- (d) To work in the same profession.

Q.70. To blackball someone

SSC CGL 14/10/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To play a game of pool with them
- (b) To give someone a special, prestigious award
- (c) To accuse someone falsely of a crime
- (d) To exclude someone from a group or society, often by secret vote

Q.71. Achilles' heel

SSC CGL 14/10/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) A strong point or advantage
- (b) A minor injury to the foot
- (c) A hidden weakness or vulnerability
- (d) A point of no return

Solutions :-

Sol.1.(c) Bite the bullet - to face a difficult or unpleasant situation with courage.

E.g.- I had to bite the bullet and work extra hours to meet the deadline.

Sol.2.(b) Bend over backwards - to exert oneself greatly to help someone or achieve something.

E.g.- The company bent over backwards to ensure customer satisfaction after the complaint.

Sol.3.(b) To carry coals to Newcastle - to do something pointless or superfluous.

E.g. Asking me to bring extra pens to the stationery shop would be like carrying coals to Newcastle.

Sol.4.(b) To throw in the towel- to admit defeat.

E.g.- After fighting bravely for ten rounds, the boxer decided to throw in the towel.

Sol.5.(b) To have an ace up one's sleeve- to possess a hidden advantage or secret resource.

E.g.- The CEO seemed calm despite the crisis, everyone knew she had an ace up her sleeve.

Sol.6.(b) Lose one's nerve - to lose confidence and courage.

E.g.- He was about to confront them but lost his nerve at the last moment.

Sol.7.(b) Beat around the bush - to avoid talking about the main point

E.g. Stop beating around the bush and just tell me what you want to say.

Sol.8.(c) To pay through the nose - to pay an excessively high price.

E.g. We had to pay through the nose for tickets to the concert because we bought them at the last minute from a reseller.

Sol.9.(b) To carry the can - to take responsibility for a mistake or failure.

E.g.- After the project failed, the team leader had to carry the can, even though it wasn't entirely his fault.

Sol.10.(c) Throw down the gauntlet - to issue a challenge or dare someone.

E.g. - The senator threw down the gauntlet by daring his opponents to a public debate.

Sol.11.(a) Ride roughshod over - to act with total disregard for others' feelings or rights.

E.g. - The new manager rode roughshod over his team's suggestions and implemented his own plans without discussion.

Sol.12.(a) Ride for a fall - to take unnecessary risks likely to end in failure.

E.g. - If he keeps investing without proper research, he's riding for a fall.

Sol.13.(b) To upset the applecart- to spoil a plan or disturb a situation./

E.g.- Everything was going smoothly until his sudden resignation upset the applecart for the entire project.

Sol.14.(a) Cry over spilt milk - to regret something that cannot be undone.

E.g. - There's no use crying over spilt milk; you should learn from your mistakes and move on.

Sol.15.(b) To send someone to Coventry - to ostracise or deliberately ignore someone.

E.g.- After his controversial remarks, his colleagues effectively sent him to Coventry, refusing to engage with him.

Sol.16.(b) To dine with Duke Humphrey - to go without food.

E.g.- After losing his job, he often found himself dining with Duke Humphrey.

Sol.17.(b) Cut the Gordian knot - solve a difficult problem boldly

E.g. - Faced with months of deadlock, the new CEO cut the Gordian knot by merging the two departments overnight.

Sol.18.(a) To tilt at windmills - to fight imaginary enemies

E.g.- Some activists waste their energy tilting at windmills instead of taking practical steps.

Sol.19.(b) To tilt at windmills- to engage in a pointless or quixotic struggle.

E.g.- Arguing with him about that topic is like tilting at windmills. He'll never change his mind.

Sol.20.(b) To throw one's hat into the ring - to enter a competition or election.

E.g.- After much encouragement from her peers, she decided to throw her hat into the ring for the school board election.

Sol.21.(d) To turn over a new leaf- to start afresh.

E.g.- After his mistakes, he promised to turn over a new leaf and be more responsible.

Sol.22.(c) To look daggers at someone- to stare at someone with anger or hatred.

E.g.- When she questioned his authority, he looked daggers at her across the table.

Sol.23.(b) To send someone to Coventry - to ostracize someone.

E.g.- After he broke their secret, his classmates sent him to Coventry for the rest of the semester.

Sol.24.(c) Achilles heel - a hidden weakness or vulnerability.

E.g.- His arrogance proved to be his Achilles' heel, leading to his downfall.

Sol.25.(b) Eat humble pie - to be forced to admit one's error and apologize humbly.

E.g.- After boasting about his infallible memory, he had to eat humble pie when he forgot his own anniversary.

Sol.26.(a) To run with the hare and hunt with the hounds - to be friendly with both sides in a conflict.

E.g.- The politician was accused of running with the hare and hunting with the hounds by praising both the government and the opposition.

Sol.27.(b) Through thick and thin - to be loyal and supportive in all circumstances.

E.g.- True friends stick together through thick and thin.

Sol.28.(a) To give the go-by - to ignore or avoid someone or something deliberately

E.g.- After their argument, she decided to give him the go-by and stopped talking to him altogether.

Sol.29.(b) To have cold feet- to be apprehensive or nervous about doing something.

E.g.- He was excited about the solo trip, but started to have cold feet as the departure date approached.

Sol.30.(c) A nine days' wonder- something that causes intense excitement or interest for a very short period.

E.g.- The viral video became a nine days' wonder; everyone talked about it for a week and then moved on.

Sol.31.(a) Call the shots - to be in control and make important decisions.

E.g.- In this company, it's the managing director who really calls the shots.

Sol.32.(a) Make no bones about - to speak frankly and without hesitation.

E.g.- Richa made no bones about her dislike for the new policy during the meeting.

Sol.33.(b) Get on like a house on fire - to become very friendly very quickly

E.g.- We were both lonely and started going out for meals, getting on like a house on fire

Sol.34.(b) Doing sterling work - doing outstanding and valuable work

E.g.- I would like to congratulate the entire team on their sterling work in

completing the project ahead of schedule.

Sol.35.(b) To tuck one's tail - to retreat in fear or shame.

E.g.- After the loud scolding, the disobedient child tucked his tail and went to his room.

Sol.36.(c) To have an axe to grind- to have a selfish motive.

E.g.- He's always pushing that idea; I suspect he has an axe to grind with the current management.

Sol.37.(a) At sixes and sevens - in a state of confusion or disorder.

E.g.- After the unexpected resignation of the manager, the whole department was at sixes and sevens.

Sol.38.(b) Mad as a March hare - completely insane or unpredictable.

E.g.- He was acting mad as a March hare during the festival, jumping and running around for no apparent reason.

Sol.39.(c) To take up the gauntlet - to accept a challenge or invitation to fight.

E.g.- When his rival made a public accusation, the politician decided to take up the gauntlet and respond directly in a televised debate.

Sol.40.(d) To have a chip on one's shoulder - to feel angry or resentful about something that happened in the past.

E.g.- Even years after losing the competition, he still has a chip on his shoulder whenever the topic is mentioned.

Sol.41.(a) Throw one's weight about - to act arrogantly or bossily.

E.g.- After becoming the team leader, he started throwing his weight about and ordering everyone around.

Sol.42.(d) Cut the mustard - meet the required standard.

E.g.- The new employee really cut the mustard by completing the project ahead of schedule.

Sol.43.(b) To skate on thin ice- to be in a risky or precarious situation.

E.g.- After arguing with the boss, he knew he was skating on thin ice with the management.

Sol.44.(b) At one's wit's end- to be utterly perplexed and not know what to do next.

E.g.- After trying every possible solution, she was at her wit's end with the stubborn computer error.

Sol.45.(a) Be the low man on the totem pole - to hold the least important or lowest position in a group.

E.g.- As a new employee, I know I'm the low man on the totem pole, so I just do what I'm told.

Sol.46.(a) Take silk - become a senior barrister or lawyer.

E.g.- After twenty years of practice, she finally took silk, earning the prestigious title of Queen's Counsel.

Sol.47.(c) Play it by ear- to decide how to deal with a situation as it develops, rather than by having a fixed plan.

E.g.- We don't have a set agenda for the meeting, so we'll just play it by ear and discuss topics as they come up.

Sol.48.(b) Come up trumps - succeed unexpectedly or achieve a desired result

E.g.- After struggling with the project for weeks, Riya really came up trumps by finishing it ahead of schedule and impressing her manager.

Sol.49.(a) Shun someone - avoid or ignore someone deliberately.

E.g.- After the scandal, most of his colleagues began to shun him at work.

Sol.50.(a) Be the chaperone - supervise or accompany young people in social situations.

E.g.- During the school trip, Naziya was assigned to be the chaperone for the students visiting the museum.

Sol.51.(c) Beat a dead horse - to dwell on a topic that is already resolved or futile.

E.g.- We've discussed this issue for hours. I think we're just beating a dead horse now.

Sol.52.(c) In the dark- unaware of the true facts or details about something.

E.g.- The employees were kept in the dark about the company's merger until the last minute.

Sol.53.(a) To open a Pandora's box - to unleash a multitude of troubles.

E.g.- The new regulations were meant to help, but they truly opened a Pandora's Box of complications for small businesses.

Sol.54.(b) A storm is brewing - trouble or conflict is likely to happen soon.

E.g.- The meeting between the two rival managers was tense; it seemed a storm was brewing over the upcoming project.

Sol.55.(a) To bite the hand that feeds

you - to show ingratitude towards a benefactor.

E.g.- After all the support they gave him, he bit the hand that fed him by spreading rumours about them.

Sol.56.(c) Out of one's depth - to be in a situation too difficult for one's abilities.

E.g.- When the conversation turned to quantum physics, I quickly realised I was out of my depth.

Sol.57.(c) To throw dust in someone's eyes - to confuse or mislead someone deliberately.

E.g.- The politician tried to throw dust in the public's eyes by changing the subject.

Sol.58.(a) Break the bank - Spend all one's money.

E.g.- She wanted to host a grand party but didn't want to break the bank.

Sol.59.(c) Lay it on the line - to speak frankly and honestly

E.g.- The manager laid it on the line about the team's poor performance in the last quarter.

Sol.60.(b) Throw caution to the wind - to do something without worrying about the risk or negative results.

E.g.- Despite the risks involved, she decided to throw caution to the wind and quit her stable job to travel the world.

Sol.61.(a) go back to square one - to start over after a failure.

E.g.- After the prototype failed all the safety tests, the engineers had to go back to square one and redesign the entire machine.

Sol.62.(c) In the nick of time - just before it was too late

E.g.- The ambulance arrived in the nick of time and saved the patient's life.

Sol.63.(d) To come clean - to confess something, especially something wrong.

E.g.- After weeks of hiding it, he finally decided to come clean about breaking the vase.

Sol.64.(b) Blow hot and cold - to keep changing one's attitude or opinion.

E.g.- His opinion on the project always blew hot and cold, making it difficult to get a clear decision.

Sol.65.(b) Step up to the plate - to take responsibility and perform well when needed.

E.g.- When the lead coordinator fell ill unexpectedly, she stepped up to the plate and handled the entire event with remarkable efficiency.

Sol.66.(a) Under the weather - feeling unwell/Sick.

Sol.67.(a) Cut to the chase - avoid unnecessary details and get to the point
E.g.- During the meeting, the manager asked everyone to cut to the chase and present their key findings without lengthy introductions.

Sol.68.(b) Through thick and thin - to be loyal and supportive in all circumstances.
E.g.- True friends stick together through thick and thin.

Sol.69.(b) Cut from the same cloth - of the same nature
E.g.- Both brothers are cut from the same cloth, especially in the way they approach challenges calmly.

Sol.70.(d) To blackball someone - to exclude someone from a group or society, often by secret vote.
E.g.- Despite his qualifications, he was blackballed from the exclusive club due to a past disagreement.

Sol.71.(c) Achilles heel- a hidden weakness or vulnerability.
E.g.- His arrogance proved to be his Achilles' heel, leading to his downfall.

SSC Selection Post (Phase - XIII)

Q.72. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"To be wide of the mark"
Matriculation Level 24/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To be very accurate
(b) To draw a large circle
(c) To be inaccurate, incorrect, or mistaken
(d) To have a broad perspective

Q.73. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Give someone the boot"
Matriculation Level 24/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To insult someone
(b) To shift someone to another place
(c) To admire someone
(d) To dismiss someone from a job

Q.74. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Point the finger at someone"
Matriculation Level 25/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To praise someone
(b) To blame someone
(c) To help someone
(d) To ignore a mistake

Q.75. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Ten a penny"

Matriculation Level 25/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) not valuable, and easily found.
(b) Scarce
(c) Worth a lot
(d) Difficult to obtain

Q.76. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"The major chunk"
Matriculation Level 26/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) A minor part
(b) An equal division
(c) A random piece
(d) A substantial portion.

Q.77. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Swim against the tide"
Matriculation Level 26/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To follow everyone else
(b) To oppose the usual trend
(c) To fail repeatedly
(d) To avoid a difficult task

Q.78. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Cost an arm and a leg"
Matriculation Level 28/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To be very cheap
(b) To cost a huge amount of money
(c) To lose savings in a robbery
(d) To spend wisely

Q.79. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Go through the mill"
Matriculation Level 28/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To enjoy a relaxing process
(b) To be praised for hard work
(c) To suffer hardships or difficulties
(d) To avoid responsibilities

Q.80. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Keep in line"
Matriculation Level 29/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To obey instructions
(b) To break the rules
(c) To compete with others
(d) To move in a straight row

Q.81. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Let someone off lightly"
Matriculation Level 29/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To punish severely
(b) To give a mild or easy punishment
(c) To ignore completely
(d) To reward someone

Q.82. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Eat one's words"
Matriculation Level 30/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To speak proudly

(b) To repeat something loudly
(c) To take back what was said / realise one was wrong
(d) To refuse to apologise

Q.83. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Lay one's cards on the table"
Matriculation Level 30/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To hide true feelings
(b) To avoid discussing emotions
(c) To confuse someone
(d) To express feelings or intentions openly

Q.84. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:
"To squeeze water from a rock"
Matriculation Level 31/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) To complete work quickly
(b) To attempt the impossible
(c) To waste time
(d) To search for rare things

Q.85. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Sharing the same plight"
Matriculation Level 31/07/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) suffering the same difficulty
(b) Competing for a trophy
(c) Playing sports together
(d) Working in different areas

Q.86. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Smell something fishy"
Matriculation Level 01/08/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) Something very tasty
(b) Something suspicious
(c) Something very old
(d) Something dangerous

Q.87. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:
"Stretch your legs according to the blanket."
Matriculation Level 01/08/2025 (Shift - 1)
(a) Do exercise regularly
(b) Buy expensive items
(c) spend within your limits
(d) Avoid saving money

Q.88. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:
"Don't open old wounds":
Matriculation Level 01/08/2025 (Shift - 2)
(a) To apply medicine to injuries
(b) To bring up painful past issues
(c) To discuss historical events openly
(d) To heal quickly from physical harm

Q.89. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:
"Leave someone high and dry"
Matriculation Level 01/08/2025 (Shift - 2)
(a) To help someone when needed

- (b) To leave someone without support in a difficult situation
 (c) To confuse someone on purpose
 (d) To give someone wrong advice

Q.90. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"On pins and needles"

Matriculation Level 01/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) Feeling completely safe
 (b) Waiting anxiously or in suspense
 (c) Enjoying a peaceful moment
 (d) Feeling sleepy

Q.91. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:

"Turn a deaf ear"

Matriculation Level 01/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) To listen carefully
 (b) To advise someone politely
 (c) To ignore or pay no attention
 (d) To respond immediately

Q.92. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:

"Pour cold water on an idea"

Matriculation Level 02/08/2025 (Shift - 1)

- (a) To strongly support an idea
 (b) To discourage or show disapproval
 (c) To think deeply about an idea
 (d) To make an idea more interesting

Q.93. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:

"Lead someone up the garden path"

Matriculation Level 02/08/2025 (Shift - 1)

- (a) To guide someone safely
 (b) To show someone a shortcut
 (c) To teach someone politely
 (d) To mislead someone

Q.94. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:

"Face the music"

Matriculation Level 02/08/2025 (Shift - 1)

- (a) To accept an unpleasant reality or consequences
 (b) To enjoy a performance
 (c) To learn to play an instrument
 (d) To celebrate a victory

Q.95. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom highlighted in bold.

To secure the scholarship, Ananya **strained every nerve** to score the highest marks in her final exams.

Matriculation Level 29/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) Ananya tried to avoid studying
 (b) Ananya try as hard as possible
 (c) Ananya relaxed throughout the exam period
 (d) Ananya became too nervous to study

Q.96. Rohan: You didn't come to help me shift my luggage.

Sanjay: I'm really sorry, Rohan. I didn't mean to **wash my hands of the matter**. A family emergency came up.

What does Sanjay mean?

Matriculation Level 29/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) He didn't want to withdraw his help in a difficult situation.
 (b) He wanted to avoid Rohan intentionally.
 (c) He forgot the plan completely.
 (d) He didn't want to carry any luggage.

Q.97. What does the idiom "call someone's bluff" mean?

Higher Secondary 24/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To support someone's claim
 (b) To praise someone for honesty
 (c) To ignore someone's warning
 (d) To challenge someone to prove their claim

Q.98. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom "**To dig one's own grave**".

Higher Secondary 24/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To help others succeed
 (b) To cause trouble for oneself by one's own actions
 (c) To escape from a bad situation
 (d) To plan a big achievement

Q.99. What does the idiom "Hit the wrong nail" mean?

Higher Secondary 25/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To accuse or target the wrong person
 (b) To find the perfect answer
 (c) To avoid taking action
 (d) To take a correct decision

Q.100. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"A pain in the neck"

Higher Secondary 26/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) A helpful companion
 (b) A serious threat
 (c) Someone or something very irritating
 (d) Something easy to handle

Q.101. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Beat one's head against a brick wall"

Higher Secondary 26/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Try hard and succeed
 (b) Waste effort on something impossible
 (c) Complain without reason
 (d) Work silently and patiently

Q.102. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Go to the ends of the earth"

Higher Secondary 28/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Travel for enjoyment
 (b) Do anything, no matter how difficult
 (c) Avoid challenges
 (d) Wait for the right moment

Q.103. Choose the correct meaning of the given idiom/phrase from the options:

"Be in hot water"

Higher Secondary 28/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To relax in warm water
 (b) To be in trouble or difficulty
 (c) To act very bravely
 (d) To become very famous

Q.104. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Off and on"

Higher Secondary 29/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Continuously without stopping
 (b) Irregularly, from time to time
 (c) Very quickly
 (d) For a long duration

Q.105. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom highlighted in bold.

When the project faced unexpected problems, Rohan suddenly quit the team and left his colleagues **in the lurch**.

Higher Secondary 29/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Helped them complete the project
 (b) Abandoned them at a difficult time
 (c) Surprised them with a new idea
 (d) Took responsibility for their mistakes

Q.106. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom: "Go berserk"

Higher Secondary 30/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Act calmly
 (b) Behave in a wild or uncontrolled manner
 (c) Sit quietly
 (d) Follow strict rules

Q.107. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Sit back on one's achievements"

Higher Secondary 30/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To work harder for new goals
 (b) To stop trying because of past success
 (c) To celebrate others' success
 (d) To plan for future challenges

Q.108. Choose the correct meaning for the idiom highlighted in bold.

When eco-friendly products became widespread, several companies decided to **go with the flow** and introduce green packaging.

Higher Secondary 31/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To resist popular trends
 (b) To follow what most people are doing
 (c) To move water through a pipe
 (d) To reduce production speed

Q.109. Choose the correct phrase for the word highlighted in bold.

The construction outside was so loud that Riya felt she needed **peace and quiet** to finish her assignment.

Higher Secondary 31/07/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) A noisy environment
 (b) A calm and silent atmosphere



- (c) A crowded workplace
(d) A brightly lit room

Q.110. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Build castles in the air"

Higher Secondary 02/08/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To make strong buildings
(b) To daydream or imagine impossible things
(c) To study very hard
(d) To plan carefully

Q.111. Choose the correct idiom for the word highlighted in bold.

After years of practising in the courtroom, Advocate Mehta has become **a dab hand** at presenting complex arguments.

Higher Secondary 02/08/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) A person who speaks too much
(b) A person who is very skillful at something
(c) A person who dislikes arguments
(d) A person who avoids hard work

Q.112. Choose the correct idiom for the word highlighted in bold.

On Sundays, my brother becomes **as lazy as a toad**, refusing to do even the smallest chores.

Higher Secondary 29/08/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Someone who likes playing outside
(b) Someone extremely lazy
(c) Someone who jumps a lot
(d) Someone who eats very fast

Q.113. Choose the correct idiom for the word highlighted in bold.

When the company discovered that Mahesh had leaked confidential data, he suddenly realized he was **in hot water** with the management.

Higher Secondary 29/08/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) Mahesh was feeling physically hot.
(b) Mahesh was in serious trouble.
(c) Mahesh was preparing tea for everyone.
(d) Mahesh was fixing a water heater.

Q.114. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Take the bull by the horns"

Higher Secondary 29/08/2025 (Shift - 2)

- (a) To avoid a difficult situation
(b) To confront a difficult or dangerous situation boldly
(c) To wait for the right moment
(d) To follow someone silently

Q.115. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"Pick up the gauntlet"

Graduate Level 24/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) To accept a challenge bravely

- (b) To avoid confrontation
(c) To surrender without trying
(d) To apologize politely

Q.116. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom given below:

"Get the drop on someone"

Graduate Level 25/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) To lose advantage suddenly
(b) To gain an unexpected or secret advantage over someone
(c) To copy someone's actions
(d) To refuse to compete

Q.117. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom given below:

"Pull a fast one"

Graduate Level 26/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) Gain an advantage through a clever or secret trick
(b) Move ahead quickly
(c) Work faster than usual
(d) Give someone a surprise gift

Q.118. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom given below:

"Fall into one's own trap"

Graduate Level 28/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) Outsmart someone cleverly
(b) Become a victim of one's own plot
(c) Escape without punishment
(d) Trick someone successfully

Q.119. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom given below:

"Call in the debt"

Graduate Level 29/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) To forgive someone completely
(b) To demand repayment strictly
(c) To donate money generously
(d) To delay payment intentionally

Q.120. Choose the correct meaning of idiom given below:

"Enter the fray"

Graduate Level 31/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) To withdraw from a contest
(b) To join a competition or conflict
(c) To support a competitor
(d) To avoid public attention

Q.121. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom given below:

"Keep an ear to the ground"

Graduate Level 02/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

- (a) To lie down on the ground
(b) To stay alert to new trends or developments
(c) To avoid listening to others
(d) To act without thinking

Q.122. What does the idiom "Fall into one's own trap/snare" mean?

Graduate Level 29/08/2025 (Shift - 1)

- (a) Escape danger cleverly

- (b) Succeed through hard work
(c) Be harmed by one's own plan
(d) Trick someone successfully

Q.123. Read the sentence below and choose the meaning of the idiom that best fits the context:

"After a long day at the office, Rohan said, 'I'm exhausted. I think it's time to hit the hay.'"

Graduate Level 29/08/2025 (Shift - 1)

- (a) Start working again
(b) Go to sleep
(c) Clean the room
(d) Go out for dinner

Solutions :-

Sol.72.(c) To be wide of the mark- to be inaccurate, incorrect, or mistaken.

E.g- His predictions for the election results were wide of the mark.

Sol.73.(d) Give someone the boot - To dismiss someone from a job.

E.g- After coming late every day, the manager finally gave him the boot.

Sol.74.(b) Point the finger at someone - To blame someone.

E.g- Everyone pointed the finger at Rohan for breaking the vase, but he was innocent.

Sol.75.(a) Ten a penny - not valuable, and easily found.

E.g- Motivational speakers are ten a penny on Instagram, but very few actually give good advice.

Sol.76.(d) The major chunk - a substantial portion.

E.g- The major chunk of his salary goes into paying rent.

Sol.77.(b) Swim against the tide - To oppose the usual trend.

E.g- By choosing a career in music instead of engineering, he decided to swim against the tide.

Sol.78.(b) Cost an arm and a leg - To cost a huge amount of money.

E.g- That new smartphone costs an arm and a leg, so I decided not to buy it.

Sol.79.(c) Go through the mill - To suffer hardships or difficulties.

E.g- He really went through the mill during his training, but it made him stronger.

Sol.80. (b) Keep in line - To obey instructions.

E.g- Students were warned to keep in line during the school assembly.

Sol.81. (b) Let someone off lightly - To give a mild or easy punishment.

E.g- Even after breaking the rules, the teacher let him off lightly with just a warning.

Sol.82.(c) Eat one's words - To take back what was said / realise one was wrong.

E.g- He had to eat his words when the plan he criticised turned out to be successful.

Sol.83.(d) Lay one's cards on the table - To express feelings or intentions openly.

E.g- During the meeting, she laid her cards on the table and shared her real concerns.

Sol.84.(b) To squeeze water from a rock - To attempt the impossible.

E.g- Convincing him to change his habits is like squeezing water from a rock.

Sol.85.(a) Sharing the same plight - suffering the same difficulty.

E.g- These two singers are in the same league when it comes to talent.

Sol.86.(b) Smell something fishy - to notice something suspicious.

E.g- I smelled something fishy when he gave a different story each time.

Sol.87.(c) Stretch your legs according to the blanket - spend within your limits.

E.g- He wanted to buy a new phone, but he decided to stretch his legs according to the blanket and saved the money instead.

Sol.88.(b) Open old wounds - to bring up painful past issues.

E.g- We've finally moved past that argument, so let's not open old wounds by talking about it again.

Sol.89.(b) Leave someone high and dry - To leave someone without support in a difficult situation.

E.g- When his friends cancelled the plan at the last moment, they left him high and dry.

Sol.90.(b) On pins and needles - Waiting anxiously or in suspense.

E.g- She was on pins and needles waiting for her exam results.

Sol.91.(c) Turn a deaf ear - To ignore or pay no attention.

E.g- He turned a deaf ear to their warnings and later regretted it.

Sol.92. (b) Pour cold water on an idea - To discourage or show disapproval.

E.g- They were excited about the new

project, but the manager poured cold water on the idea by pointing out its flaws.

Sol.93.(d) Lead someone up the garden path - To mislead someone.

E.g- He trusted them, but they led him up the garden path with false promises.

Sol.94.(a) Face the music - To accept an unpleasant reality or consequences.

E.g- He broke the rules, so now he must face the music.

Sol.95.(b) Strain every nerve - try as hard as possible.

Sol.96.(a) Wash one's hands of the matter - to withdraw one's involvement or responsibility in a difficult situation.

Sol.97.(d) Call someone's bluff - To challenge someone to prove their claim.

E.g- He said he could finish the work in one hour, so I called his bluff and asked him to do it.

Sol.98.(b) To dig one's own grave - To cause trouble for oneself by one's own actions.

E.g- By lying to the teacher, he dug his own grave.

Sol.99. (a) Hit the wrong nail - To accuse or target the wrong person.

E.g- By blaming Riya for the mistake, they really hit the wrong nail.

Sol.100.(c) A pain in the neck - Someone or something very irritating.

E.g- The constant noise in the classroom was a real pain in the neck for the teacher.

Sol.101.(b) Beat one's head against a brick wall - Waste effort on something impossible.

E.g- Trying to convince him is like beating your head against a brick wall—he never listens.

Sol.102.(b) Go to the ends of the earth - Do anything, no matter how difficult./

E.g- She would go to the ends of the earth to help her best friend.

Sol.103.(b) Be in hot water - To be in trouble or difficulty.

E.g- He forgot his assignment again and is now in hot water with the teacher.

Sol.104.(b) Off and on - Irregularly, from time to time.

E.g- It has been raining off and on since morning.

Sol.105.(b) In the lurch - to abandon someone at a difficult or critical time.

Sol.106.(b) Go berserk - Behave in a wild or uncontrolled manner.

E.g- The crowd went berserk when the team scored the winning goal.

Sol.107.(b) Sit back on one's achievements - To stop trying because of past success.

E.g- After winning one award, he sat back on his achievements and stopped working hard.

Sol.108.(b) Go with the flow - to follow what most people are doing; to accept things as they happen.

Sol.109.(b) Peace and quiet - a calm and silent atmosphere.

Sol.110.(b) Build castles in the air - To daydream or imagine impossible things.

E.g- He spends all day building castles in the air instead of working.

Sol.111.(b) A dab hand - a person who is very skilled or expert at something.

Sol.112.(b) As lazy as a toad - refers to someone extremely lazy.

Sol.113.(b) In hot water - to be in serious trouble.

Sol.114.(b) Take the bull by the horns - To confront a difficult or dangerous situation boldly.

E.g- She decided to take the bull by the horns and speak to the manager directly.

Sol.115.(a) Pick up the gauntlet - To accept a challenge bravely.

E.g- He picked up the gauntlet and agreed to compete in the debate.

Sol.116.(b) Get the drop on someone - To gain an unexpected or secret advantage over someone.

E.g- The police got the drop on the thieves by arriving earlier than expected.

Sol.117.(a) Pull a fast one - to gain an advantage by tricking or deceiving someone.

E.g- He tried to pull a fast one on the teacher by submitting an old assignment as new.

Sol.118.(b) Fall into one's own trap - Become a victim of one's own plot.

E.g- He planned to fool others but fell into his own trap.

Sol.119.(b) Call in the debt - To demand repayment strictly.

E.g. The bank finally called in the debt after several warnings.

Sol.120.(b) Enter the fray - To join a competition or conflict.

E.g- Several new candidates have entered the fray for the election.

Sol.121. (b) Keep an ear to the ground - To stay alert to new trends or developments.

E.g- Good businessmen always keep an ear to the ground.

Sol.122.(c) Fall into one's own trap/snare - Be harmed by one's own plan.

E.g- He tried to trick others but fell into his own trap.

Sol.123.(b) Hit the hay - to go to sleep.

SSC Stenographer 2025 Tier - 1

Q.124. Choose the correct phrase for the word highlighted in bold.

Let's try to **think outside the box** and come up with a new solution to this problem.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) To consider unconventional and creative solutions.
- (b) To reject all solutions without analysis.
- (c) To solve problems using only existing rules.
- (d) To follow traditional methods strictly.

Q.125. Which of the following sentences correctly uses the idiom "a slip of the tongue" ?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) The chef burned his hand and let out a slip of the tongue.
- (b) Sneha carefully planned her speech to ensure a slip of the tongue.
- (c) Sunita lost her balance while walking and had a slip of the tongue.
- (d) Ravi misspoke during the interview; it was just a slip of the tongue.

Q.126. Choose the correct meaning of idiom "**Cut the Gordian knot**".

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Create unnecessary complications
- (b) Disagree with authority
- (c) Tie unrelated issues together
- (d) Solve a problem boldly

Q.127. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

'Cast pearls before swine'

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Sell things at very high prices
- (b) Share secrets with close friends
- (c) Hide something precious from

everyone

- (d) Give valuable things to undeserving

Q.128. Choose the underlined part of the sentence with an appropriate idiom:

As the president of a major company, Harshith is used to **being the focus of attention**.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) The elephant in the room
- (b) A dime a dozen
- (c) Under the weather
- (d) In the limelight

Q.129. Choose the correct meaning of Idiom "To oil the hinges of silence".

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To bribe someone to remain quiet
- (b) To prevent secrets from being exposed
- (c) To gradually break uncomfortable silence
- (d) To speak diplomatically in tense moments

Q.130. What does the idiom 'Go the extra mile' mean?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Work half-heartedly
- (b) Work harder than expected
- (c) Stay idle
- (d) Leave midway

Q.131. What does the idiom 'Take to task' mean?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Scold
- (b) Congratulate
- (c) Reward
- (d) Praise

Q.132. Choose the correct meaning of Idiom "**Bite the bullet**".

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Endure something painful
- (b) Make a bold plan
- (c) Speak without thinking
- (d) Tell a secret

Q.133. What does the idiom 'Not one's cup of tea' mean?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Impossible task
- (b) Very easy
- (c) Something disliked
- (d) Something enjoyable

Q.134. What does the idiom 'In black and white' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Officially in writing
- (b) In verbal form
- (c) In secret
- (d) Unclear terms

Q.135. What does the idiom 'To have the last laugh' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Succeed eventually
- (b) Fail hopelessly
- (c) Be mocked
- (d) Stay indifferent

Q.136. What does the idiom 'Give someone a cold shoulder' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Treat warmly
- (b) Praise someone
- (c) Ignore someone
- (d) Invite for dinner

Q.137. Choose the correct meaning of idiom:

'Show a clean pair of heels'

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Run away
- (b) Imitate one
- (c) Be precise and careful
- (d) Spread quickly

Q.138. What does the idiom 'To turn over a new leaf' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Start afresh
- (b) Repeat mistakes
- (c) Turn pages
- (d) Stay unchanged

Q.139. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

'Tooth and nail'

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Secretly and silently
- (b) Without any tools
- (c) In a confused state
- (d) With full strength and determination

Q.140. Choose the correct meaning of idiom: '**Face the music**'

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Poor Weather
- (b) Bear consequences
- (c) Earn Money
- (d) Give money

Q.141. What does the idiom 'Face the music' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Run away
- (b) Confront difficulties
- (c) Hide feelings
- (d) Avoid trouble

Q.142. Which of the following sentences correctly uses the idiom "**A picture is worth a thousand words**" ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) I prefer reading detailed descriptions rather than looking at images, even though a picture is worth a thousand words.
- (b) The beautiful photograph captured the tragedy so well that no words were needed—truly, a picture is worth a thousand words.
- (c) Since she couldn't take a picture, she decided to write a long paragraph, as a picture is worth a thousand words.
- (d) He described the entire scene in detail because a picture is worth a thousand words.

Q.143. What does the idiom 'Spill the beans' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Waste food
- (b) Hide a fact
- (c) Reveal a secret
- (d) Lose patience

Q.144. What does the idiom 'Steal someone's thunder' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Mock them
- (b) Take credit for their work
- (c) Help them
- (d) Ignore them

Q.145. What does the idiom 'Turn a deaf ear' mean?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Ignore advice
- (b) Argue
- (c) Listen carefully
- (d) Reply angrily

Q.146. What does the idiom 'Pull someone's leg' mean?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Joke with them
- (b) Praise them
- (c) Annoy them
- (d) Criticize them

Q.147. What is the meaning of the proverb **"Don't count your chickens before they hatch"** ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Hatching eggs is an unpredictable process.
- (b) Don't assume success before it happens.
- (c) Chickens should be counted immediately after hatching.
- (d) Always count your livestock carefully.

Q.148. The phrase **'A white elephant'** refers to:

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Lucky charm
- (b) Valuable item
- (c) Costly burden
- (d) Rare animal

Q.149. What does the idiom 'Cry over spilt milk' mean?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Regret a past loss
- (b) Ignore problems
- (c) Be indifferent
- (d) Work harder

Q.150. What does the idiom 'To leave no stone unturned' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Search thoroughly
- (b) Avoid effort
- (c) Relax completely
- (d) Ignore issues

Q.151. What does the idiom 'on cloud nine' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Lazy
- (b) Extremely happy
- (c) Very angry
- (d) Confused

Q.152. Choose the correct meaning of Idiom **"Flog a dead horse"**.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Beat an opponent unfairly
- (b) Repeat a settled argument
- (c) Chase an impossible goal
- (d) Waste time on a lost cause

Q.153. What does the idiom 'Barking up the wrong tree' mean?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Apologizing
- (b) Praising someone
- (c) Accusing wrongly
- (d) Succeeding quickly

Q.154. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

'Cut no ice'

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Have no effect
- (b) Create trouble
- (c) Be sharp
- (d) Stop something

Q.155. What does the idiom 'To grasp at straws' mean ?

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To win easily
- (b) To try desperate measures
- (c) To show courage
- (d) To make careful decisions

Q.156. What does the idiom 'Throw in the towel' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Boast
- (b) Give up
- (c) Work harder
- (d) Start afresh

Q.157. What does the idiom 'Jump the gun' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Succeed quickly
- (b) Act prematurely
- (c) Wait patiently
- (d) Fire a gun

Q.158. What does the idiom 'To beat a dead horse' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Be overconfident
- (b) Win a competition
- (c) Encourage others
- (d) Waste time on a hopeless issue

Q.159. What does the idiom 'Cry wolf' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Be truthful
- (b) Lie unnecessarily
- (c) Help others
- (d) Raise a false alarm

Q.160. The meaning of the Idiom **'Make a clean breast of'** is to:

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Argue
- (b) Accuse
- (c) Confess
- (d) Whisper

Q.161. The idiom **'Token strike'** implies:

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) No protest
- (b) Warning strike
- (c) Heavy protest
- (d) Silent protest

Q.162. What does the idiom 'Bury the hatchet' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Fight again
- (b) Hide weapons
- (c) Ignore a problem
- (d) Make peace

Q.163. What does the idiom 'Get to the point' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Speak directly
- (b) Interrupt
- (c) Avoid the matter
- (d) Speak indirectly

Q.164. What does the idiom 'Jack up the rates' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Increase prices
- (b) Drop prices
- (c) Stay unchanged
- (d) Sell everything

Q.165. What does the idiom 'Speak your mind' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Express frankly
- (b) Stay silent
- (c) Lie
- (d) Gossip

Q.166. What does the idiom 'Clutching at straws' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Hoping without reason
- (b) Laughing loudly
- (c) Boasting unnecessarily
- (d) Winning easily

Q.167. What does the idiom 'Sit on the fence' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Take a risk
- (b) Remain silent
- (c) Stay neutral
- (d) Join both sides

Q.168. Choose the correct meaning of idiom:

'All at sea'

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Far away
- (b) Excited
- (c) Confused
- (d) Drowning

Q.169. What does the idiom 'To go for a song' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Be expensive
- (b) Be unsold
- (c) Be sold cheaply
- (d) Be sung loudly

Q.170. What does the idiom 'To bell the cat' mean?

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Take a risky initiative
- (b) Feed a pet
- (c) Escape a problem
- (d) Make an easy move

Q.171. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom:

"The gift of the gab"

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Habit of exaggerating stories
- (b) Power to make quick decisions
- (c) Ability to cook well
- (d) Talent for speaking fluently and persuasively

Solutions :-

Sol.124.(a) Think outside the box- to consider unconventional and creative solutions.

Sol.125.(d) Ravi misspoke during the

interview; it was just a slip of the tongue. The idiom 'a slip of the tongue' means something that is said by mistake. The sentence given in option (d) states that Ravi misspoke during the interview, meaning he made a mistake in speech. Hence, option (d) uses the idiom correctly.

Sol.126.(d) Cut the Gordian knot- solve a problem boldly.

E.g.- Instead of prolonging negotiations, the leader cut the Gordian knot by implementing a decisive reform.

Sol.127.(d) Cast pearls before swine- give valuable things to undeserving.

E.g. Offering him sincere advice was like casting pearls before swine, as he never valued or acted on it.

Sol.128.(d) In the limelight- being the focus of attention.

Sol.129.(a) To oil the hinges of silence - To bribe someone to remain quiet

E.g. The company tried to oil the hinges of silence by offering a large settlement to the employee who discovered the financial fraud.

Sol.130.(b) Go the extra mile - Work harder than expected

E.g. The teacher always goes the extra mile to help her students succeed in exams.

Sol.131.(a) Take to task - Scold

E.g. The teacher took the students to task for not completing their homework on time.

Sol.132.(a) Bite the bullet - Endure something painful

E.g. Even though he was terrified of the dentist, he decided to bite the bullet and get his tooth treated.

Sol.133.(c) Something disliked

The idiom "Not one's cup of tea" means something that a person does not like or enjoy.

Sol.134.(a) In black and white- officially in writing.

E.g.- The agreement was put down in black and white to avoid any future disputes.

Sol.135.(a) To have the last laugh - succeed eventually.

E.g.- He was mocked for his ideas at first, but he had the last laugh when his project won the national award.

Sol.136.(c) Give someone a cold shoulder - ignore someone.

E.g.- He felt hurt when his colleagues gave him the cold shoulder at the meeting.

Sol.137.(a) Show a clean pair of heels - run away.

E.g.- The thief showed a clean pair of heels when the police arrived.

Sol.138.(a) To turn over a new leaf - start afresh.

E.g.- After his release from prison, he decided to turn over a new leaf and live an honest life.

Sol.139.(d) Tooth and nail - with full strength and determination.

E.g.- India played tooth and nail against Australia to win the cricket series.

Sol.140.(b) Face the music - Bear consequences

E.g. After repeatedly failing to turn in his assignments, John finally had to face the music and accept that he wouldn't pass the class.

Sol.141.(b) Face the music - Confront difficulties

E.g. Even though he was nervous about the exam, he decided to face the music and answer all the questions.

Sol.142.(b) The beautiful photograph captured the tragedy so well that no words were needed—truly, a picture is worth a thousand words.

The idiom "A picture is worth a thousand words" means that a single image can convey complex ideas or emotions more effectively than words. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.143.(c) Spill the beans - reveal a secret.

E.g. Shruti accidentally spilled the beans about the surprise party, and everyone knew about it.

Sol.144.(b) Steal someone's thunder - take credit for their work

E.g. The manager stole his assistant's thunder by presenting her idea as his own.

Sol.145.(a) Turn a deaf ear - Ignore advice.

E.g. - Despite repeated warnings from his doctor, he turned a deaf ear and continued smoking.

Sol.146.(a) Pull someone's leg - Joke with them.

E.g. - Riya told me she had won the lottery, but she was just pulling my leg.

Sol.147.(b) Don't count your chickens before they hatch - Don't assume success before it happens.

E.g. - She was sure she'd win the lottery and quit her job, but I told her not to count her chickens before they hatch.

Sol.148.(c) A white elephant - costly burden.

E.g. - The stadium built for the event turned out to be a white elephant.

Sol.149.(a) Cry over spilt milk - Regret a past loss

E.g. - Riya missed the bus, but there was no use crying over spilt milk.

Sol.150.(a) To leave no stone unturned - Search thoroughly.

E.g. - He left no stone unturned to impress the interview panel.

Sol.151.(b) on cloud nine - Extremely happy.

E.g. - She was on cloud nine when she heard that she had passed the exam.

Sol.152.(d) Flog a dead horse - Waste time on a lost cause.

E.g. - Arguing with her about the past is just flogging a dead horse.

Sol.153.(c) Barking up the wrong tree - Accusing wrongly.

E.g. - If you think I took your book, you are barking up the wrong tree.

Sol.154.(a) Cut no ice - Have no effect.

E.g. - His excuses cut no ice with the teacher.

Sol.155.(b) To grasp at straws - To try desperate measures.

E.g. - We searched all the backup tapes, trying to find the missing files, but we knew we were grasping at straws.

Sol.156.(b) Throw in the towel - Give up.

E.g. After several failed attempts to fix the car, he finally threw in the towel.

Sol.157.(b) Jump the gun - act prematurely.

E.g. The manager jumped the gun by announcing the project before getting final approval.

Sol.158.(d) To beat a dead horse - waste time on a hopeless issue

E.g. There is no point in arguing with him about that mistake; you are just beating a dead horse.

Sol.159.(d) Cry wolf - raise a false alarm

E.g. The villagers realized he was crying wolf when he called for help again without any real danger.

Sol.160.(c) Make a clean breast of - Confess.

E.g. He finally made a clean breast of his mistake to the teacher.

Sol.161.(b) Token strike - warning strike.
E.g.- The workers went on a token strike for two hours to protest the new work schedule.

Sol.162.(d) Bury the hatchet - make peace.

E.g.- After years of rivalry, the two neighbors decided to bury the hatchet and became friends again.

Sol.163.(a) Get to the point - speak directly.

E.g.- During the meeting, the manager asked everyone to get to the point and avoid unnecessary details.

Sol.164.(a) Jack up the rates - increase prices.

E.g.- The hotel decided to jack up the rates during the holiday season due to high demand.

Sol.165.(a) Speak your mind - express frankly.

E.g.- During the meeting, she decided to speak her mind about the project delays instead of staying quiet.

Sol.166.(a) Clutching at straws - hoping without reason.

E.g. - He was clutching at straws, hoping the exam would be postponed.

Sol.167.(c) Sit on the fence - stay neutral.

E.g. - When asked about the issue, he chose to sit on the fence rather than give his opinion.

Sol.168.(c) All at sea - confused.

E.g. - After getting the new assignment, I was all at sea about where to start.

Sol.169.(c) To go for a song - be sold cheaply.

E.g. - I bought this antique vase when it went for a song at the auction.

Sol.170.(a) To bell the cat - take a risky initiative.

E.g. - Proposing strict rules to the corrupt officials was like trying to bell the cat.

Sol.171.(d) The gift of the gab - Talent for speaking fluently and persuasively.

E.g. - He got the job because he had the gift of the gab and impressed the interviewers.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp) Questions (172 to 259)

Q.172. Be on the same page

- (a) Doing things with a partner
- (b) having the same understanding
- (c) Staying in the same place

(d) Reading something together

Q.173. Split one's sides

- (a) To scream in agony
- (b) To undergo surgery
- (c) To roar with laughter
- (d) To overeat

Q.174. Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.

Bite the _____

- (a) bullet (b) bread (c) barb (d) bean

Q.175. Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.

Sitting on the _____.

- (a) wall (b) boundary (c) tree (d) fence

Q.176. Be in apple-pie order

- (a) Be extra sweet to people
- (b) Be in a happy mood
- (c) Be in chronological order
- (d) Be perfectly arranged and tidy

Q.177. To get someone's goat

- (a) To steal something
- (b) To irritate someone
- (c) To make one feel good
- (d) To have affection for somebody

Q.178. Cut from the same cloth

- (a) To have very similar qualities
- (b) To belong to the same family
- (c) To share resources
- (d) To have the same origin

Q.179. Complete the dialogue for Person B using the correct idiom.

Person A: I am so nervous. I don't think I should make the speech tomorrow.

Person B: No. You are just getting _____. You have prepared for this.

- (a) hot feet (b) cold feet
- (c) cold hand (d) cold foot

Q.180. The team decided to pull out all the stops for their upcoming presentation.

- (a) To do everything to make something successful
- (b) Give up easily and without thinking much
- (c) Keep things simple and straightforward
- (d) Wait patiently for a more favourable time

Q.181. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

A lot of people are still _____ over the GDP issue.

- (a) over the fence (b) breaking a leg
- (c) sitting on the fence (d) by the fence

Q.182. Complete the dialogue for Person B using the correct idiom.

Person A: We are all going to the club this weekend. Do you want to come?

Person B: Thank you for asking. But I don't like clubs. It's_____.

- (a) not my cup, not my tea
- (b) not my cup of coffee
- (c) my cup of coffee
- (d) not my cup of tea

Q.183. He goes hard with one and all.

- (a) To be busy over trifles
- (b) To remain neutral
- (c) To be difficult
- (d) To be unreliable

Q.184. Read the sentence carefully and select the most suitable idiom to fill in the blank.

Extreme inflation in the country has led to a hike in the price of day-to-day commodity. It has made it difficult to ____.

- (a) a blessing in disguise
- (b) break a leg
- (c) costs an arm and a leg
- (d) keep body and soul together

Q.185. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Unless sales improve next month, the company will be in a critical position in which failure seems imminent.

- (a) a damp squib (b) hitting the sack
- (c) a mare's nest (d) up against the wall

Q.186. Your guess is as good as mine

- (a) To guess an incredible idea
- (b) To have no idea of the answer
- (c) To predict a disaster
- (d) To be superstitious

Q.187. Loose cannon

- (a) Someone who is quiet and reserved in social situations
- (b) Someone who is unpredictable and liable to cause problems
- (c) Someone who is enthusiastic and very eager to take responsibilities
- (d) Someone who is well known and respected in society

Q.188. Diamond in the rough

- (a) A top model
- (b) Unpolished diamonds
- (c) An industry of star-struck actors
- (d) An unsophisticated person with potential

Q.189. The sergeant ordered the soldiers to be armed to the teeth as he expected it to be a tough fight.

- (a) Working in a great hurry
- (b) Separated from the worthless
- (c) Active without any goals
- (d) Well-equipped or prepared

Q.190. The winner's performance was head and shoulders above all other participants' in the dance competition.

- (a) Worse than others
- (b) Well informed of current trends
- (c) Caught between two alternatives
- (d) Much better than others

Q.191. Made his mark

- (a) To make a colourful exit
- (b) To distinguish himself
- (c) To fail in the task
- (d) To take a stand

Q.192. Milk of human kindness

- (a) Compassion (b) Bravery
- (c) Luck (d) Victory

Q.193. Select the most appropriate idiomatic expression that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Today's managers' meeting has given me a lot to think about as I decide whether or not to stay with this company.

- (a) belle of the ball
- (b) bird's eye view
- (c) roll with the punches
- (d) food for thought

Q.194. Substitute the underlined word-segment with the most appropriate idiom.

Lack of funds is the main obstacle for the company's growth.

- (a) uphill battle
- (b) odds and ends
- (c) stumbling block
- (d) storm in the teacup

Q.195. Call it a day

- (a) Begin with an assignment
- (b) Stop working on something
- (c) Name a particular day
- (d) Involve many people for a simple job

Q.196. To show the white feather

- (a) To act cowardly (b) To show anger
- (c) To maintain peace (d) To act bravely

Q.197. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Bheem has been shown in the popular culture as someone who eats in large quantity.

- (a) eat humble pie (b) eats like a horse
- (c) eat like a bird (d) chews the fat

Q.198. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

The comedian's jokes were so funny that the audience was laughing uncontrollably.

- (a) on the ball (b) as easy as pie

- (c) in stitches (d) in bits and pieces

Q.199. Sushant looked blue in the face after the marathon.

- (a) happy (b) sad (c) exhausted (d) good

Q.200. Like a bat out of hell

- (a) Very fast and wildly
- (b) In a bad situation
- (c) Defeated
- (d) Impossible

Q.201. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

I heard management is planning to transfer me to another department and demote me. I need to confirm if this is true by hearing it directly from the person involved and from my manager.

- (a) straight from the horse's mouth
- (b) on pins and needles
- (c) in the seventh heaven
- (d) bearing a grudge

Q.202. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Most women are facing the same problem when it comes to job satisfaction because of the pay parity in institutions.

- (a) armchair experts
- (b) a drop in the ocean
- (c) comparing apples to oranges
- (d) in the same boat

Q.203. 'Hold someone's feet to the fire'

- (a) Agree upon a shared venture with full conviction
- (b) Take big risks without knowing the consequences
- (c) Think over a new proposal
- (d) Insist that someone fulfil their promises or obligations

Q.204. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

We hear the judges from their _____ that only CNG buses should run in Delhi.

- (a) melting pot (b) ivory tower
- (c) look sharp (d) square meal

Q.205. Like a dying duck in a thunderstorm

- (a) Fearful or scared of water
- (b) Dejected or hopeless
- (c) Bad swimmer or practitioner
- (d) Harmful or vigilant

Q.206. A square peg in a round hole

- (a) a person who is criminal by nature
- (b) a person who fits the job
- (c) a person who is bankrupt
- (d) a person who does not fit the job

Q.207. Baker's Dozen

- (a) Choosing quality over quantity

- (b) One unit extra with one dozen
- (c) A pile of bread
- (d) When shopkeepers put something extra

Q.208. Hanging by a thread.

- (a) To be perilously close to failing, dying, or resulting in a bad outcome
- (b) Crude and lacking sophistication
- (c) To do something very risky
- (d) To avoid danger or trouble

Q.209. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

We often go camping, but I have never been to that particular part of town or country before.

- (a) neck of the woods (b) knock on wood
- (c) get it in the neck (d) risk one's neck

Q.210. To look black

- (a) To roll on ice
- (b) To seem unfavourable
- (c) To give an approving expression
- (d) To cry bitterly

Q.211. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

After the long and tedious project, Sarah felt like she was at the limit of her patience.

- (a) end of her rope (b) tip of the iceberg
- (c) crossroads (d) finishing line

Q.212. Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.

That's great! You keep everything under your _____.

- (a) eyes (b) thumb (c) legs (d) hands

Q.213. The salesman informed the customers that if they had any questions, they could drop a line.

- (a) send a brief letter
- (b) complain against him
- (c) call his secretary
- (d) come back with the items

Q.214. To have bigger fish to fry

- (a) To have an interest in cooking
- (b) To know different kinds of fishing techniques
- (c) To take calculated risks
- (d) To have bigger things to take care of than the menial task at hand

Q.215. Break a leg

- (a) Give advice on maintaining physical health.
- (b) Encourage someone to engage in risky activities.
- (c) Suggest taking a short break during work.

(d) Wish someone good luck before a performance.

Q.216. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Raju's job as a clerk seemed to be bad at first because of the low salary, but resulted in something good happening later because it saved him from being unemployed.

- (a) a boon in disguise
- (b) a blessing in disguise
- (c) a jolt in disguise
- (d) a gift in disguise

Q.217. Fatima was at her wits' end trying to decide on a serene place for spending the holidays in.

- (a) So worried, confused or annoyed that she does not know what to do next
- (b) So worried, confused or annoyed that she became unconscious
- (c) So calm and composed that she knows what to do next
- (d) So worried, confused or annoyed that she insulted others for no reason

Q.218. Which of the following idioms means 'to steal from a shop'?

- (a) Golden opportunity
- (b) Green thumb
- (c) Five-finger discount
- (d) Black sheep

Q.219. On the ball

- (a) Unaware of any changes or developments and lazy to react to them
- (b) Aware of any changes or developments but slow to react to them
- (c) Aware of any changes or developments and quick to react to them
- (d) Aware of any changes or developments but doing nothing

Q.220. I'm ____ about whether to accept the job offer or continue freelancing. Both options have their advantages.

- (a) on the fence
- (b) cutting corners
- (c) left out in cold
- (d) up in arms

Q.221. Your so-called friend has **cooked your goose**.

- (a) To complete a lot of work or a wide range of things
- (b) When something develops completely and reaches maturity; when a child becomes an adult
- (c) To spend a lot of time and energy but achieve nothing
- (d) To interfere with, disrupt or ruin something for someone

Q.222. Care a hang

- (a) Hanging clothes to dry
- (b) Putting an outfit on a hanger
- (c) Caring too much
- (d) Showing no interest

Q.223. To tell others secret information only for enjoyment is not a good practice.

- (a) spill the words
- (b) spill the cat
- (c) spill the onions
- (d) spill the beans

Q.224. The doctors tried very hard to save his mother but they were unsuccessful.

- (a) faced the music
- (b) drew the line
- (c) moved heaven and earth
- (d) ran like clockwork

Q.225. Hit the nail on the head

- (a) They are experiencing a headache.
- (b) They have accurately identified or explained something.
- (c) They're uncertain about a decision.
- (d) They hit a nail with a hammer.

Q.226. To read between the lines

- (a) To underline some words
- (b) To read differently
- (c) To read aloud to public
- (d) To understand more than what the words suggest

Q.227. Jump the gun

- (a) To start all over again
- (b) Using a gun for sports
- (c) To stop a process
- (d) To do something too soon and too quickly

Q.228. A dime a dozen

- (a) Variety of amenities
- (b) Something common and not special
- (c) Very wealthy
- (d) A fair trade

Q.229. Nobody's fool

- (a) Not easily deceived
- (b) The wisest person
- (c) A complete fool
- (d) All are fools

Q.230. Read the sentence carefully and select the most suitable idiom to fill in the blank.

The renowned publisher decided to withdraw a book from the market. No one was interested in the book as the arguments presented were _____.

- (a) high and mighty
- (b) out of the woods
- (c) beside the mark
- (d) under the rose

Q.231. In my new office, all employees were different, so I felt like a fish out of water.

- (a) Uncomfortable
- (b) Homeless
- (c) Frustrated
- (d) Disappointed

Q.232. Anand personally believes in the motto, "When life gives you lemons, make lemonade."

- (a) Earn the maximum out of business
- (b) Nourish health
- (c) Enjoy the most when the season is favourable
- (d) Make the best out of difficult situations

Q.233. Turned a deaf ear to

- (a) Disregarded
- (b) At intervals
- (c) By any means
- (d) Rebuked

Q.234. All his friends admired him because he was a straight shooter.

- (a) Excellent shooter
- (b) Complicated and confusing person
- (c) Miserly and pessimistic individual
- (d) A thoroughly upright straightforward person

Q.235. My uncle lives in New York, so I only see him once in a blue moon.

- (a) Not very often
- (b) Monthly
- (c) Weekly
- (d) Very often

Q.236. Radhika stood by Monica's side through thick and thin.

- (a) Under easy situations wherein she could ensure Monica's safety and security
- (b) In all the happy moments, personally spending most of her time
- (c) Under all conditions, no matter how challenging or difficult
- (d) In the moments when Monica couldn't complete some simple tasks

Q.237. In those days, we did not expect luxuries; we were thankful if we could keep the wolf from the door.

- (a) Avoid starvation
- (b) Wallow in poverty
- (c) Relish food
- (d) Encourage starvation

Q.238. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

My cousin works day and night to achieve success in life.

- (a) vale of tears
- (b) around the clock
- (c) great dealing
- (d) a handful

Q.239. To bring to light

- (a) To engage in conversation
- (b) To lighten
- (c) To disclose
- (d) To disengage

Q.240. Rina pulled a long face since her husband had not bought her a diamond necklace on their anniversary.

- (a) To be euphoric
- (b) To be ecstatic
- (c) To look saddened
- (d) To be electrified

Q.241. Easy does it

- (a) Used to tell someone to do something rarely
 (b) Used to tell someone to do something violently
 (c) Used to tell someone to do something slowly and carefully
 (d) Used to tell someone to do something horribly

Q.242. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill the blank in the given situation.

I thought Sadhna would always stick by me, but when I got into trouble, she turned out to be a/an _____.

- (a) hard nut to crack (b) open secret
 (c) fair-weather friend (d) white elephant

Q.243. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the idiom in the given brackets.

His PhD degree seems to be (Penelope's web).

- (a) An important task (b) A difficult task
 (c) A secret task (d) An endless task

Q.244. On cloud nine

- (a) Being angry with someone
 (b) Being very delighted
 (c) Flying in the sky
 (d) Being very high

Q.245. A bitter pill

- (a) Facing a distressing situation
 (b) Talking nonsense
 (c) Arguing unnecessarily
 (d) Getting furious easily

Q.246. Creature of habit

- (a) A mean person
 (b) A bad habit
 (c) A faithful dog
 (d) One who does same thing in the same way

Q.247. Hit the roof

- (a) To destruct a building
 (b) To become very angry
 (c) To jump high
 (d) To play joyfully

Q.248. I had heard of henpecked husbands and now, I felt that I saw one.

- (a) Controlling husband
 (b) Bossy husbands
 (c) Oppressed husband
 (d) Dominating husbands

Q.249. At a low ebb

- (a) In a depressed or weak state
 (b) In a happy state
 (c) In a critical moment
 (d) In an unemployed mode

Q.250. Off and on

- (a) Now and then
 (b) Know something thoroughly

- (c) Remind
 (d) Object to

Q.251. Left out in the cold

- (a) To go underground
 (b) To be in hiding
 (c) To be ignored
 (d) To be extremely negative

Q.252. Break the ice

- (a) Nervousness before a performance
 (b) Ill-feeling carried by a person over a period of time
 (c) Respect for someone's achievements
 (d) To say or do something that makes people feel more relaxed, especially at the beginning of a meeting, party

Q.253. This year's budget is unlikely to pass as law since the president's proposed budgets typically face a jaundiced eye but this one has gotten even more scepticism.

- (a) Jealousy (b) Confidence
 (c) Resentment (d) Good will

Q.254. A time when money might unexpectedly be needed

- (a) A rainy day
 (b) A raw deal
 (c) A rash of something
 (d) A rap over the knuckles

Q.255. Instead of confusing others, let us call a spade a spade in front of the audience.

- (a) Pretend superiority (b) Remain silent
 (c) Speak truthfully (d) Be at strife

Q.256. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

After months of dedication and effort, I finally completed the marathon. I can really _____ for this accomplishment.

- (a) eat like a horse
 (b) up a creek without a paddle
 (c) blow hot and cold
 (d) pat myself on the back

Q.257. The leader of the Legislative Assembly won the hearts of the members through his maiden speech during the session in state council.

- (a) final speech (b) closure speech
 (c) first speech (d) logical speech

Q.258. The entire speech of the revivalist fell flat with the crowd that was present there.

- (a) had a great impact on
 (b) had moderate influence on
 (c) had somewhat of a result on
 (d) had no effect on

Q.259. My brother always received the lion's share of every meal that we had.

- (a) a very small part (b) the pet's share
 (c) the last bite (d) the major portion

Solutions :-

Sol.172.(b) Be on the same page- having the same understanding.

E.g.- Before starting the project, the manager made sure everyone was on the same page about the goals.

Sol.173.(c) Split one's sides- to roar with laughter.

E.g.- The comedian's jokes were so funny that the audience was splitting their sides with laughter.

Sol.174.(a) Bite the bullet - To face a difficult situation with courage and determination.

E.g.- He finally bit the bullet and paid off all his debts, even though it meant giving up some luxuries.

Sol.175.(d) Sitting on the fence- to refuse to take sides in a dispute.

E.g.- During the argument between his friends, he chose to sit on the fence and stay neutral.

Sol.176.(d) Be in apple-pie order- be perfectly arranged and tidy.

E.g.- She cleaned the entire house until everything was in apple-pie order for the guests.

Sol.177.(b) To get someone's goat- to irritate someone.

E.g.- His constant interruptions really get my goat when I'm trying to concentrate.

Sol.178.(a) Cut from the same cloth- to have very similar qualities.

E.g.- Both sisters are hardworking and kind. They are truly cut from the same cloth.

Sol.179.(b) Cold feet- feeling nervous or lack of confidence.

Sol.180.(a) Pull out all the stops- to do everything to make something successful.

Sol.181.(c) sitting on the fence- to refuse to support or oppose a decision.

Sol.182.(d) (not) my cup of tea- (not) an activity that someone likes.

Sol.183.(c) Goes hard - to be difficult.

Sol.184.(d) keep body and soul together - to get enough food and money to survive.

Sol.185.(d) up against the wall - in a

critical position in which failure seems imminent.

Sol.186.(b) Your guess is as good as mine - to have no idea of the answer.

E.g.- I asked him when the train would arrive, and he replied that his guess was as good as mine.

Sol.187.(b) Loose canon - someone who is unpredictable and liable to cause problems.

E.g.- The new manager is a loose cannon. He makes sudden decisions without consulting anyone

Sol.188.(d) Diamond in the rough - an unsophisticated person with potential.

E.g.- Despite his lack of formal training, Jake is a diamond in the rough with exceptional artistic talent.

Sol.189.(d) Armed to the teeth

- well-equipped or prepared.

Sol.190.(d) Head and shoulders above

- much better than others.

Sol.191.(b) Made his mark - to distinguish himself.

E.g.- She made her mark in the art world with her unique and captivating painting style.

Sol.192.(a)

Milk of human kindness - compassion.

E.g.- Despite her struggles, she showed the milk of human kindness by helping the homeless in her community.

Sol.193.(d) Food for thought - a lot to think about.

Sol.194.(c) Stumbling block - obstacle.

Sol.195.(b) Call it a day - stop working on something.

E.g.- After finishing the last report, Sarah decided to call it a day and head home early.

Sol.196.(a) To show the white feather - to act cowardly.

E.g.- He showed the white feather by backing out of the challenge at the last minute.

Sol.197.(b) Eats like a horse - eats in large quantity.

Sol.198.(c)

In stitches - laughing uncontrollably.

Sol.199.(c) Blue in the face- exhausted.

Sol.200.(a) Like a bat out of hell - very fast and wildly.

E.g.- He ran out of the building like a bat

out of hell when the alarm went off.

Sol.201.(a) Straight from the horse's mouth - directly from the person involved.

Sol.202.(d) In the same boat - facing the same problem.

Sol.203.(d) Hold someone's feet to the fire - insist that someone fulfil their promises or obligations.

E.g.- The voters are holding the politician's feet to the fire to deliver on his campaign promises.

Sol.204.(b) Ivory tower - a place or situation where you are separated from the problems and practical aspects of normal life.

Sol.205.(b) Like a dying duck in a thunderstorm - dejected or hopeless.

E.g.- After losing the match, the team walked off the field like a dying duck in a thunderstorm.

Sol.206.(d) A square peg in a round hole

- a person who does not fit the job.

E.g.- John is a square peg in a round hole as a quiet person in a sales job.

Sol.207.(b) Baker's dozen - one unit extra with one dozen.

E.g.- The shopkeeper smiled and added an extra egg to make it a baker's dozen.

Sol.208.(a) Hanging by a thread - perilously close to failing, dying or resulting in a bad outcome.

E.g.- The company is losing money and is hanging by a thread.

Sol.209.(a) Neck of the woods - particular part of town or country.

Sol.210.(b)

To look black- to seem unfavourable.

E.g.- Things looked black for the team after they lost their best player to injury.

Sol.211.(a) End of her rope - limit of her patience.

Sol.212.(b) thumb

The idiom 'under your thumb' means completely under your influence or control. Hence, 'thumb' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.213.(a) Drop a line - send a brief letter.

Sol.214.(d) To have bigger fish to fry - to have bigger things to take care of than the menial task at hand.

E.g.- I can't worry about that small project right now. I have bigger fish to fry.

Sol.215.(d) Break a leg - wish someone good luck before a performance.

E.g.- You're going to do great in the play tonight. Break a leg!

Sol.216.(b) A blessing in disguise - bad at first, but resulted in something good happening later.

Sol.217.(a) At her wits' end - so worried, confused or annoyed that she does not know what to do next.

Sol.218.(c) Five-finger discount - to steal from a shop.

E.g.- He got caught trying to use a five-finger discount at the electronics store.

Sol.219.(c) On the ball- aware of any changes or developments and quick to react to them.

E.g.- The manager is really on the ball. She noticed the issues before they became major problems.

Sol.220.(a) On the fence - not able to decide something.

Sol.221.(d) Cooked your goose - to interfere with, disrupt or ruin something for someone.

E.g.- I didn't want to go to the dentist, but I had to bite the bullet and get my tooth fixed.

Sol.222.(d) Care a hang - showing no interest.

E.g.- She doesn't care a hang about the latest fashion trends.

Sol.223.(d) Spill the beans - tell others secret information.

Sol.224.(c) Moved heaven and earth - tried very hard.

Sol.225.(b) Hit the nail on the head - they have accurately identified or explained something.

E.g.- When she said the project failed due to poor planning, she really hit the nail on the head.

Sol.226.(d) To read between the lines - to understand more than what the words suggest.

E.g.- He didn't say he was upset, but you could read between the lines and sense his frustration.

Sol.227.(d) Jump the gun - to do something too soon and too quickly.

E.g.- He jumped the gun by announcing the promotion before it was officially confirmed.

Sol.228.(b) A dime a dozen - something common and not special.



E.g.- In big cities, coffee shops are a dime a dozen.

Sol.229.(a) Nobody's fool - not easily deceived.

E.g.- He's nobody's fool and won't fall for that scam.

Sol.230.(c) Beside the mark - something is irrelevant or not to the point.

Sol.231.(a) Fish out of water - uncomfortable.

Sol.232.(d) When life gives you lemons, make lemonade. - make the best out of difficult situations.

Sol.233.(a) Turned a deaf ear to - disregarded.

E.g.- He turned a deaf ear to their complaints and continued with his plan.

Sol.234.(d) Straight shooter - a thoroughly upright straightforward person.

Sol.235.(a) Once in a blue moon - not very often.

Sol.236.(c) Through thick and thin - under all conditions, no matter how challenging or difficult.

Sol.237.(a) Keep the wolf from the door - avoid starvation.

Sol.238.(b)

Around the clock (idiom) - day and night.

Sol.239.(c) To bring to light - to disclose.
E.g.- The investigation brought to light several previously unknown facts about the case.

Sol.240.(c)

Pulled a long face - to look saddened.

Sol.241.(c) Easy does it - used to tell someone to do something slowly and carefully.

E.g.- Easy does it with the boxes. Don't drop anything fragile.

Sol.242.(c)

fair-weather friend - 'Fair-weather friend' is an idiom which means 'a person who is dependable in good times but is not in times of trouble'. The given sentence states that I thought Sadhna would always stick by me, but when I got into trouble, she turned out to be a fair-weather friend. Hence, 'fair-weather friend' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.243.(d)

Penelope's web - an endless task.

Sol.244.(b)

On cloud nine - being very delighted.

E.g.- She was on cloud nine after hearing about her promotion.

Sol.245.(a) A bitter pill - facing a distressing situation.

E.g.- Accepting that I lost the competition was a bitter pill to swallow.

Sol.246.(d) Creature of habit - one who does same thing in the same way.

E.g.- Tom is a creature of habit. He wakes up at the same time every day.

Sol.247.(b)

Hit the roof - to become very angry.

E.g.- When he saw the mess in the kitchen, he hit the roof.

Sol.248.(c) Henpecked husbands - oppressed husband.

Sol.249.(a) At a low ebb - in a depressed or weak state.

E.g.- She felt at a low ebb after failing the exam.

Sol.250.(a) Off and on - now and then.

E.g.- He visits his grandparents off and on throughout the year.

Sol.251.(c)

Left out in the cold - to be ignored.

E.g.- She felt left out in the cold when her friends didn't invite her to the party.

Sol.252.(d)

Break the ice - to say or do something that makes people feel more relaxed, especially at the beginning of a meeting, party.

E.g.- He told a joke to break the ice at the start of the meeting.

Sol.253.(c) Jaundiced eye - resentment.

Sol.254.(a) A rainy day - a time when money might unexpectedly be needed.

E.g.- She saved some money for a rainy day, just in case of an emergency.

Sol.255.(c) Call a spade a spade - speak truthfully.

Sol.256.(d) Pat myself on the back - to praise myself for doing something good.

Sol.257.(c) Maiden speech - first speech.

Sol.258.(d) had no effect on

'Fell flat with' is an idiom which means to have no effect on the audience. The given passage states that the entire speech of the revivalist fell flat with the crowd that was present there. Hence, 'had no effect on' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.259.(d) the major portion

"The lion's share" is an idiom which means the major portion. Hence, option (d) is the most appropriate answer.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp) Questions (260 to 351)

Q.260. We all have to pull our socks up for the upcoming Board exam, if we want to get outstanding grades.

- (a) act in a proper manner
- (b) work harder than before
- (c) calm down impudent contempt
- (d) revive interest in old matters

Q.261. Due to her impoverished state, most of her relatives treated her with contempt.

- (a) Came in handy
- (b) Turned up their nose at her
- (c) Turned the corner at her
- (d) Gave a wide space to her

Q.262. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

The betrayal of the country was at last unmasked.

- (a) traitor
- (b) truant
- (c) transgressor
- (d) theist

Q.263. Let the dust settle

- (a) To make use of a situation
- (b) Wait for the other person to make a move
- (c) To make a space tidy
- (d) To wait for a situation to become clear or certain

Q.264. Ranveer never has the habit of making a beeline for his academic activities.

- (a) behaving abnormally
- (b) selecting inconsiderately
- (c) going straight and quick
- (d) immediately responding to things

Q.265. The company understood that these small protests of employees regarding low wages were just the tip of the iceberg.

- (a) A small, noticeable part of a problem, the total size of which is non-existent
- (b) A small, noticeable part of a problem, the total size of which is solvable
- (c) A large part of a problem which is really noticeable
- (d) A small, noticeable part of a problem, the total size of which is really much greater

Q.266. Bincy's mother kept her cards close to her chest.

- (a) Decided to show more affection

- (b) Informed that all the cards must be kept safe
 (c) Kept her purse and money by herself
 (d) Kept her plans and thoughts hidden

Q.267. Lucy's conceited conduct with her colleagues has left her high and dry.

- (a) Helpless
 (b) Superseding
 (c) Impoverished
 (d) Surrounded by people

Q.268. The realtors of the new venture sold plots like hot cakes.

- (a) Sold illegally
 (b) Sold with great difficulty
 (c) Sold innovatively
 (d) Sold quickly and in large number

Q.269. Black and white

- (a) In writing (b) Doubtful
 (c) In dispute (d) A false invention

Q.270. At one's fingertips

- (a) Out of reach
 (b) To take revenge
 (c) To have complete knowledge
 (d) To be unaware of something

Q.271. Teja followed his friend's advice so now he is in deep water.

- (a) In trouble (b) In good position
 (c) In deep thoughts (d) In dilemma

Q.272. Blowing smoke

- (a) To tease someone relentlessly
 (b) To lie to perplex others
 (c) To burn something important
 (d) To hide something

Q.273. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

The arrival of Pragati in the house brought disharmony among the family members.

- (a) A cry in the wilderness
 (b) Hair breadth
 (c) Rift in the lute
 (d) Tenterhooks

Q.274. Cost an arm and a leg

- (a) To be affordable
 (b) To be moderately priced
 (c) To be inexpensive
 (d) To be very expensive

Q.275. Put in mind

- (a) To forget (b) To understand
 (c) To calculate (d) To remind

Q.276. Dog eat dog

- (a) Like-minded people connect better
 (b) Tit for tat
 (c) Being calculative
 (d) Ruthlessly competitive

Q.277. Slip your mind

- (a) Immediately think of something
 (b) Forget about something
 (c) Can't think of anything to say
 (d) Think about something for a short time

Q.278. Lose heart

- (a) To believe in your success
 (b) To be suspicious of your success
 (c) To stop believing that you can succeed
 (d) To get success by believing in yourself

Q.279. Select the most appropriate idiomatic expression that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.:

It feels like I made a promise of more than my ability when I promised to complete this worksheet in one day.

- (a) bit off more than I could chew
 (b) beat the drum
 (c) beat my brain out
 (d) burnt a hole in my pocket

Q.280. On its last legs

- (a) Last choice
 (b) In a bad condition
 (c) Creeping on legs
 (d) Slow movement

Q.281. Last resort

- (a) Last ride
 (b) Last friend remaining
 (c) Last course of action
 (d) Last hotel on the way

Q.282. Have a bee in your bonnet

- (a) Unable to stay at a place for long
 (b) To keep worrying about yourself
 (c) Be preoccupied or obsessed with something
 (d) Having a cruel intention or grudge against someone

Q.283. Stick to one's guns

- (a) To become unfaithful to
 (b) To become a rebel
 (c) To shoot at
 (d) To remain faithful to

Q.284. Best thing since sliced bread

- (a) Rated well amongst cooks
 (b) Extremely good, interesting
 (c) Something to be cautious about
 (d) Breaking news

Q.285. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined word segment in the given sentence.

Delivering that furniture to the tenth floor without the lift and an incline is incredibly foolish and next to impossible.

- (a) like a tree known by its fruits

- (b) as tight as the bark of the tree
 (c) like nailing jelly to the tree
 (d) like going between the bark and the tree

Q.286. Vishnu and Vignesh are always like two peas in a pod.

- (a) Good in every way
 (b) Very similar to each other
 (c) Smart and intelligent
 (d) Happy and compassionate

Q.287. Independence Day is considered as a red-letter day in the history of India.

- (a) Regular day (b) Uneventful day
 (c) Memorable day (d) Unimportant day

Q.288. Prakash could not make up his mind about what to do with the project.

- (a) Abide (b) Decide
 (c) Think (d) Abandon

Q.289. You can best identify the fair weather friends at the time of adversity.

- (a) Friend only at the time of prosperity
 (b) Best friends
 (c) Friends who come in good weather conditions
 (d) Friends who bring good rain

Q.290. I can't begin to talk on this situation right now; I am still wrapping my head around it.

- (a) Understanding something complicated
 (b) Comparing two things that can't be compared
 (c) Revealing a secret nobody knows
 (d) Ignoring something completely

Q.291. A bolt from the blue

- (a) A sudden and unexpected event
 (b) Raining heavily
 (c) Thunder and rain in a storm
 (d) A spontaneous but expected event

Q.292. Walk a tightrope

- (a) To act carefully in a difficult situation
 (b) To try and balance yourself
 (c) To walk on a narrow road
 (d) To be tensed about something

Q.293. Bag and baggage

- (a) By force (b) Fair and honest
 (c) At the service (d) With all goods

Q.294. The United Nations is working to eliminate the vicious cycle of poverty.

- (a) One problem causes other
 (b) Strength of something
 (c) Loophole of something
 (d) The barrier of poverty

Q.295. When I got an opportunity to start a new business, Ravikanth queered my pitch.

- (a) Ruined my plan

- (b) Advised me
(c) Helped me by standing beside me
(d) Supported me with money

Q.296. Bells and whistles

- (a) At a serious disadvantage
(b) To take on a difficult task
(c) An innovative development
(d) Attractive but unnecessary features added to products

Q.297. Which of the following idioms means 'going to sleep'?

- (a) Hit the sack
(b) Run around in circles
(c) Break new grounds
(d) Keep an ear to the ground

Q.298. Where the shoe pinches

- (a) Where the shoe hurts
(b) Difficult roads
(c) Unknown paths
(d) Where the difficulty lies

Q.299. A wild goose chase

- (a) On a hunt (b) Fruitful search
(c) Fruitless search (d) Ideal seeking

Q.300. An old head on young shoulders

- (a) A person who is slow at understanding things.
(b) A young person who acts or speaks like an older person.
(c) A young person who is lazy.
(d) A young person who looks old.

Q.301. He got medals time after time by following the instructions of his mentor.

- (a) Repeatedly (b) Once
(c) Twice (d) Rarely

Q.302. Select the sentence that brings out the most appropriate meaning of the idiom.

'Dog in the manger'.

- (a) Mohit was so loyal and committed to his company that he rejected lucrative offers from different companies.
(b) Rachit had some important work and so he cancelled the show tickets for everyone.
(c) To prove this is not a trap, I want to check the credibility of your plan.
(d) You are here just because you have recognised your hidden potential.

Q.303. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill the blank in the given situation.

They were waiting for their family members who were returning from a pilgrimage.

Therefore, they were _____ on the platform.

- (a) running behind time
(b) playing a joke
(c) rolling up their sleeves
(d) pacing up and down

Q.304. Manish told Rounak time and again of the ill consequences of his habit of being late to the college.

- (a) Not often (b) Hardly ever
(c) Repeatedly (d) At intervals

Q.305. Going through a sticky patch

- (a) To experience a bad period in life
(b) To walk on a muddy road
(c) To feel sad
(d) Try to paste something unsuccessfully

Q.306. A sting in the tail

- (a) A situation in which a large group has to do something to satisfy a small group
(b) Something which seems bad at first but contains a pleasant part at the end
(c) To initiate a situation that is very complicated or problematic
(d) An unexpected, typically unpleasant or problematic end to something

Q.307. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined word segment in the given sentence.

I know Covid has made you terribly ill, but the good thing is that you have developed immunity against it for further infections.

- (a) the silver lining in the cloud
(b) crossing palms with silver
(c) being in the quicksilver
(d) the silver spoon

Q.308. Out of the frying pan and into the fire

- (a) Being with someone through good times as well as bad times
(b) Being a horrible cook
(c) Things getting intense by the hour
(d) Things going from bad to worse

Q.309. Every piece of furniture in her house is in apple-pie order.

- (a) Very delicately arranged
(b) Kept in a disorganised way
(c) Very neatly arranged
(d) Painted in light colours

Q.310. To throw dust in one's eyes

- (a) To hit someone with stone
(b) To mislead someone by tricks
(c) To talk in an abusive language
(d) To make someone blind forever

Q.311. Based on the situation in the sentence, select the most appropriate idiom.

After many years of rivalry, the two schools decided to _____ and participate in a National Event together.

- (a) be in the doldrums (b) go cold turkey
(c) bury the hatchet (d) bell the cat

Q.312. By leaps and bounds

- (a) Slowly (b) Rapidly
(c) Unknowingly (d) Normally

Q.313. Yeoman's service

- (a) Fraudulent service
(b) Working under a cruel master
(c) Excellent work done
(d) A thankless and tedious job

Q.314. Skating on thin ice

- (a) He was on thin ice after making a controversial statement.
(b) They were on thin ice due to the icy conditions on the road.
(c) They were on thin ice when they skated on the frozen lake.
(d) She was on thin ice while trying to balance on a tightrope.

Q.315. Be in seventh heaven

- (a) To be ignored
(b) To be in a state of extreme happiness
(c) To start performing better
(d) To avoid talking about what's important

Q.316. Based on the situation in the sentence, select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment.

After the Pandemic, his business crumbled and he is in a difficult situation.

- (a) Be in a tight corner
(b) Give a cold shoulder
(c) Bolt from the blue
(d) Pull the last straw

Q.317. At the drop of a hat

- (a) Eventually (b) Immediately
(c) Certainly (d) Consecutively

Q.318. Go down in flames

- (a) To crash and burn
(b) To destroy completely
(c) To fail spectacularly
(d) To burn down completely

Q.319. Identify the meaning of the idiom in the given situation.

I will always stand by my friend.

- (a) Support in difficult situation
(b) Stand next to
(c) Work together
(d) Be in a queue

Q.320. Only those having blue blood can dethrone the evil autocrat and restore equilibrium.

- (a) Bitter relations
(b) Vigilant nature
(c) Political ideology
(d) Aristocratic lineage

Q.321. Ignoring his father's warnings, he said, "an elephant in the room" to his mother.

- (a) There is an obvious problem

- (b) Someone hiding in the room
 (c) The elephant got stuck in the room
 (d) Someone begins to suspect

Q.322. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.
 The players like the coach because he is honest, realistic and practical in dealing with them.

- (a) far and wide (b) down to earth
 (c) sick and tired (d) by and large

Q.323. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation focusing on the underlined words.

I invited them to my anniversary dinner but they had other plans, so they decided to politely decline with the implication that they may come at a later date.

- (a) Took it with a grain of salt
 (b) To take a rain check
 (c) To spoil a moment
 (d) Call it a day

Q.324. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence and complete the sentence correctly.

It is important to take this opportunity to make a name for yourself - beat around the bush.

- (a) fight tooth and claw
 (b) bare the foot
 (c) pass with flying colours
 (d) strike while the iron is hot

Q.325. Select the most appropriate idiomatic expression that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

He is very strict with his students but good-natured.

- (a) he has a big mouth
 (b) his heart is in the right place
 (c) his heart misses a beat
 (d) his eyes are bigger than his stomach

Q.326. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

When I went to Egypt and lost my wallet and passport, I was _____

- (a) rolling up my sleeves
 (b) working my fingers to the bone
 (c) putting my nose to the grindstone
 (d) up in a creek without a paddle

Q.327. To leave no stone unturned

- (a) To treat someone/something as if of no importance
 (b) To control a person completely
 (c) To win everything that is available
 (d) To do everything possible to achieve something

Q.328. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

John was always _____ about becoming a millionaire without doing any hard work.

- (a) building castles in the air
 (b) eating like a horse
 (c) having an ace up his sleeve
 (d) a storm in a tea cup

Q.329. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

It's Christmas and everything looks so beautiful. It makes me believe that life is wonderful and pleasant.

- (a) I'm facing the music
 (b) I'm changing my tune
 (c) life is a bowl of cherries
 (d) I'm up in the air

Q.330. Beat around the bush.

- (a) To talk about something important.
 (b) To go around the bush.
 (c) To live around the bush.
 (d) To avoid talking about what is important.

Q.331. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

We need to make sure that criminals like these get more from the authorities than a very mild punishment.

- (a) a taste of their own medicine
 (b) an axe to grind
 (c) a blessing in disguise
 (d) a slap on the wrist

Q.332. Despite multiple obstacles, she continued with her endeavour, demonstrating that she has nerves of steel.

- (a) The capacity to maintain composure when stressed
 (b) Extraordinary beauty
 (c) An absence of fear or anxiety
 (d) Relentless determination

Q.333. In life, there will be many situations where you have to choose between the devil and the deep blue sea.

- (a) To be in dilemma to choose
 (b) To be in a good condition
 (c) To be in the deep sea
 (d) To choose wisely

Q.334. Select the sentence that uses the given idiom correctly.

Have your head in the clouds

- (a) They had their heads in the clouds by looking up at the sky during a meteor shower.
 (b) The pilot had his head in the clouds while flying a plane.
 (c) He had his head in the clouds during an important meeting.
 (d) She had her head in the clouds by

wearing a cloud-shaped hat.

Q.335. Select the most appropriate idiom from the options to replace the underlined segment in the given sentence.

After his business failed, he had to reduce spending and adjust to a frugal lifestyle.

- (a) let the cat out of the bag
 (b) hit the nail on the head
 (c) kick the bucket
 (d) tighten his belt

Q.336. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined word in the given idiom.

A goose's eye view

- (a) bird's (b) hornet's (c) fool's (d) dog's

Q.337. When pigs fly

- (a) Something that will never happen
 (b) Something that will never deviate
 (c) something that will get completed
 (d) Something that will never last long

Q.338. Sacred cow

- (a) Unquestionable (b) Interrogate
 (c) Hateful (d) Harmful

Q.339. Black sheep

- (a) Disreputable (b) Miscreant
 (c) Intelligent (d) Naive

Q.340. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined part in the given sentence:

Amar was left in a difficult situation by his business partners.

- (a) Heart and soul
 (b) Hard and fast
 (c) High and dry
 (d) Head and shoulders above

Q.341. Get itchy feet

- (a) Judge something primarily on appearance
 (b) Join a popular trend or activity
 (c) Learn something by memorising it without a thought to what is being learnt
 (d) To start to want to travel or do something different

Q.342. On thin ice

- (a) On an investigating job
 (b) On a summer vacation
 (c) Communicating with friends
 (d) In a risky position

Q.343. Bread and butter

- (a) Breakfast (b) Party
 (c) Livelihood (d) Sharing

Q.344. A team's captain always keeps a level head, even in the most challenging situations.

- (a) Keeps his head protected with a helmet
- (b) Prefers to keep his head covered with a cap
- (c) Maintains an equal number of players on the field
- (d) Remains calm and composed

Q.345. Keep your pants on

- (a) To keep calm and quiet
- (b) To wear the dress neatly
- (c) To work like a tailor
- (d) To make things proper

Q.346. Nip in the bud

- (a) To suppress something at an early stage
- (b) To publicise a long-kept secret
- (c) To complete a prolonged or unfinished work
- (d) To stop something from growing beyond limit

Q.347. Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence.

I sent the agreement over for them to sign so the ball is now in their court.

- (a) It is time for someone to deal with a problem or make a decision, because other people have already done as much as they can
- (b) An approach that uses traditional ideas that have previously worked
- (c) A time when after which programmes for older audiences may be aired on TV
- (d) Better to be satisfied with what you have than risk losing it by trying to get something better

Q.348. From cradle to grave

- (a) To achieve something you needed
- (b) Buying something very cheap or very expensive
- (c) Giving directions and telling someone to follow
- (d) During the whole span of one's life

Q.349. Chip on the shoulder

- (a) Elated
- (b) Emotional
- (c) Happy
- (d) Offended

Q.350. See eye to eye

- (a) To agree with someone
- (b) To get upset with something
- (c) To do something pointless
- (d) To ignore someone

Q.351. In the following question, a statement has been given with highlighted text. You are required to replace the text with correct phrase given in the options.

His intriguing mastery of the English language allowed him to write eloquently.

- (a) least known talent
- (b) captivating expertise
- (c) master
- (d) wellness known skill

Solutions :-

Sol.260.(b) work harder than before

'Pull our socks up' is an idiom which means to work harder than before. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.261.(b) Turned up their nose at her - treated her with contempt.

Sol.262.(a)

Traitor - betrayer of the country.

Sol.263.(d) Let the dust settle - to wait for a situation to become clear or certain. E.g.- Let's wait a few days and let the dust settle before making any decisions.

Sol.264.(c) Making a beeline (idiom) - going straight and quick.

Sol.265.(d) The tip of the iceberg - a small, noticeable part of a problem, the total size of which is really much greater.

Sol.266.(d) Kept her cards close to her chest - Kept her plans and thoughts hidden.

Sol.267.(a) High and dry - helpless.

Sol.268.(d) Sold like hot cakes - something is being sold very quickly and in large quantities.

Sol.269.(a) Black and White - in writing. E.g.- Make sure you get the agreement in black and white before proceeding with the deal.

Sol.270.(c) At one's fingertips - to have complete knowledge.

E.g.- With years of experience in research, she has all the necessary information at her fingertips.

Sol.271.(a) In deep water - in trouble.

Sol.272.(b) Blowing smoke - to lie to perplex others.

E.g.- He has been blowing smoke about his result in college.

Sol.273.(c) Rift in the lute - disharmony.

Sol.274.(d) Cost an arm and a leg - to be very expensive.

E.g.- Getting a new smartphone with all the latest features will cost you an arm and a leg.

Sol.275.(d) Put in mind - to remind.

E.g.- Her story really put in mind the

struggles I faced during my childhood.

Sol.276.(d)

Dog eat dog - ruthlessly competitive.

E.g.- The game was dog eat dog, both teams played hard to win.

Sol.277.(b)

Slip your mind - forget about something.

E.g.- I was supposed to pick up groceries after work, but it totally slipped my mind.

Sol.278.(c) Lose heart - to stop believing that you can succeed.

E.g.- After a few setbacks, he began to lose heart in his project.

Sol.279.(a)

Bit off more than I could chew - made a promise of more than my ability.

Sol.280.(a)

On its last legs - in a bad condition.

E.g.- The old car has been breaking down frequently. It is really on its last legs.

Sol.281.(c)

Last resort - last course of action.

E.g.- If the problem continues, we may have to consider cutting costs as a last resort.

Sol.282.(c) Have a bee in your bonnet - be preoccupied or obsessed with something.

E.g.- She has a bee in her bonnet about cleaning, so she's always tidying up the house.

Sol.283.(d)

Stick to one's gun - to remain faithful to.

E.g.- Even though everyone criticized her decision, Sarah stuck to her guns and remained faithful to her principles.

Sol.284.(b) Best thing since sliced bread - extremely good, interesting.

E.g.- I think video calls are the best thing since sliced bread because they help me talk to my family far away.

Sol.285.(c) Like nailing jelly to the tree - extremely difficult or nearly impossible to achieve.

Sol.286.(b) Like two peas in a pod - very similar to each other.

Sol.287.(c)

Red letter day - memorable day.

Sol.288.(b) Make up his mind - decide.

Sol.289.(a) Fair weather friend - friend only at the time of prosperity.

Sol.290.(a) Wrapping my head around it - understanding something complicated.

Sol.291.(a) A bolt from the blue - a

sudden and unexpected event.

E.g.- The sudden announcement of the company's closure was a bolt from the blue for all the employees.

Sol.292.(a) Walk a tightrope - to act carefully in a difficult situation.

E.g.- He had to walk a tightrope when deciding between going to the party and studying for his exam

Sol.293.(d)

Bag and baggage - with all goods.

E.g.- After the argument, she left the house bag and baggage.

Sol.294.(a) The vicious cycle - one problem causes other.

Sol.295.(a) Queered my pitch - ruined my plan.

Sol.296.(d) Bells and whistles - attractive but unnecessary features added to products.

E.g.- The new phone comes with all the bells and whistles, but I only need the basic features.

Sol.297.(a) Hit the sack - going to sleep.
E.g.- After a long day at work, I decided to hit the sack early to get some rest.

Sol.298.(d) Where the shoe pinches - where the difficulty lies.

E.g.- The manager knows where the shoe pinches and is working to solve the problem.

Sol.299.(c)

A wild goose chase - fruitless search.

E.g.- We looked everywhere for the dog, but it was a wild goose chase because he was sleeping in the backyard.

Sol.300.(b) An old head on young shoulders - a young person who acts or speaks like an older person.

E.g.- Despite being only 16, his mature decisions show he's an old head on young shoulders.

Sol.301.(a) Time after time - repeatedly.

Sol.302.(b) Rachit had some important work and so he cancelled the show tickets for everyone.

Dog in the manger - a person who prevents others from having something they cannot use.

Sol.303.(d)

Pacing up and down - walking back and forth due to anxiety or impatience.

Sol.304.(c) Time and again - repeatedly.

Sol.305.(a) Going through a sticky patch - to experience a bad period in life.

E.g.- My friend is going through a sticky patch at work, but I'm sure things will get better soon.

Sol.306.(d) A sting in the tail - an unexpected, typically unpleasant or problematic end to something.

E.g.- The movie seemed fun at first, but it had a sting in the tail when the main character died unexpectedly.

Sol.307.(a) The silver lining in the cloud - a positive aspect or hopeful side of a difficult or negative situation.

Sol.308.(d) Out of the frying pan and into the fire - things going from bad to worse

E.g.- When he changed jobs to escape stress, he found himself out of the frying pan and into the fire with an even tougher boss.

Sol.309.(c) Apple-pie order - very neatly arranged.

Sol.310.(b) To throw dust in one's eyes - to mislead someone by tricks

E.g.- The salesman tried to throw dust in our eyes with false promises about the product.

Sol.311.(c) Bury the hatchet - to make peace or end a conflict.

Sol.312.(b)

By leaps and bounds - rapidly.

E.g.- Her business is growing by leaps and bounds this year.

Sol.313.(c)

Yeoman's service - excellent work done.

Ex. - The teacher did yeoman's service by staying late to help students with their projects.

Sol.314.(a) He was on thin ice after making a controversial statement.

Skating on thin ice - doing something risky which may have serious consequences.

Sol.315.(b) Be in seventh heaven - to be in a state of extreme happiness.

E.g.- She was in seventh heaven when she got her dream job.

Sol.316.(a) Be in a tight corner - in a difficult situation.

Sol.317.(b) At the drop of a hat - immediately.

Sol.318.(c) Go down in flames - to fail spectacularly.

E.g.- The project went down in flames after the team missed all their deadlines.

Sol.319.(a) Stand by someone - support in difficult situation.

Sol.320.(d)

Blue blood - aristocratic lineage.

Sol.321.(a) An elephant in the room - there is an obvious problem.

Sol.322.(b) Down to earth - realistic and practical.

Sol.323.(b) To take a rain check - to politely decline with the implication that they may come at a later date.

Sol.324.(d) Strike while the iron is hot - make use of an opportunity immediately.

Sol.325.(b) His heart is in the right place - good natured.

Sol.326.(d) up in a creek without a paddle - in a difficult situation with no clear way out.

Sol.327.(d) To leave no stone unturned - to do everything possible to achieve something

E.g.- The detectives left no stone unturned to solve the mystery.

Sol.328.(a) building castles in the air - thinking of some impossible task.

Sol.329.(c) Bowl of cherries - wonderful and pleasant.

Sol.330.(d) Beat around the bush - to avoid talking about what is important.

E.g.- Instead of giving me a direct answer, he kept beating around the bush, avoiding the real issue.

Sol.331.(d) A slap on the wrist - a very mild punishment.

Sol.332.(c) nerves of steel - an absence of fear or anxiety

Sol.333.(a) Between the devil and the deep blue sea - to be in dilemma to choose.

Sol.334.(c) He had his head in the clouds during an important meeting.

'Have your head in the clouds' is an idiom which means someone is not paying attention. Going through the options, the sentence given in option (c) correctly uses the idiom. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.335.(d) tighten his belt - to spend less and live more carefully.

Sol.336.(a) A bird's eye view - a clear impression of what is happening.

Sol.337.(a) When pigs fly - something that will never happen.

E.g.- It will snow in the desert when pigs fly.

Sol.338.(a)

Sacred cow - unquestionable.

E.g.- In their family, the old traditions are treated like a sacred cow.

Sol.339.(a) Black sheep - disreputable.

E.g.- He is the black sheep of the family because he always gets into trouble.

Sol.340.(c)

High and dry - in a difficult situation.

Sol.341.(d) Get itchy feet - to start to want to travel or do something different.

E.g.- After a few months in one place, she started to get itchy feet and wanted to travel again.

Sol.342.(d)

On thin ice - in a risky position.

E.g.- She knew she was on thin ice when she missed another deadline.

Sol.343.(c) Bread and butter - livelihood.

E.g.- Writing novels became his bread and butter after he left his job.

Sol.344.(d) Keep a level head - remain calm and composed.

Sol.345.(a) Keep your pants on - to keep calm and quiet.

E.g.- Keep your pants on! The movie will start in just a few minutes.

Sol.346.(a) Nip in the bud - to suppress something at an early stage.

E.g.- Let's nip this problem in the bud before it gets worse.

Sol.347.(a) The ball is now in their court

- it is time for someone to deal with a problem or make decision, because other people have already done as much as they can.

Sol.348.(d) From cradle to grave - during the whole span of one's life.

E.g.- The company provides healthcare services from cradle to grave.

Sol.349.(d)

Chip on the shoulder- offended.

E.g.- He has a chip on his shoulder because he wasn't chosen for the team.

Sol.350.(a)

See eye to eye - to agree with someone.

E.g.- My brother and I always see eye to eye on everything.

Sol.351.(b) captivating expertise

'Captivating' means holding your attention by being extremely interesting,

exciting, pleasant, or attractive. 'Expertise' means a high level of knowledge or skill. The given sentence states that his captivating expertise of the English language allowed him to write eloquently. Hence, 'captivating expertise' is the most appropriate answer.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp) Questions (352 to 442)

Q.352. Select the phrase/idiom that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence.

When our principal said she was leaving the company, I played out the opportunity to fill the job.

- (a) glided at the opportunity
- (b) ran to the opportunity
- (c) started at the opportunity
- (d) jumped at the opportunity

Q.353. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined word in the given idiom.

At the last hour

- (a) twelfth
- (b) eleventh
- (c) sixth
- (d) half

Q.354. The best of both worlds

- (a) Everyone gets a chance
- (b) Stay strong in a difficult situation
- (c) Do a perfectly good job
- (d) Good in every way

Q.355. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

The team always _____ to come up with unique advertisements for all its clients

- (a) thinks outside the box
- (b) throw caution to the winds
- (c) take a back seat
- (d) turn the tables

Q.356. Back to back

- (a) Present and discuss the details of something.
- (b) Try to get something.
- (c) Something follows immediately after something else.
- (d) Do something very fast or with great energy.

Q.357. Make waves

- (a) To have patience
- (b) To cause difficulty
- (c) To take it easy
- (d) To give up

Q.358. Up the ante

- (a) Mediocre
- (b) Increase demands
- (c) Expensive
- (d) Cost cutting

Q.359. Select the most appropriate

meaning of the underlined segment in the following sentence.

Don't you think that the cat's in the cradle? You never make time for me.

- (a) Busy in your work
- (b) Complicated relationship
- (c) Busy in minting money
- (d) Newly married life

Q.360. In the following question a sentence has been given with a blank. You are required to choose the correct idiom to fill in the blank.

I'm _____ until my family arrives from their holiday. I cannot wait to see them.

- (a) counting down the days
- (b) bearing the gift of the gab
- (c) losing ground
- (d) getting myself into a mess

Q.361. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

_____, French was the most difficult language for Shruti.

- (a) Bear out
- (b) By far
- (c) Break into
- (d) Be in the air

Q.362. A snake in the grass

- (a) A worthless person
- (b) A secret or hidden enemy
- (c) A man of ability
- (d) A man with a straightforward attitude

Q.363. All Greek to me

- (a) Something that is not understandable
- (b) Something that is ancient and classic
- (c) Something that is harmful to all
- (d) Something that is fancy and classy

Q.364. Select the sentence that uses the given idiom correctly.

Eat like a bird

- (a) Nobody can eat with Jerry at the same table as he is so messy.
- (b) The colonial powers colonised small countries by exploiting them and stealing their resources.
- (c) Pinky is on a diet so she is too picky about the food she eats.
- (d) Overeating is the most obvious reason for gaining weight quickly.

Q.365. Apple of discord

- (a) Solution of dispute
- (b) Matter of dispute
- (c) Cause of happiness
- (d) Disruption of communication

Q.366. Based on the situation in the sentence, select the most appropriate idiom.

Although Greta Thunberg gave a moving speech at the UN about environmental damage, it could _____.

- (a) break the ice
- (b) cut no ice

- (c) walk on thin ice
(d) be the icing on the cake

Q.367. No one even thought that Sheila's success would burst the bubble.

- (a) Suddenly end
(b) Change her into arrogance
(c) Break the border
(d) Last for ever

Q.368. Select the most appropriate idiomatic expression that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

He wanted to be a professional basketball player but given his height, luck was against him.

- (a) the cards were stacked against him
(b) his health was not in his favour
(c) his principles were against him
(d) the ball was against him

Q.369. Select the idiom that means the same as the underlined segment in the given sentence.

She forgot to apply for her internship abroad due to the ongoing marriage preparations she had to help with and now that opportunity is lost.

- (a) Missing the boat
(b) Burning the midnight oil
(c) Beat about the bush
(d) Treading on thin ice

Q.370. The boss of our organisation is considered a jack of all trades.

- (a) Knowing nothing but boasting
(b) Doing several different jobs instead of specialising in one
(c) Engaged in gambling
(d) Innocence about everything

Q.371. The employees made a noticeable hue and cry to get their demands raised to the board of Directors.

- (a) Celebrate an event
(b) Participate in sports
(c) Lie lifeless
(d) Protest something

Q.372. Select the idiom that gives the most appropriate meaning of the underlined phrase in the following sentence.

Our Principal looked disappointed when no one expressed the willingness to join the trip.

- (a) Pulled a long face
(b) Made a comeback
(c) High and dry
(d) Gave a single shot

Q.373. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

I know you have been really busy with your work, but can you just give me a few minutes?

- (a) snowed under
(b) through thick and thin
(c) jumped on the bandwagon
(d) on cloud nine

Q.374. To make both ends meet

- (a) To take back what you have said
(b) To anticipate
(c) To live within one's income
(d) Quite worthless

Q.375. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

We have been at fours and fives in the office due to network issues.

- (a) At nines and tens
(b) At sixes and sevens
(c) At threes and fours
(d) At eights and nines

Q.376. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

I know you're blaming me for all that has happened but I wasn't at fault alone.

- (a) it is always darkest before the dawn
(b) make hay while the sun shines
(c) leave no stone unturned
(d) it takes two to tango

Q.377. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

Sharon doing the work all by herself? Seems like it is possible, but is very unlikely to happen.

- (a) pie in the sky (b) a piece of cake
(c) a bad egg (d) bent out of shape

Q.378. We should teach our wards not to look down upon anybody in human society.

- (a) Talk leniently
(b) Kneel down
(c) Guess on something
(d) Despise somebody

Q.379. Everybody was surprised to see that he fell flat even after arduous efforts.

- (a) Win a difficult race
(b) Succeed without hassles
(c) Fall from a height
(d) Fail to win applause

Q.380. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

His old car has become a financial burden on him now.

- (a) A white elephant
(b) An apple of one's eye

- (c) An eyesore
(d) A rare bird

Q.381. Many unavoidable situations were avoided only because someone had our back.

- (a) In consultation (b) Without help
(c) To support (d) Within reach

Q.382. Midhuna was nineteen years old, too young to buy the farm.

- (a) Own a property (b) Possess anything
(c) Stop living (d) Spend money

Q.383. Select the most appropriate idiom that best explains the given sentence.

I was unable to solve the geometry question myself. So, I have asked my teacher to help me out.

- (a) You can't always get what you want.
(b) Two heads are better than one.
(c) When the going gets tough, the tough gets going.
(d) Two wrongs don't make a right.

Q.384. Select the sentence that gives the most appropriate meaning of the idiom 'In hot water'.

- (a) The chef added spices to the dish to enhance its flavour and make it more delicious.
(b) The children enjoyed playing in the pool on a hot summer day.
(c) After accidentally breaking the valuable vase, Sarah found herself in trouble with her parents.
(d) The company faced challenges due to the economic downturn but managed to overcome them.

Q.385. 'Keep your chin up'.

- (a) The students diligently completed their homework assignments before the deadline.
(b) Despite facing setbacks, she remained positive and determined to achieve her goals.
(c) The hiker enjoyed the breathtaking view from the mountaintop, taking in the natural beauty.
(d) The scientist conducted experiments and gathered data to support his research hypothesis.

Q.386. Select the most appropriate option that best expresses the meaning of the proverb in the given sentence.

The salesperson for the project offered a sneak peek of the project as we expressed our interest in the area and amenities.

- (a) Getting a preview of something
(b) To try something new
(c) Sending a brief letter
(d) To be in a winning position

Q.387. bring to book

- (a) punish someone (b) teach someone
(c) calm someone (d) support someone

Q.388. bad blood

- (a) hostility between people
(b) family of ill - repute
(c) poor blood circulation
(d) felling of brotherhood

Q.389. a mare's nest

- (a) a familiar situation
(b) a new situation
(c) a refreshing situation
(d) a confused situation

Q.390. Rock the boat

- (a) divert someone's attention
(b) overcome a difficult situation
(c) disturb a stable situation
(d) pester and irritate someone

Q.391. have your heart in your mouth

- (a) to get worse and worse
(b) to be extremely frightened
(c) to be extremely jealous
(d) to behave in a foolish manner

Q.392. forty winks

- (a) a short sleep (b) a deep sleep
(c) a secret signal (d) a long leave

Q.393. cut from the same cloth

- (a) to be of a similar nature
(b) to come from the same source
(c) to share resources
(d) belong to the same family

Q.394. Bite the bullet

- (a) The children played in the park on a sunny day.
(b) Despite the pain, Sarah decided to go ahead with the surgery.
(c) The chef prepared a delicious meal for the guests.
(d) Jack and Jill went up the hill to fetch a pail of water.

Q.395. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

Despite their differences, the two politicians decided to _____ and work together for the greater good.

- (a) bury the hatchet
(b) burn the midnight oil
(c) bark up the wrong tree
(d) blow off steam

Q.396. We dodged a bullet when we didn't fall for the agents' words.

- (a) To be out of your comfort zone
(b) To give something a try
(c) To narrowly avoid situation
(d) To start performing better

Q.397. Bend over backwards

- (a) Working hard to try to impress

- (b) Going backward
(c) Using wrongful means
(d) Working slowly and lazily

Q.398. I hate to get off on the wrong foot.

- (a) To start a relationship or activity badly
(b) To start something with an injury on the wrong foot
(c) To start something with neutral factors
(d) To start something with positive factors

Q.399. A leopard can't change his spots

- (a) A visual presentation is far more descriptive than words
(b) Something good that isn't recognised at first
(c) You cannot change who you are
(d) Someone who is cherished above all others

Q.400. More people in Turkey are on the breadline now than thirty years ago.

- (a) Earn a lot of money
(b) Be very expensive
(c) Be very poor
(d) Are well educated

Q.401. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

All my efforts went in vain. The project on which I was working for the last two months has failed and we are _____.

- (a) around the bend
(b) back to square one
(c) all in the seventh heaven
(d) on the fly

Q.402. Crack someone up

- (a) To criticise someone
(b) To make someone angry
(c) To make someone laugh
(d) To force someone to commit a mistake

Q.403. What a small world!

- (a) What a coincidence!
(b) What a beautiful place!
(c) The world is a village.
(d) The world is great.

Q.404. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Any sort of unfair conduct is not tolerated in international sports tournaments as it can completely ruin an athlete's career.

- (a) hand in the mud (b) straw in the eye
(c) red handed (d) foul play

Q.405. Select the correct idiom that can substitute the italicised group of words in the given sentence.

He really stinks and *smells foul* after a hard session at the gym.

- (a) lame excuse (b) pen and ink
(c) an iron will (d) an old flame

Q.406. Choose the most suitable idiom for the given situation.

Ravi has a strong desire to be in college hockey team this year and he is working hard to gain such skills to fulfill his goal of life. He has clearly made up his mind to achieve his target.

- (a) Set sights on
(b) To move the goal posts
(c) To rise to the occasion
(d) To make the cut

Q.407. Select the most appropriate idiom or phrase to complete the given sentence. I like her because she never likes to make _____.

- (a) a drop in the bucket (b) a quick buck
(c) a slap on the wrist (d) a bed of roses

Q.408. Grasping at straws

- (a) Trying to find the best way to compete with others when nothing you choose is likely to work
(b) Trying to find some way to succeed when nothing you choose is likely to work
(c) Trying to find some way to succeed when you see others are also doing the same
(d) Trying to find manipulative ways to succeed

Q.409. You cannot throw dust into my eyes.

- (a) hurt me (b) terrify me
(c) abuse me (d) mislead or deceive me

Q.410. A plum job

- (a) A difficult job
(b) A rare job
(c) A job involving extensive travelling
(d) An easy and pleasant job

Q.411. Face the music

- (a) To work every possible way to succeed
(b) To be cheated by someone you trust
(c) To have the problems with money
(d) To accept punishment for some mistake which you have done

Q.412. Ram could not go to Delhi for vacation since he was banking on his arrears of pay which he did not get in time.

- (a) Calling on (b) Sloping on
(c) Relying on (d) Depending on his bank

Q.413. Select the most appropriate idiomatic expression to fill in the blank.

Our Director took a meeting and asked us to express our views on _____ of the new

HR policy.

- (a) the pros and cons
- (b) the ups and downs
- (c) the bandwagon
- (d) the hook

Q.414. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

He got a **burst of energy**, and started digging again.

- (a) took bull by the horns
- (b) a fancy of someone
- (c) heart on the sleeve
- (d) second wind

Q.415. Right now, **my hands are full**.

- (a) My hands are swollen
- (b) I'm very tired
- (c) I'm very busy
- (d) My hands are filled up

Q.416. Boil the ocean

- (a) Try to do something impossible
- (b) To make someone very angry
- (c) Something which gets hot gradually
- (d) Something very big

Q.417. We've sent a very strong protest letter. That should make them sit up and **take notice**.

- (a) Observe (b) Attend
- (c) Follow (d) Consider

Q.418. Burn one's bridges

- (a) Impossible to return to an earlier state
- (b) Having an overnight success
- (c) Working very hard
- (d) Attack on one's enemy

Q.419. Select the most appropriate idiomatic expression to substitute for the underlined segment in the given sentence.

I had **to work late in the night** for nearly three months to write my first book.

- (a) to take a back seat
- (b) to blow a fuse
- (c) to look through coloured glasses
- (d) to burn the midnight oil

Q.420. You must **lie in the bed you have made**.

- (a) Sleep on the bed you made yourself
- (b) Sleep in your own bed
- (c) Be contended always
- (d) Face the unpleasant consequences of your own acts

Q.421. Open your heart

- (a) Immediately think of something
- (b) Feel relieved because the stress is removed
- (c) Could do something very easily
- (d) Share your deepest feelings

Q.422. The office management was **in dire straits** after the financial crash.

- (a) Being direct or fair
- (b) To be extremely happy
- (c) In a very bad situation
- (d) To walk on already trodden paths

Q.423. Choose the idiom that can best substitute the underlined part of the given sentence.

Shelley **ignored** her father's wish of studying arts and instead took admission in commerce.

- (a) Beyond the pale (b) Bid defiance to
- (c) Blew over (d) Big fish

Q.424. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

He started with an online company and became a millionaire. Then, he sold it and invested in the share market and earned more money. Now, he has invested in the transportation industry and is generating huge wealth. What does he have?

- (a) Sticky fingers
- (b) As genuine as a three-dollar bill
- (c) Rule of thumb
- (d) Midas touch

Q.425. A snowball effect

- (a) Cold and uncomfortable
- (b) Slow movement
- (c) Trick someone completely
- (d) An accelerating growth of magnitude

Q.426. What we need is skilled and energetic planning and **elbow grease**.

- (a) Hard work that one puts into doing something
- (b) Hard work that one puts into cleaning one's elbow
- (c) The grease that is earned through labour
- (d) Hard work that one puts into removing grease

Q.427. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Do you believe that you **have a possibility** of getting that job ?

- (a) shoot the breeze (b) snow job
- (c) spill the beans (d) stand a chance

Q.428. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation focusing on the underlined segment.

The modern era statistics data **provides useful advantage** to the players at competent level.

- (a) Play it by ear
- (b) Put something on ice
- (c) Grist to the mill
- (d) Cost an arm and a leg

Q.429. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

At some point in the past, there were rows of temporary shops that used to display various cooking utensils.

- (a) In the past few years
- (b) Long ago
- (c) Before now
- (d) Once upon a time

Q.430. Steer clear of

- (a) Loose temper and react furiously to someone
- (b) Avoid someone or something because it is dangerous for you
- (c) Be kind and empathetic to someone
- (d) Show someone how to do a job or activity

Q.431. He ate the whole bunch of grapes **under the nose** of all of us.

- (a) After much persuasion
- (b) Sharing equally
- (c) In full view of somebody
- (d) Secretly

Q.432. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

You wanted to speak but you controlled yourself and became patient. What have you done?

- (a) Pin drop silence (b) Dragged your feet
- (c) Herculean task (d) Hold your horses

Q.433. Step up to the plate

- (a) Take control of a situation
- (b) Plan for better performance
- (c) Implement a plan
- (d) Think about a crisis

Q.434. Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom in the given sentence.

Nancy held a grudge against her teacher for a long time, but she finally decided to **let bygones be bygones**.

- (a) Ignore the past (b) Change the past
- (c) Flatter someone (d) Take revenge

Q.435. Choose the option which means the same as the underlined segment.

The boss wanted to **finish** the case before the arrival of the Inspection team.

- (a) be over one's head
- (b) be over and done with
- (c) be over and over
- (d) be over a barrel

Q.436. Yamini is a great singer. She will **make it big** one day.

- (a) Migrate and settle
- (b) Educated and rich
- (c) Succeed and become famous
- (d) Become financially sound



Q.437. Come what may

- (a) No matter what happens
- (b) To get frightened
- (c) Meeting someone
- (d) To be among the latest

Q.438. Christy should discuss this with her **face to face**.

- (a) Remained normal and realistic
- (b) Almost always
- (c) With another person in their presence rather than, say, by phone or letter
- (d) Come to fully accept or understand something

Q.439. Fit as a fiddle

- (a) In good health
- (b) To ignore what someone is saying
- (c) To betray a close person
- (d) At the last moment

Q.440. Hear someone out

- (a) Dismiss someone from listening to you
- (b) Keep someone out
- (c) Hear from far away
- (d) Let someone complete what they are saying

Q.441. Pull yourself together

- (a) Feel agitated
- (b) Discourage the orphans
- (c) Calm down after an upsetting incident
- (d) Encourage the rich

Q.442. Bite your tongue

- (a) To avoid saying something
- (b) To have something explored
- (c) To scold someone verbally
- (d) To drink very heavily

Solutions :-

Sol.352.(d) jumped at the opportunity
The idiom 'jump at the opportunity' means to quickly take advantage of an opportunity. Hence, 'jumped at the opportunity' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.353.(b) At the eleventh hour - in the last moment.
E.g.- He finished his homework at the eleventh hour, just before the deadline.

Sol.354.(d) The best of both worlds - good in every way.
E.g.- By working from home, she gets the best of both worlds—spending time with her family and still having a successful career.

Sol.355.(a) thinks outside the box- to think creatively and innovatively, often by looking at a problem from a different perspective.

Sol.356.(c) Back to back - Something follows immediately after something else.

E.g.- The team had back-to-back meetings all afternoon.

Sol.357.(b) Make waves - to cause difficulty.

E.g.- He didn't want to make waves at work, so he kept quiet about the issue.

Sol.358.(b) Up the ante- increase demands.

E.g.- To win the contract, the company had to up the ante with a better offer.

Sol.359.(b) Cat's in the cradle - complicated relationship.

Sol.360.(a) Counting down the days - to be waiting eagerly for something to happen.

Sol.361.(b) By far

'By far' means a lot more than something. The given sentence states that by far French was the most difficult language for Shruti. Hence, 'By far' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.362.(b) A snake in the grass - a secret or hidden enemy.

E.g.- I thought he was my friend, but his betrayal showed he was just a snake in the grass.

Sol.363.(a) All greek to me - something that is not understandable.

E.g.- When she started explaining her advanced math homework, I realized it was all Greek to me.

Sol.364.(c) Pinky is on a diet so she is too picky about the food she eats.

The idiom '**eat like a bird**' means have a very small appetite. Going through the options, sentence given in option (c) has the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.

Sol.365.(b) Apple of discord - matter of dispute.

E.g.- The promotion became an apple of discord among the team members, as everyone believed they deserved it.

Sol.366.(b)

Cut no ice - have no influence or effect.

Sol.367.(a) Burst the bubble - suddenly end.

Sol.368.(a) The cards were stacked against him - luck was against him.

Sol.369.(a)

Missing the boat - opportunity is lost.

Sol.370.(b) A jack of all trades - doing several different jobs instead of specialising in one.

Sol.371.(d)

Hue and cry - protest something.

Sol.372.(a)

Pulled a long face - looked disappointed.

Sol.373.(a) Snowed under - really busy.

Sol.374.(c) To make both ends meet - to live within one's income.

E.g.- It's hard for some families to make both ends meet with rising expenses.

Sol.375.(b) At sixes and sevens

'At sixes and sevens' is an idiom which means in a badly organised or difficult situation. The given passage states that we have been in a difficult situation due to network issues. Hence, 'at sixes and sevens' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.376 .(d) It takes two to tango - I wasn't at fault alone.

Sol.377.(a) Pie in the sky - possible, but is very unlikely to happen.

Sol.378.(d)

look down upon - despise somebody.

Sol.379.(d)

Fell flat - failed to win applause.

Sol.380.(a)

A white elephant - a financial burden.

Sol.381.(c) Had our back - to support.

Sol.382.(c) Buy the farm- stop living.

Sol.383.(b) Two heads are better than one - Two people can usually solve a problem more easily than one person.

Sol.384.(c) After accidentally breaking the valuable vase, Sarah found herself in trouble with her parents.

The idiom 'in hot water' means in a difficult situation in which you are likely to be punished.

Sol.385.(b) Despite facing setbacks, she remained positive and determined to achieve her goals.

The idiom 'keep your chin up' means to stay cheerful and hopeful.

Sol.386.(a) Getting a preview of something- to describe something or be shown before it officially begins.

Sol.387.(a)

Bring to book - punish someone.

E.g.- After causing trouble at school, Tom was brought to book by the principal.

Sol.388.(a)

Bad blood - hostility between people.

E.g.- The argument about the car created bad blood between the neighbors.

Sol.389.(d)

A mare's nest - a confused situation.

E.g.- Finding a solution to the complex math problem turned out to be a mare's nest for the students.

Sol.390.(c) Rock the boat - disturb a stable situation.

E.g.- I don't want to rock the boat, but I think we need to discuss the project deadline.

Sol.391.(b) Have your heart in your mouth - to be extremely frightened.

E.g.- As she approached the edge of the cliff, her heart was in her mouth.

Sol.392.(a) Forty winks - a short sleep.

E.g.- After a long day at work, he decided to take forty winks on the sofa.

Sol.393.(a) Cut from the same cloth - to be of a similar nature.

E.g.- Rohan and Raj, both passionate about art and literature, are cut from the same cloth.

Sol.394.(b) Despite the pain, Sarah decided to go ahead with the surgery. The idiom 'bite the bullet' means to force yourself to do something unpleasant or difficult. Going through the options, the sentence given in option (b) has the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.

Sol.395.(a) Bury the hatchet - to agree to end the disagreement that has divided two people or groups.

Sol.396.(c) Dodged a bullet - to narrowly avoid the situation.

Sol.397.(a) Bend over backwards - working hard to try to impress.

Sol.398.(a) get off on the wrong foot - to start a relationship or activity badly.

Sol.399.(c) A leopard can't change his spots - you cannot change who you are. E.g.- No matter how hard he tries to be organized, his desk is always a mess. A leopard can't change his spots.

Sol.400.(c)

on the breadline - be very poor.

Sol.401.(b) back to square one

Back to square one means to start over. The given sentence states that the project on which I was working for the last two months has failed and we are

back to square one. Hence, 'back to square one' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.402.(c) Crack someone up - to make someone laugh.

Sol.403.(a) What a small world! - what a coincidence!

E.g.- I bumped into my childhood friend while on vacation in a remote village. What a small world!

Sol.404.(d) foul play - unfair conduct.

Sol.405.(b) Pen and ink - smells foul

Sol.406.(a) Set sights on - to decide that you want something and to try very hard to get it.

Sol.407.(b) a quick buck

A quick buck means easily and quickly earned money. The given sentence states that I like her because she never likes to make a quick buck. Hence, 'a quick buck' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.408.(b) Grasping at straws - trying to find some way to succeed when nothing you choose is likely to work.

E.g.- The detective was grasping at straws, hoping for a breakthrough in the unsolved case.

Sol.409.(d) throw dust into my eyes - mislead or deceive me.

Sol.410.(d)

A plum job - an easy and pleasant job.

E.g.- Getting to travel the world and write about it for a living is a plum job for a travel writer.

Sol.411.(d) Face the music - to accept punishment for some mistake which you have done.

E.g.- After breaking the vase, I knew I had to face the music when my parents found out.

Sol.412.(c) relying on

The phrase 'banking on' means relying on. The given sentence states that Ram could not go to Delhi for vacation since he was banking on his arrears of pay which he did not get in time. Hence, 'relying on' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.413.(a)

The pros and cons - the advantages and disadvantages of something.

Sol.414.(d)

Second wind - a burst of energy.

Sol.415.(c)

My hands are full - I'm very busy.

Sol.416.(a) Boil the ocean - try to do something impossible.

E.g.- Completing the entire project in just one day is like boiling the ocean. It's simply impossible.

Sol.417.(d) Take notice - consider.

Sol.418.(a) Burn one's bridges - impossible to return to an earlier state.

E.g.- He burned his bridges with his former business partners when he cheated them.

Sol.419.(d) To burn the midnight oil - to work late in the night.

Sol.420.(d) Lie in the bed you have made - face the unpleasant consequences of your own acts.

Sol.421.(d) Open your heart - share your deepest feelings.

E.g.- When you're facing difficulties, don't be afraid to open your heart and talk to a friend about your feelings.

Sol.422.(c) in dire straits - in a very bad situation.

Sol.423.(b) Bid defiance to - ignore or to offer resistance.

Sol.424.(d) Midas touch - the ability to make money out of anything one undertakes.

Sol.425.(d) A snowball effect - an accelerating growth of magnitude.

E.g.- The viral video's popularity had a snowball effect, leading to millions of views and countless shares in just a few days.

Sol.426.(a) Elbow grease - hard work that one puts into doing something.

Sol.427.(d)

Stand a chance - have a possibility.

Sol.428.(c) Grist to the mill - provides useful advantage.

Sol.429.(b) Long ago

The phrase 'long ago' means at a time in the distant past, which is synonymous with the phrase 'at some point in the past'. Hence, 'long ago' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.430.(b) Steer clear of - avoid someone or something because it is dangerous for you.

E.g.- After hearing about the recent increase in car thefts, she decided to steer clear of parking her vehicle in that area.

Sol.431.(c) Under the nose - in full view of somebody.

Sol.432.(d) Hold your horses - to be patient and stop making hasty decisions.

Sol.433.(a) Step up to the plate - take control of a situation.

E.g.- When the team needed a leader, he was ready to step up to the plate and guide them through the challenging project.

Sol.434.(a) Let bygones be bygones - ignore the past.

Sol.435.(b) Be over and done with - finish.

Sol.436.(c) Make it big - succeed and become famous.

Sol.437.(a) Come what may - no matter what happens.

E.g.- Despite the stormy weather forecast, they were determined to have a picnic in the park, come what may.

Sol.438.(c) Face to face - with another person in their presence rather than, say, by phone or letter.

Sol.439.(a)

Fit as a fiddle - in good health.

E.g.- Despite his age, he's still as fit as a fiddle and can run marathons without any trouble.

Sol.440.(d) Hear someone out - let someone complete what they are saying.

E.g.- Before making a decision, it's important to hear someone out to understand their perspective.

Sol.441.(c) Pull yourself together - calm down after an upsetting incident.

E.g.- After receiving the unexpected news, he had to pull himself together to face the challenges ahead.

Sol.442.(a) Bite your tongue - to avoid saying something.

E.g.- I wanted to tell her she was wrong, but I had to bite my tongue to avoid an argument.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp) Questions (443 to 533)

Q.443. To let the cat out of the bag

- (a) To reveal a secret (b) To hide the truth
(c) To be in a hurry (d) To be careful

Q.444. I did not even listen to him; he was only talking through his hat.

- (a) Talking ignorantly

- (b) Talking non-stop
(c) Talking garrulously
(d) Talking nonsense

Q.445. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank and complete the meaning of the sentence.

Most of the ministers are concerned with the ____ of office than the service of man.

- (a) leaps and bounds (b) wear and tear
(c) loaves and fishes (d) Herculean task

Q.446. Replace the underlined segment with the most appropriate idiom/phrase from the following options.

This is the critical point of the issue. One should always be focused on it.

- (a) A black sheep
(b) The crux of the matter
(c) Chip off the old block
(d) Don't cry over spilt milk

Q.447. Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom in the given sentence.

She said she liked my hair, but it turned out to be **a left handed compliment**.

- (a) A joke (b) A flattery
(c) A praise (d) An insult

Q.448. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

The team leader tried to remain positive or optimistic in the situation, even though they were facing tough competition and limited resources.

- (a) to put a strong desire in front of
(b) to put on a strong exterior
(c) to put a brave face on
(d) to put a strong hand forward

Q.449. He was carried off his feet when he was declared to have won the prize.

- (a) Was dizzy
(b) Was wild with excitement
(c) Danced on his toes
(d) Became delirious

Q.450. The new routine will suit you to a T.

- (a) nicely (b) a little bit
(c) very poorly (d) exactly

Q.451. Call the shots

- (a) To be a follower that makes less important decision
(b) To be in a position to make decisions that influences a situation
(c) To be in a powerless position that follows orders
(d) To be in a neutral position

Q.452. Cup of tea

- (a) Long held desire
(b) A cup brimming with tea
(c) Favourite pastime

- (d) Something one likes/excels in

Q.453. The council president is known to play devil's advocate often.

- (a) To allow others to rise
(b) To play risky games
(c) To argue, just for the sake of it
(d) Make one's own destiny

Q.454. The executives were running around in circles, without any success.

- (a) Achieving maximum mileage
(b) Suffering huge profits and losses
(c) Successfully accomplishing the target
(d) Putting efforts into something that does not give a worthwhile result

Q.455. Barking up the wrong tree

- (a) Provoke trouble
(b) To make a bad situation worse
(c) Getting a good start is important
(d) To be mistaken, to be looking for solutions in the wrong place

Q.456. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following sentence.

Shweta organises the sale of handmade pottery at a cheap rate.

- (a) Hush money
(b) Go for a song
(c) Having one's cake and eating it too
(d) Making a fuss out of something

Q.457. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

Rajat is known for his notorious nature. He will be friendly to your face but likes_____.

- (a) to blow his trumpet
(b) to stab you in the back
(c) to paint the whole town red
(d) to get all bent out of the shape

Q.458. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

The play I saw last night was a _____.

- (a) hit the road (b) hit the hay
(c) smash hit (d) hit the roof

Q.459. To cut someone some slack

- (a) Avoid talking about problems till the very end
(b) To get the conversation going
(c) To criticise someone very strictly
(d) To not manage someone very strictly or critically

Q.460. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

Our trainer asked for _____ on her for the next informative session.

- (a) chasing rainbows
(b) being around the bend
(c) all eyes and ears
(d) going bananas

Q.461. The actor decided to live life in the fast lane.

- (a) Dropping charges of crime
- (b) A life filled with excitement
- (c) Racing away to the moon
- (d) A life of extreme speed

Q.462. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

I asked my friend to _____ against her employers who are doing wrong to her.

- (a) fine words butter no parsnips
- (b) finders keepers, losers weepers
- (c) fight the good fight
- (d) fight fire with fire

Q.463. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

Jane, please don't tell me fairy tales; I just want to know the real matter _____.

- (a) in the cold
- (b) in a fortnight
- (c) in the long run
- (d) in a nutshell

Q.464. The shopkeeper was sly as a fox and tried to sell off the old stock.

- (a) smart and clever
- (b) slow
- (c) suspicious
- (d) in confusion or disagreement

Q.465. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

I don't think you should go out in the rain, it's _____.

- (a) rain on cats and dogs
- (b) storming cats and dogs
- (c) raining cats and dogs
- (d) raining dogs and puppies

Q.466. To keep one's temper

- (a) To meet with disaster
- (b) To become impatient
- (c) To become angry
- (d) To remain calm

Q.467. Get your act together

- (a) To have patience
- (b) To stay together
- (c) To act in a play
- (d) Get organised and do things better

Q.468. Be like chalk and cheese

- (a) To be completely different from each other
- (b) To be very similar to each other
- (c) To have a close relation with another person
- (d) To be distantly related to each other

Q.469. Select the most appropriate idiom from the given options to fill in the blank. Greta Thunberg _____ when she dared to question about accountability with respect to global warming and climate change.

- (a) sowed wild oats

- (b) kept the pot boiling
- (c) gave the devil his due
- (d) hit the nail on the head

Q.470. Select the most appropriate idiom from the given options to fill in the blank. Being a journalist, your first duty is to _____ or else your colleagues might surpass you.

- (a) eat a humble pie
- (b) have an axe to grind
- (c) build castles in the air
- (d) keep your ear to the ground

Q.471. As phony as a three-dollar bill

- (a) Something that is attractive
- (b) Something that is genuine
- (c) Something that is disgusting
- (d) Something that is fake

Q.472. He was on cloud nine when he got admission in Cambridge University.

- (a) involved in useless journey
- (b) very happy
- (c) unsettled
- (d) available to be called to go to work

Q.473. From scratch

- (a) From a skin disease
- (b) From the beginning
- (c) From utter disorder
- (d) From death

Q.474. The detective went the whole nine yards in his investigation.

- (a) Measuring every step
- (b) Everything, all the way
- (c) Close affinity with the law
- (d) Taking the distant call

Q.475. "Do not turn a blind eye to all the mischief your child is up to", the teacher told the young parent.

- (a) Close the door
- (b) Take pride in
- (c) Give rewards
- (d) Pretend not to notice

Q.476. Have egg on your face

- (a) Defeat someone thoroughly
- (b) To be made to look foolish or embarrassed
- (c) Making a choice between two unpleasant choices
- (d) Reveal a secret

Q.477. Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Our team is all on the same page when it comes to our goals for the upcoming project.

- (a) Be confused
- (b) Be in agreement
- (c) Be unsure
- (d) Be in conflict

Q.478. Bite the dust

- (a) To suffer a defeat
- (b) To fall from a height
- (c) To remain calm

- (d) To fall asleep

Q.479. A man of character, he stuck to his guns even in the most difficult situations.

- (a) To do things that would please people
- (b) To behave disrespectfully
- (c) To find a treasure
- (d) To stand firm against all difficulties and challenges

Q.480. Riddhi believes in wearing her heart on her sleeve. That is why she has so many friends.

- (a) To criticise everybody
- (b) To wear a badge of honour
- (c) To openly and freely express one's emotions
- (d) To talk aloud

Q.481. To cross swords

- (a) To kill
- (b) To arrange
- (c) To fight
- (d) To defend

Q.482. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

The deal was _____ for three months.

- (a) cut no ice
- (b) broken the ice
- (c) tipped of the iceberg
- (d) put on ice

Q.483. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

You are an intellectual with a professional degree; you can do wonders as _____.

- (a) you are playing with fire
- (b) you can say it again
- (c) your mileage may vary
- (d) the world is your oyster

Q.484. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

It's risky to invest all your savings in one company; it's like _____.

- (a) going down in flames
- (b) putting all your eggs in one basket
- (c) biting the bullet
- (d) breaking a leg

Q.485. Irrespective of the chaos in the classroom, our class teacher stays cool as a cucumber.

- (a) Stays calm and composed
- (b) Behaves like a vegetable
- (c) Scolds all the students in the classroom
- (d) Develops a fever

Q.486. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

Naina has six children, and I always _____ with their names.

- (a) get mixed up
- (b) get rid of
- (c) get away clean
- (d) get cold feet

Q.487. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

She told me, _____ that she was going to live in New York.

- (a) blue blood (b) black and blue
(c) out of the blue (d) once in a blue moon

Q.488. Bone to pick

- (A) To be angry about something and want to discuss it
(B) To stop trying hard
(C) To not give up
(D) Putting in extra effort

Q.489. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

Rahul speaks easily in front of a small group, but he seems _____ before a large audience.

- (a) ill at ease (b) think ill of
(c) man of ill repute (d) ill-disposed to

Q.490. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following sentence.

He made the business profitable from unprofitable in about a year of joining.

- (a) Easy come, easy go
(b) Throw up
(c) Where there is a will, there is a way
(d) Still waters run deep

Q.491. The apple of one's eye

- (a) Very cheerful (b) Very dear
(c) Very nice (d) Very pleasing

Q.492. By the skin of your teeth

- (a) By a very narrow margin
(b) To be less affected by criticisms and rebuffs
(c) Very protective
(d) Saved by others

Q.493. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the following sentence.

His research on the migratory patterns of the birds is run-of-the-mill.

- (a) absurd (b) one in a million
(c) trash (d) average

Q.494. Keep someone at arm's length

- (a) To ruin someone's plans
(b) To avoid becoming too close or friendly with someone
(c) Angry about something
(d) Having energy again after being tired

Q.495. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

I know it was wrong to distract his friends, but _____.

- (a) all's fair in love and war
(b) all's unfair in the world
(c) all's unfair in love and war
(d) all's fair in the world

Q.496. He managed to save his father's

business by the sweat of his brow.

- (a) incidentally
(b) hard work
(c) tricks and strategies
(d) any way possible

Q.497. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

My manager forced me to resign from my job as a chef since I underwent a spine surgery. I was depressed and had lost all hope. Later my father motivated me to open my own café and showed me ways to be independent. After all it is true that one should not _____.

- (a) grease the palm
(b) blow one's own trumpet
(c) cry over spilt milk
(d) blow hot and cold

Q.498. He was quaking in his boots when he had to give a speech on the stage.

- (a) To tremble in excitement
(b) To shake in happiness
(c) To tremble with fear
(d) To shake in excitement

Q.499. The entrepreneur decided to throw caution to the wind.

- (a) Take a risk
(b) Take the best option
(c) Think innovatively
(d) In extreme windy conditions

Q.500. Child's play

- (a) In someone's role
(b) Something very easy
(c) Weakness
(d) Just behaviour

Q.501. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

I found my teacher's points casual and informal in the group discussion

- (a) flesh and blood (b) free and easy
(c) foot the bill (d) fair and square

Q.502. Beauty of it

- (a) Make things worse
(b) Cause for dispute
(c) Quite ordinary
(d) Good points

Q.503. All of a sudden

- (a) Intentionally
(b) Quickly and unexpectedly
(c) Quickly and Expectedly
(d) Accidentally

Q.504. These things are very hard to swallow.

- (a) difficult to resist (b) difficult to speak
(c) difficult to believe (d) difficult to eat

Q.505. The decision to go on a trip after

my vacations was the _____.

- (a) ice on the cake
(b) icing on the cake
(c) apple on the cake
(d) icing on the brownie

Q.506. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

It's easy to say that you'll start exercising every day, but it is _____.

- (a) like fish out of water
(b) easier said than done
(c) crying wolf
(d) going the extra mile

Q.507. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

If Peter said he would get that book for you, he will do it. He always _____.

- (a) keeps under his hat
(b) keeps him at arm's length
(c) keeps his word
(d) keeps his shirt on

Q.508. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the following sentence.

With the harsh words of the boss, Srujan felt sad, but his colleague's words created insult to injury.

- (a) attached insult to injury
(b) provoked insult to injury
(c) added injury to insult
(d) added insult to injury

Q.509. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence

Brave people never hide at the moment of decision.

- (a) When the crunch comes
(b) Beat the clock
(c) A hell of time
(d) Turn back the hands of time

Q.510. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following statement.

It's better to get less than what you want than get nothing.

- (a) Half a loaf is better than none.
(b) Waste not, want not.
(c) Where there is smoke, there is fire.
(d) A storm in a teacup

Q.511. Bharath is a skilful achiever, so he hits the nail on the leg.

- (a) hits the nail on the head
(b) hits the nail on the shoulder
(c) put the nail in the hole
(d) hits the screw on the top

Q.512. Play it by ear

- (a) Obey the rules blindly
(b) Act as suggested
(c) Discontinue impulsively
(d) Perform without any rehearsals

Q.513. Memory like sieve

- (a) Being healthy
- (b) Poor memory
- (c) Feeling ill
- (d) Remembering everything

Q.514. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined words in the given sentence.

The candidate blamed the persistent traffic jam as reason of his being late and the interviewer believed him though he was not convinced.

- (a) gave the benefit of doubt
- (b) changed his tune
- (c) thought err is human and to forgive is divine
- (d) did not judge the book by its cover

Q.515. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

Geetika spoke a lot about her new movie. However, it came to nothing in the theatres.

- (a) To give the devil his dues
- (b) To get into hot water
- (c) To dig the grave
- (d) To end in smoke

Q.516. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence

Raima takes her classes very attentively.

- (a) In accordance with
- (b) By blazing a trail
- (c) By losing in a cloud
- (d) Be all ears

Q.517. Getting the long-awaited promotion is a milestone in her career.

- (a) Burden
- (b) Important event
- (c) Wonder
- (d) Mishap

Q.518. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given statement.

One who hurries up always gets the best

- (a) The early bird catches the worm.
- (b) His bark is worse than his bite.
- (c) Forewarned is forearmed.
- (d) Brevity is the soul of wit.

Q.519. Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.

When I was in Italy for a tour, the tourist guide provided by Azim was ____ Because of him, the whole tour was successful

- (a) looking for a needle in a haystack
- (b) burning the midnight oil
- (c) worth his weight in gold
- (d) armed to the teeth

Q.520. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

Shayam was accused of bribery, but he submitted proofs for his innocence.

- (a) Buying the pig in a poke
- (b) Cast pearls before they swine

- (c) Chapter and verse
- (d) Beating about the bush

Q.521. I was so nervous for the job interview that I was sweating bullets the whole time.

- (a) very happy
- (b) extremely nervous or anxious
- (c) very cold
- (d) very hard

Q.522. Like a cat on a hot tin roof

- (a) Studying very hard
- (b) Being lazy
- (c) Being in a state of agitation
- (d) Urging somebody not to worry about something

Q.523. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the sentence given below.

Most of the people say that some people fight for the cause but most of them don't support it.

- (a) Are out of frying pan onto the fire
- (b) Spare the rod and spoil the child
- (c) Pay only lip service
- (d) Mind their P's and Q's

Q.524. Head in the clouds

- (a) Being extremely tall
- (b) Being absent minded
- (c) Being extremely happy
- (d) Being extremely sad

Q.525. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence .

We should protect ourselves from jealous people.

- (a) High-spirited
- (b) Any Tom, Dick or Harry
- (c) One trick pony
- (d) Green-eyed

Q.526. On the straight and narrow

- (a) The unrefined and complicated
- (b) The straightforward and ethically acceptable
- (c) The honest but dubious
- (d) The unpredictable though genuine

Q.527. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following sentence.

Her visits to her family are very rare because she lives out of the country.

- (a) Few and far between
- (b) Egg on
- (c) Beck and call
- (d) All in all

Q.528. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

The servants know the secrets of the family they are working for.

- (a) Ins and outs
- (b) Latin and Greek
- (c) Hornet's nest
- (d) Long and short

Q.529. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

Shruti is a strange person because of her attitude.

- (a) A one man
- (b) A scarlet woman
- (c) Queer fish
- (d) A straw man

Q.530. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

Mayank was speaking a lot about honesty, but when Rita reminded him about the money paid to him for the work, he behaved cowardly and left the place.

- (a) Flogging a dead horse
- (b) Gliding the pill
- (c) Falling flat
- (d) Going with his tail between his legs

Q.531. Have a bash

- (a) to betray a close friend
- (b) to make an attempt
- (c) to spoil a moment
- (d) to put something on hold

Q.532. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

Don't annoy or irritate Raghav, otherwise he will oppose our proposal in the meeting.

- (a) Pass the buck
- (b) Pour oil on troubled water
- (c) Rub in the wrong way
- (d) Loose the ground

Q.533. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given statement.

Doing things in a hurry does not give fruitful results.

- (a) Nothing succeeds like success.
- (b) Still waters run deep.
- (c) Haste is waste.
- (d) Wisdom is too high for a fool.

Solutions :-

Sol.443.(a) To let the cat out of the bag - to reveal a secret.

E.g.- John accidentally let the cat out of the bag about the surprise party when he mentioned the cake.

Sol.444.(d) Talking through his hat- talking nonsense.

Sol.445.(c) loaves and fishes

The idiom 'loaves and fishes' means material benefits. The given sentence states that most of the ministers are concerned with the material benefits of office rather than the service of man. Hence, 'loaves and fishes' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.446.(b) The crux of the matter -

Critical point of the issue.

Sol.447.(d) A left handed compliment -
An insult

Sol.448.(c) to put a brave face on - to remain positive or optimistic

Sol.449.(b) carried of his feet - was wild with excitement

Sol.450.(d) to a T - exactly

Sol.451.(b) Call the shots - to be in a position to make decisions that influence a situation.

E.g.- Since it's your project, you get to call the shots and decide how it's done.

Sol.452.(d) Cup of tea - something one likes/excels in.

E.g.- Cooking isn't my cup of tea. I would rather order takeout.

Sol.453.(c) To play devil's advocate - to argue, just for the sake of it.

Sol.454.(d) running around in circles - putting efforts into something that does not give a worthwhile result.

Sol.455.(d) Barking up the wrong tree - to be mistaken, to be looking for solutions in the wrong place.

E.g.- John thought I knew where his lost phone was, but he was barking up the wrong tree.

Sol.456.(b) Go for a song - being sold at a cheap rate.

Sol.457.(b) Stab in the back - to betray or harm someone.

Sol.458.(c) Smash hit - something overwhelmingly successful or popular.

Sol.459.(d) To cut someone some slack - to not manage someone very strictly or critically.

E.g.- Cut John some slack. He is new and learning.

Sol.460.(c) All eyes and ears - listening and watching eagerly and carefully.

Sol.461.(b) In the fast lane - A life filled with excitement.

Sol.462.(d) fight fire with fire - to respond to a problem or challenge with a similar or equally strong counter measure.

Sol.463.(d) in a nutshell

The idiom 'in a nutshell' means in brief. The given sentence states that the person just wants to know the real matter in brief. Hence, 'in a nutshell' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.464.(a) sly as a fox - smart and clever.

Sol.465.(c) Raining cats and dogs - raining heavily.

Sol.466.(d) To keep one's temper - to remain calm.
E.g.- Even though he was frustrated, he managed to keep his temper during the meeting.

Sol.467.(d) Get your act together - Get organised and do things better.

E.g.- Before the important meeting, he realized he needed to get his act together, so he started organizing his notes and preparing his presentation.

Sol.468.(a) Be like chalk and cheese - to be completely different from each other.
E.g.- The twins may look alike, but their personalities are like chalk and cheese.

Sol.469.(d) hit the nail on the head
The idiom 'hit the nail on the head' means to do or say something that is exactly right. The given sentence states that Greta Thunberg was right when she asked about accountability for global warming and climate change. Hence, 'hit the nail on the head' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.470.(d) keep your ear to the ground
The idiom 'keep your ear to the ground' means to pay attention to everything that is happening. The given sentence states that as a journalist, it's crucial to stay well-informed and aware of current events and trends, otherwise, your colleagues might outperform you. Hence, 'keep your ear to the ground' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.471.(d) As phony as a three-dollar bill - something that is fake.

E.g.- His excuses for missing the meeting were as phony as a three-dollar bill, and no one believed a word he said.

Sol.472.(b) On cloud nine - very happy

Sol.473.(b) From scratch - from the beginning
E.g.- She decided to bake a cake from scratch, starting with basic ingredients like flour, eggs, and sugar.

Sol.474.(b) The whole nine yards - everything, all the way

Sol.475.(d) Turn a blind eye - pretend not to notice.

Sol.476.(b) have egg on your face - to be made to look foolish or embarrassed.

E.g.- John confidently predicted that his team would win the championship, but they lost by a large margin, leaving him with egg on his face.

Sol.477.(b) On the same page - be in agreement.

Sol.478.(a) Bite the dust - to suffer a defeat.
E.g.- After a long and fierce battle, the opposing army had to bite the dust, and our soldiers emerged victorious.

Sol.479.(d) Stuck to his guns - to stand firm against all difficulties and challenges.

Sol.480.(c) Wearing her heart on her sleeve - to openly and freely express one's emotions.

Sol.481.(c) To cross swords - to fight.
E.g.- The two rival companies crossed swords in the courtroom over a patent dispute.

Sol.482.(d) Put on ice - to postpone or temporarily delay something.

Sol.483.(d) the world is your oyster - having many opportunities and possibilities available.

Sol.484.(b) Putting all your eggs in one basket - to put all the effort or resources into doing one thing.

Sol.485.(a) Cool as a cucumber - stays calm and composed.

Sol.486.(a) get mixed up
'Get mixed up' means to become confused in distinguishing or remembering things. The given sentence states that Naina has six children, and I always get confused with their names. Hence, 'get mixed up' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.487.(c) Out of the blue - suddenly and unexpectedly.

Sol.488.(a) Bone to pick - to be angry about something and want to discuss it.
E.g.- I have a bone to pick with you because you promised to help me with my project, but you never showed up.

Sol.489.(a) ill at ease
The idiom 'ill at ease' means uncomfortable or embarrassed. The given sentence states that Rahul speaks easily in front of a small group, but he seems uncomfortable before a large audience. Hence, 'ill at ease' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.490.(c) Where there is a will, there is a way - where there is determination, there is a path to success.

Sol.491.(b)

The apple of one's eye - very dear.

E.g.- My granddaughter is the apple of my eye. I cherish every moment with her.

Sol.492.(a) By the skin of your teeth - by a very narrow margin.

E.g.- I almost missed my flight, but I made it by the skin of my teeth.

Sol.493.(d) Run-of-the-mill - average.

Sol.494.(b) Keep someone at arm's length - to avoid becoming too close or friendly with someone.

E.g.- She decided to keep her nosy neighbor at arm's length by politely avoiding personal questions.

Sol.495.(a) all's fair in love and war

The idiom 'all's fair in love and war' means any kind of behaviour is acceptable in love and war. The given sentence states that I know it was not right to distract his friends but any kind of behaviour is acceptable in love and war. Hence, 'all's fair in love and war' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.496.(b)

the sweat of his brow - hard work.

Sol.497.(c) Cry over spilt milk - to be upset or concerned about something that has already happened and cannot be changed.

Sol.498.(c) Quaking in his boots - to tremble with fear.

Sol.499.(a) Throw caution to the wind - take a risk.

Sol.500.(b)

Child's play - something very easy.

E.g.- For the experienced chef, preparing a gourmet meal is child's play.

Sol.501.(b) free and easy

'Casual and informal' means a relaxed or free approach to something which is synonymous with the phrase 'free and easy'. Hence, 'free and easy' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.502.(d) Beauty of it- good points.

E.g.- The beauty of it is that you can create art in your own unique way, expressing your individuality through your work.

Sol.503.(b) All of a sudden - quickly and unexpectedly.

E.g.- All of a sudden, the lights went out during the storm.

Sol.504.(c)

Hard to swallow - difficult to believe.

Sol.505.(b) icing on the cake

The idiom 'icing on the cake' means something extra that makes a good thing even better. The given sentence states that the decision to go on a trip after my vacations was the perfect addition to an already enjoyable situation. Hence, 'icing on the cake' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.506.(b) Easier said than done - easy to talk about but hard to put into practice.

Sol.507.(c) keeps his word - to do what he promised.

Sol.508.(d) Added insult to injury - made the situation even worse.

Sol.509.(a) When the crunch comes - at the moment of decision.

Sol.510.(a) Half a loaf is better than none - it's better to get less than what you want than get nothing.

E.g.- Even though I only got a small raise, I know that half a loaf is better than none.

Sol.511.(a) Hits the nail on the head - find exactly the right solution.

Sol.512.(d) Play it by ear - perform without any rehearsals.

E.g. Anjali had not heard the song before. She was playing it by ear at the annual function.

Sol.513.(b)

Memory like sieve - poor memory.

E.g.- She has a memory like a sieve. She forgot what I told her just five minutes ago.

Sol.514.(a) Gave the benefit of doubt - believe someone's statement or explanation, but not be convinced entirely.

Sol.515.(d) To end in smoke - to come to nothing or to have no positive result.

Sol.516.(d) Be all ears - to listen very attentively.

Sol.517.(b) Milestone - important event.

Sol.518.(a) The early bird catches the worm - one who hurries up always gets the best.

E.g.- John arrived at the store before it opened, and he got the best deals. The early bird catches the worm.

Sol.519.(c) Worth his weight in gold - something that is extremely valuable or

useful.

Sol.520.(c) Chapter and verse - to provide full, specific and authoritative information to support your statement.

Sol.521.(b) Sweating bullets - extremely nervous or anxious.

Sol.522.(c) Like a cat on a hot tin roof - being in a state of agitation.

E.g.- The pitcher was so nervous that he was sweating like a cat on a hot tin roof.

Sol.523.(c) Pay only lip service - some people fight for the cause but most of them don't support it.

Sol.524.(b) Head in the clouds - Being absent minded.

E.g.- During the science lecture, John always has his head in the clouds, daydreaming about his next adventure.

Sol.525.(d) Green-eyed - jealous

Sol.526.(b) On the straight and narrow - the straightforward and ethically acceptable.

E.g.- After a troubled past, he's now on the straight and narrow.

Sol.527.(a) Few and far between - very rare or not happening frequently.

Sol.528.(a) Ins and outs - secrets and detailed or complicated facts of something.

Sol.529.(c) Queer fish - a strange person

Sol.530.(d) Going with his tail between his legs - feeling ashamed or embarrassed about something.

Sol.531.(b)

Have a bash - to make an attempt.

E.g.- I've never played chess before, but I'll have a bash at it.

Sol.532.(c) Rub in the wrong way - to irritate or annoy someone.

Sol.533.(c) Haste is waste - doing things in a hurry does not give fruitful results.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp) Questions (534 to 624)

Q.534. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined words in the given sentence.

Playing fantasy games on internet is an easy way to make money quickly but it's risky.

(a) in for a penny in for a pound

(b) not fair and square

- (c) making a quick buck
(d) bigger fish to fry

Q.535. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following statement.

We should be together to fight any danger. Otherwise, separately, we won't be able to fight.

- (a) Nothing ventured, nothing gained.
(b) A full purse makes the mouth speak.
(c) United we stand, divided we fall.
(d) Well begun is half done

Q.536. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

Rohit is very mischievous and always annoys his teachers.

- (a) Gets in his teacher's hair
(b) Puts his shoulders to the wheel
(c) A storm in a tea cup
(d) Leads up the garden path

Q.537. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

The child played the video game as much as he wanted to.

- (a) To his heart's content
(b) To gild the pill
(c) To kick the bucket
(d) To assume airs

Q.538. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

The proud people forget the fact that the world is tangible.

- (a) Hobson's choice
(b) Head and shoulders
(c) High and mighty
(d) Hard-nosed attitude

Q.539. Queer pitch

- (a) Make a weird request
(b) Make a lot of progress
(c) Act out of normal
(d) Spoil somebody's chance of doing something

Q.540. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the sentence given below.

Richa was provoking her neighbours against her maid Shanta who spoke against her but none of them responded.

- (a) Smelling a rat
(b) Egging on
(c) Carrying the conviction
(d) Rising like a phoenix

Q.541. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Tourists from all around the world visit Agra to see the Taj mahal.

- (a) Ever and anon (b) Cut and dried

- (c) Few and far (d) Far and wide

Q.542. Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Teja is a successful businessman; he always makes hay when the moon shines.

- (a) makes hay while the sun sets
(b) makes hay while the sun shines
(c) makes hey while the moon rises
(d) makes hay while the stars twinkle

Q.543. Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.

Having a chip on one's shoulder

- (a) Having an unnecessary feeling of guilt
(b) Having an irritated and unfriendly attitude
(c) Having a proud and self-centred arrogance
(d) Showing great resistance to any adversities

Q.544. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

I told Benny that the die was cast and there was no further escape.

- (a) the course of action ended and it couldn't be restarted
(b) the course of action would never begin
(c) the course of action began and it could not be blocked
(d) the course of action yet to start and it could be postponed

Q.545. Turn his hand to

- (a) To resolve
(b) To adapt or apply to
(c) To try new things
(d) To try hard

Q.546. Though Ravi is silent and reserved, he

has got a finger in every pie.

- (a) special interest in certain things
(b) involved in many things
(c) an opinion of his own
(d) a cold attitude toward everything

Q.547. Throw cold water on

- (a) To show indifference
(b) To rinse thoroughly
(c) To encourage
(d) To talk nicely

Q.548. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined words in the given sentence.

Piyush is inexperienced in leather industry.

- (a) in great hands (b) a sore thumb
(c) hang fire (d) a greenhorn

Q.549. It's not polite to blow your own trumpet in front of others.

- (a) brag one's own accomplishment
(b) criticise someone unfairly
(c) play a musical instrument
(d) give someone a compliment

Q.550. Cry for the moon

- (a) To start performing better
(b) To have patience
(c) To desire the unattainable
(d) To be extremely happy

Q.551. Have a narrow escape

- (a) Only just succeed in doing something
(b) Likely to fall in the near future
(c) Do something very risky
(d) Just manage to avoid danger or trouble

Q.552. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined words in the given sentence.

The childhood days are peaceful days of our life.

- (a) halcyon days (b) live wire days
(c) all years (d) hard and fast days

Q.553. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the given sentence.

When he made fun of the sage, who was already infuriated, it made a bad situation Worse.

- (a) Made them at the loggerheads
(b) Pulled someone's legs
(c) Added fuel to the fire
(d) Budged up

Q.554. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following sentence.

The recent strike of the employees left the factory and its machinery in disorder.

- (a) Need of the hour (b) Out of gear
(c) Pin-money (d) Lock and key

Q.555. Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

My mother asked my father to increase her personal use allowance.

- (a) pell mell (b) rank and file
(c) pins and needles (d) pin money

Q.556. Select the most appropriate idiom for the following statement.

The manager was punished for his negligence in work.

- (a) Bid defiance
(b) Burn one's boats
(c) Bolt from the blue
(d) Bring to book

Q.557. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

Everything in the mansion was in **great confusion** after the robbery.

- (a) Pick holes (b) Pell-mell
(c) Turn over a new leaf (d) Damp squib

Q.558. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined words in the given sentence.

He was alone and knew the dangers ahead during his journey, but he **tried to keep up his confidence**.

- (a) whistled in the dark
(b) made a sterner stuff
(c) stepped up his game
(d) wouldn't be caught dead

Q.559. Select the most appropriate idiom for the underlined segment in the following sentence.

Nitish's promotion is **due**.

- (a) On the cards
(b) Not worth his salt
(c) With due respect
(d) Done to death

Q.560. Lily-livered

- (a) Brave (b) Comical
(c) Not brave (d) Naughty

Q.561. Pooja tried to explain the problem, but soon she **tied herself up in knots**.

- (a) Be forced to explain your actions and (probably) punished
(b) Become very confused when you are trying to explain something
(c) Make no progress in an argument or discussion
(d) Won't modify an opinion or agree to even small changes that another person wants

Q.562. To bell the cat

- (a) To feed pets (b) To play with kids
(c) To love cats (d) To face risk

Q.563. Today, the country's nationalists **rule the roost** and hand out the jobs.

- (a) To be in charge
(b) To be prejudiced
(c) To save a criminal
(d) To exploit someone

Q.564. Scrape the barrel

- (a) Trying to find something
(b) Hiding something
(c) Using all the ways to achieve the desired result
(d) To be forced to use one's last and weakest resource

Q.565. A dime a dozen

- (a) Her ideas were worth a dime a dozen and didn't impress the boss.
(b) The concert tickets were a dime a dozen and sold out quickly.

- (c) The restaurant had some delicious desserts that were a dime a dozen.
(d) The antique store had some rare finds, but they were a dime a dozen.

Q.566. To prime the pump

- (a) Manipulate someone to achieve success
(b) Encourage the growth or action of something
(c) To use a pump efficiently
(d) Ask others to be ambitious

Q.567. Bad iron

- (a) No steam (b) Not hot
(c) Bad luck (d) Bad behaviour

Q.568. Has he lost his mind? He is **falling foul** of everybody.

- (a) Quite puzzled with
(b) Maintaining a sort of coldness
(c) Having an amicable talk with
(d) Quarrelling with

Q.569. Get into a scrape

- (a) Creating a problem
(b) Solving a problem
(c) Explaining a problem
(d) Involved in a problem

Q.570. Blow something out of (all) proportion.

- (a) Make things difficult for someone without reason
(b) Leave someone at a time when they need you to stay and help them
(c) Control the level of something in order to stop it increasing
(d) Behave as if something that has happened is much worse than it really is

Q.571. To go to the dogs

- (a) To win a race
(b) To become worse
(c) To stand on guard
(d) To win support

Q.572. Go back to the drawing board

- (a) Mediate a task
(b) Accomplish a task
(c) Start over
(d) Leave a work unfinished

Q.573. I'm going to be **in trouble** if I don't submit my homework to the teacher.

- (a) a devil's advocate (b) off base
(c) the lion's share (d) up the creek

Q.574. Select the most appropriate idiom for the given situation.

I was very excited about my new assignment. I sent the email without the required attachment. What have I done?

- (a) Shook a leg
(b) As swift as an eagle
(c) Jumped the gun

- (d) Tested the waters

Q.575. Stir up a hornets' nest

- (a) Provoke trouble (b) Resist a fight
(c) Create doubts (d) Scare the birds

Q.576. Taking a bull by the horns

- (a) Wearing a skull cap
(b) To decapitate a bull for beef
(c) To make a stupid decision thinking it to be daring
(d) To deal with a difficult situation in a very direct or confident way

Q.577. A perfect storm

- (a) Pretty good judgement
(b) Healing from trauma
(c) The worst possible situation
(d) Appropriate for all occasions

Q.578. Your career is now **completely obsolete**.

- (a) moving like a worm
(b) as dead as a doornail
(c) dead even
(d) hanging by a thread

Q.579. Select the correct idiom that can substitute the italicised group of words in the given sentence.

My business partners thought that I would simply accept their cheating, but they will soon realise that ***I am more powerful than what they expected.***

- (a) damsel in distress
(b) they caught a tartar
(c) cutting a cloth
(d) casting pearls before swine

Q.580. Hit the jackpot

- (a) Found a piece of gold
(b) Harm the opportunity
(c) Receiving a reward
(d) Gaining a big success

Q.581. Select the most appropriate idiom/phrase that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Mahesh has learnt **not to take things seriously**.

- (a) Your guess is as good as mine
(b) Take it with a grain of salt
(c) That's the last straw
(d) Pull someone's leg

Q.582. Many analysts are tipping stable, blue-chip companies **to weather the storm**.

- (a) to deal with a simple situation without being harmed
(b) to deal with a situation without thinking
(c) to deal with a difficult situation without being harmed
(d) to deal with a simple situation



without harming anyone else

Q.583. Harry always speaks his eye but he is not always very diplomatic!

- (a) speaks his tongue (b) reads his heart
(c) speaks his mind (d) listens his ear

Q.584. Pass the buck

- (a) Providing essential services
(b) Trying to calm down
(c) Blaming another person
(d) Saying something unpleasant

Q.585. Select the correct idiom that can substitute the italicised group of words in the given sentence.

Shelley has been contemplating for a few days but still has not decided to quit the job.

- (a) biting the dust
(b) chewing the cud
(c) cooling one's heels
(d) getting into hot waters

Q.586. At cross purposes

- (a) Developing and amplifying ideas given
(b) Finalising ideas and plans
(c) Blindly following each other's ideas
(d) Disagreeing with each other's ideas

Q.587. Select the correct idiom that can substitute the italicised group of words in the given sentence.

You must not participate in the marathon this year without any training. It is an unreal hope on your part!

- (a) carrying coal to new castle
(b) a pipe dream
(c) a will-o'-the-wisp
(d) to lose one's temper

Q.588. I just went to Bali on a backpacking trip and did everything by the ear without any itinerary.

- (a) by spreading rumors
(b) by improvisation
(c) while criticising
(d) by asking

Q.589. You snooze, you lose

- (a) If you oversleep, you are likely to lose a job
(b) Laziness is not good
(c) You may lose your money if snoozing is not stopped
(d) If you are not alert, you are likely to miss opportunities

Q.590. His voice gets on my nerves.

- (a) Makes me ill (b) Pierces my eardrums
(c) Irritates me (d) Makes me sad

Q.591. Select the most appropriate idiom/phrase that can substitute the given group of words.

The better you know someone the less you like him.

- (a) Save for a rainy day
(b) Spill the beans
(c) The elephant in the room
(d) Familiarity breeds contempt

Q.592. I really don't want to pour cold water on your theory but it cannot be applied to real life situations.

- (a) To destroy someone's written piece of work
(b) To take revenge on someone by destroying their lives' work under the pretext of bad quality
(c) To be critical or doubtful of a plan that someone is excited about
(d) To give goosebumps by showing a Prospect

Q.593. Riya always considers sincerity, devotion and dedication as the highest priority of a good employee.

- (a) Fair and square (b) Ever and anon
(c) Free and easy (d) First and foremost

Q.594. Get up on the wrong side of the bed.

- (a) Someone who is having a horrible day
(b) Destroy or ruin a plan
(c) Someone who is having a good day
(d) Go to bed or go to sleep

Q.595. Julia has the habit of comparing apples to oranges.

- (a) Comparing two things that cannot be compared
(b) Blaming others for her mistakes
(c) Choosing things after careful scrutiny
(d) Purchasing different fruits for different purposes

Q.596. Die a dog's death

- (a) The old businessman died in peace after meeting his whole family on his deathbed.
(b) Yesterday, a poor vegetable seller died in an unfortunate accident.
(c) The doctor who used illegal methods to conduct experiments on humans must die a shameful death.
(d) Wars compel people to starve to death and they are helpless.

Q.597. I don't buy it

- (a) Purchasing should be controlled
(b) Only good decisions can be agreed on
(c) I am not convinced
(d) I do not like to buy

Q.598. Pull yourself together

- (a) Fight violently (b) Work overtime
(c) Help the needy (d) Calm down

Q.599. Easier said than done

- (a) Not as easy as it appears to be
(b) Not as moderate as it appears to be
(c) Not as restricted as it appears to be
(d) Not as difficult as it appears to be

Q.600. To show a clean pair of heels

- (a) To clean shoes fast
(b) Show clean shoes
(c) Show clean feet
(d) To run fast

Q.601. 'Honesty is the best policy' does not remain valid in the present times of corruption and greed.

- (a) Go through thick and thin
(b) Put up
(c) Keep pace with
(d) Hold good

Q.602. Choose the option which means the same as the underlined segment

His deep study of the case uncovered more problems.

- (a) opened a Pandora's box
(b) opened the fire on
(c) opened conversation
(d) opened a season on

Q.603. Through the grapevine

- (a) Through difficulties
(b) Via gossip
(c) Extremely ill
(d) Succeeded brilliantly

Q.604. Ruffle someone's feathers

- (a) Be relaxed and in control
(b) Do something very easily
(c) Make more of an effort
(d) Make someone annoyed

Q.605. Select the idiom that gives the most appropriate meaning of the underlined phrase in the following sentence.

Our secretary is always in the mood for an argument. He must learn to keep quiet.

- (a) To go through (b) To turn up
(c) To take off (d) To hold his tongue

Q.606. Reghu's been trying to keep a lid on his emotions, but every now and then his anger erupts.

- (a) make things difficult for someone
(b) either take less care of your appearance or relax completely and enjoy yourself
(c) leave someone at a time when they need you to stay and help them
(d) control the level of something in order to stop it increasing

Q.607. A piece of information received by word of mouth has no authenticity.

- (a) through an official order
(b) through rumours

- (c) in written form
(d) in spoken form

Q.608. Athira would like to get him a special birthday present, but nothing **springs to mind**.

- (a) almost always
(b) forget about something
(c) dawns on
(d) from the beginning of time

Q.609. The officer asked his subordinates to **keep him posted** of the workplace developments.

- (a) maintain secrecy
(b) send letters by post
(c) keep sharing the latest information
(d) not disturb him in matters

Q.610. A blind spot

- (a) A person who is blind
(b) A person with no emotional feelings
(c) A situation where no progress is made
(d) An area in your range of vision that you cannot see properly

Q.611. Get down to brass tacks

- (a) To become serious about something
(b) Get fired from the job
(c) Compromise, cooperation between people
(d) To be ready

Q.612. A bed of nails

- (a) A problematic or uncomfortable situation
(b) A quick and automatic response
(c) A person with no moral ethics
(d) A fiercely contested fight or dispute

Q.613. To have an itching palm

- (a) To have no mercy
(b) To gain strength
(c) To have an urge to slap
(d) To be greedy for money

Q.614. Out of the woods

- (a) Out of danger
(b) To lose contact
(c) To meet with disaster
(d) Not adhering to rules

Q.615. Buy a lemon

- (a) Wear fashionable clothing
(b) The ability to know what's happening
(c) To not complain
(d) To buy something that is worthless

Q.616. Select the most appropriate meaning of the bracketed idiom in the given sentence.

The first sample of ore from the trial boring is very promising, but we should remember that **(one swallow does not make a summer.)**

- (a) The fact of failure or escape is not affected by the narrowness of the margin
(b) To come out of one trouble and get into a worse
(c) A single fortunate event does not mean that what follows will also be good.
(d) The whole of everything

Q.617. To meet one's eyes

- (a) To look at someone directly while they are looking at you
(b) To confess something
(c) To make haste
(d) To meet someone regularly

Q.618. A blast from the past

- (a) A competition where the outcome is difficult to judge or predict
(b) Punishment for the crime committed in the past
(c) Something powerfully nostalgic
(d) An unresolved argument

Q.619. Against the clock

- (a) To take on a task that is a way to big
(b) On the point of achievement
(c) To avoid talking
(d) Rushed and short on time

Q.620. In the groove

- (a) To muse on in an aimless manner
(b) Starting to perform very well
(c) Simplify the producers
(d) A widely debated issue

Q.621. Walk on air

- (a) To work hard
(b) To describe an unusual situation
(c) To be extremely happy
(d) Feeling weakened or tired

Q.622. Wet behind the ears

- (a) A sudden change in fortune due to a windfall
(b) To place a bad bet
(c) To be young and without experience
(d) To win a bet

Q.623. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

That new budget bill was **(totally useless)** before it hit the Senate.

- (a) a cry wolf (b) a dead duck
(c) cold feet (d) a fuel to the fire

Q.624. To pull the trigger

- (a) To make an exaggerated statement
(b) To do unnecessary things
(c) To insult and disgrace the people
(d) To commit a course of action

Solutions :-

Sol.534.(c) Making a quick buck - an easy way to make money quickly.

Sol.535.(c) United we stand, divided we fall - together we are strong, when divided we fail.

Sol.536.(a)

Get in somebody's hair - to annoy.

Sol.537.(a) To his heart's content - as much as he wanted to.

Sol.538.(c) High and mighty - proud people.

Sol.539.(d) Queer pitch - spoil somebody's chance of doing something.
E.g.- The unexpected rain queered our pitch for the outdoor picnic.

Sol.540.(b) Egging on - to encourage or provoke someone to do something.

Sol.541.(d)

Far and wide - all around the world.

Sol.542.(b) Makes hay while the sun shines - to take advantage of a favourable situation.

Sol.543.(b) Having a chip on one's shoulder - having an irritated and unfriendly attitude.

E.g.- After the argument, Sarah had a chip on her shoulder, making it hard for her to smile.

Sol.544.(c) The die was cast - the course of action began and it could not be blocked.

Sol.545.(c)

Turn his hand to - to try new things.

E.g.- John is a valuable team member. He is always willing to turn his hand to new challenges.

Sol.546.(b) A finger in every pie - involved in many things.

Sol.547.(a) Throw cold water on - to show indifference.

E.g.- When he talked about his acting skills, his friends threw cold water on it.

Sol.548.(d) a greenhorn - inexperienced.

Sol.549.(a) blow your own trumpet - brag one's own accomplishment.

Sol.550.(c) Cry for the moon - to desire the unattainable.

E.g.- Susan knows that getting a sports car for her birthday is crying for the moon, but she can't help dreaming about it.

Sol.551.(d) Have a narrow escape - just manage to avoid danger or trouble.
E.g.- The house had a narrow escape from being flooded when the storm changed direction at the last minute.

Sol.552.(a)

Halcyon days - peaceful days.

Sol.553.(c) Added fuel to the fire - made a bad situation worse.

Sol.554.(b) Out of gear - in a state of disorder; not functioning properly.

Sol.555.(d)

Pin money - personal use allowance.

Sol.556.(d) Bring to book - to punish someone for something they are accountable for.

Sol.557.(b) Pell-mell - great confusion.

Sol.558.(a) Whistled in the dark - tried to keep up his confidence.

Sol.559.(a) On the cards - due or likely to happen.

Sol.560.(c) Lily-livered - Not brave.

E.g.- The soldier was called lily-livered because he ran away from the battlefield at the first sign of danger.

Sol.561.(b) To tie yourself in knots - Become very confused when you are trying to explain something.

Sol.562.(d)

To bell the cat - to face the risk

E.g.- No one was quite ready to bell the cat.

Sol.563.(a)

Rule the roost - to be in charge.

Sol.564.(d) Scrape the barrel - To be forced to use one's last and weakest resource

E.g.- After months of searching, they had to scrape the barrel to find any remaining job candidates.

Sol.565.(a) Her ideas were worth a dime a dozen and didn't impress the boss.

The idiom "**a dime a dozen**" means that something is very common and of no particular value. Going through the options, the sentence given in option 'a' has the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.

Sol.566.(b) To prime the pump - Encourage the growth or action of something.

E.g.- To get more people to join the club, they offered free snacks as a way to prime the pump.

Sol.567.(c) Bad iron - bad luck.

E.g.- Spilling coffee on my white shirt before the presentation was another instance of bad iron.

Sol.568.(d) Falling foul - quarrelling with.

Sol.569.(d)

Get into a scrape - Involved in a problem

E.g.- Tommy got into a scrape when he borrowed his sister's bike without asking and then accidentally damaged it.

Sol.570.(d) Blow something out of (all) proportion - behave as if something that has happened is much worse than it really is.

E.g.- She blew the small argument out of proportion by telling everyone in the neighborhood about it.

Sol.571.(b)

To go to the dogs - to become worse.

E.g.- The company went to the dogs after the new CEO took over.

Sol.572.(c) Go back to the drawing board - start over.

E.g.- The new design didn't work well, so they had to go back to the drawing board to come up with a better plan.

Sol.573.(d) Up the creek - In trouble

Sol.574.(c)

Jumped the gun - to act prematurely or before the appropriate time.

Sol.575.(a)

Stir up a hornets' nest - Provoke trouble.

E.g.- When the politician made that controversial statement, he unknowingly stirred up a hornets' nest and faced severe criticism from the public and media.

Sol.576.(d) Taking a bull by the horns - to deal with a difficult situation in a very direct or confident way.

E.g.- He faced his problems by taking a bull by the horns.

Sol.577.(c) A perfect storm - the worst possible situation.

E.g.- The shortage of ingredients and a busy evening rush in the restaurant kitchen created a perfect storm of chaos.

Sol.578.(b) As dead as a doornail - Completely obsolete.

Sol.579.(b) Caught a tartar - more powerful than expected.

Sol.580.(d) Hit the jackpot - Gaining a big success

E.g.- Sarah couldn't believe her luck when she hit the jackpot at the casino and won

a huge sum of money.

Sol.581.(b) Take it with a grain of salt - Not to take things seriously

Sol.582.(c) To weather the storm - To deal with a difficult situation without being harmed.

Sol.583.(c) speaks his mind - to express thoughts, opinions, or feelings openly and honestly

Sol.584.(c) Pass the buck - blaming another person.

E.g.- During the game, when the team lost, he passed the buck to the referee.

Sol.585.(b) Chewing the cud - to think slowly and carefully about something.

Sol.586.(d) At cross purposes - Disagreeing with each other's ideas

E.g. - Their conversation seemed confusing as they were communicating at cross purposes.

Sol.587.(b) a pipe dream - an unreal hope

Sol.588.(b) by the ear - by improvisation

Sol.589.(d) You snooze, you lose - If you are not alert, you are likely to miss opportunities

E.g. - She missed out on the special discount because she didn't make a decision quickly. You snooze, you lose!

Sol.590.(c) Gets on my nerves - Irritates me

Sol.591.(d) Familiarity breeds contempt - the better you know someone the less you like him.

Sol.592.(c) To pour cold water on - To be critical or doubtful of a plan that someone is excited about

Sol.593.(d) First and foremost - highest priority.

Sol.594.(a) Get up on the wrong side of the bed - Someone who is having a horrible day.

E.g.- He seems annoyed today. Maybe he got up on the wrong side of the bed.

Sol.595.(a) comparing apples to oranges - comparing two things that cannot be compared.

Sol.596.(c) The doctor who used illegal methods to conduct experiments on humans must die a shameful death.

The idiom 'Die a dog's death' means to die a shameful, dishonorable, or miserable death. Going through the options, the sentence given in option (c)

has the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.

Sol.597.(c) I don't buy it - I am not convinced.

E.g.- You may think so, but I don't buy it.

Sol.598.(d)

Pull yourself together - calm down.

E.g.- Even though she was upset, she pulled herself together before facing the difficult situation.

Sol.599.(a) Easier said than done - Not as easy as it appears to be.

Sol.600.(d) To show a clean pair of heels- to run fast

E.g.- The clever fox showed a clean pair of heels to the pursuing hounds.

Sol.601.(d) Hold good - Remain valid

Sol.602.(a) Opened a Pandora's box - uncovered more problems.

Sol.603.(b)

Through the grapevine - Via gossip.

E.g.- News about the party spread through the grapevine.

Sol.604.(d) Ruffle someone's feathers - make someone annoyed.

E.g.- His criticism of her work really ruffled her feathers.

Sol.605.(d) Learn to keep quiet - To hold his tongue.

Sol.606.(d) Keep a lid on - control the level of something in order to stop it increasing.

Sol.607.(d) by word of mouth - in spoken form

Sol.608.(c) springs to mind - dawns on

Sol.609.(c) keep him posted - keep sharing the latest information

Sol.610.(d) A blind spot - An area in your range of vision that you cannot see properly.

E.g.- He was a great scientist, but he had his blind spots.

Sol.611.(a) Get down to brass tacks - To become serious about something.

E.g. - After a long and general discussion, let's get down to brass tacks and decide on a budget for the project.

Sol.612.(a) A bed of nails - A problematic or uncomfortable situation.

E.g. - Life is a bed of nails for street children in India.

Sol.613.(d) To have an itching palm - To be greedy for money

E.g. - He was known for having an itching palm, always eager to receive bribes and take advantage of his position of power.

Sol.614.(a)

Out of the woods - Out of danger

E.g. - After months of financial struggle, Sarah finally got a new job that paid well, and she was thrilled to be out of the woods and on the path to financial stability.

Sol.615.(d) Buy a lemon - To buy something that is worthless

E.g. - We often try to save money by buying second-hand cars but little do we realise that we are up to buy a lemon.

Sol.616.(c) One swallow does not make a summer- A single fortunate event does not mean that what follows will also be good.

Sol.617.(a) To meet one's eyes- To look at someone directly while they are looking at you

E.g.- I tried to avoid meeting his eye.

Sol.618.(c) A blast from the past - Something powerfully nostalgic

E.g.- The class tenth photograph was a blast from the past.

Sol.619.(d) Against the clock - Rushed and short on time.

E.g.- We are working against the clock to finish the report by Friday.

Sol.620.(b) In the groove - Starting to perform very well

E.g. - After a few warm-up songs, the band finally found their rhythm and got in the groove, delivering an electrifying performance.

Sol.621.(c)

Walk on air - To be extremely happy

E.g. - The boys are walking on air because their team won the game.

Sol.622.(c) Wet behind the ears - To be young and without experience

E.g. - He's just finished high school, so he's still wet behind the ears.

Sol.623.(b) A dead duck - Totally useless

Sol.624.(d) To pull the trigger - To commit a course of action

E.g. - After months of deliberation, she finally decided to pull the trigger and start her own business.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp)

Questions (625 to 715)

Q.625. On the job

(a) In the war

(b) Avoiding the work

(c) Working at a particular job

(d) On the contrary

Q.626. The life and soul of the party

(a) The only person who dances in the party

(b) Chief guest of the party

(c) A person who brings lots of gifts

(d) Person who brings lots of energy to the party

Q.627. Select the most appropriate meaning of the bracketed idiom in the given sentence.

Later, Brooks' brother alleged that racism helped put the **(pedal to the metal)**.

(a) Very excessive

(b) To go full speed, especially while driving a vehicle

(c) To enjoy yourself by going out

(d) Avoid responsibility by giving it to someone else

Q.628. Select the most appropriate meaning of the bracketed idiom in the given sentence.

After repeated failures and disappointments he was tempted **(to throw up the sponge)**, but continued perseverance finally brought success.

(a) To catch somebody off guard

(b) To surrender or give up the contest

(c) To reveal secret information

(d) To be afraid

Q.629. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct Idiom for the bracketed text.

Susie **(has such strong resemblance to)** Kate Winslet that sometimes people would ask her for her autograph.

(a) dead ringer

(b) gone bananas

(c) jack of all trades

(d) pound the pavement

Q.630. Go down like a lead balloon

(a) To be received badly by an audience

(b) Put yourself in a tough position in order to support someone / something

(c) Surrender peacefully

(d) To gamble everything you have

Q.631. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

I'm sorry I snapped at you earlier, I think I **(am just in a bad mood today)**.

(a) two wrongs don't make right

(b) clam up

(c) dressed to the nines

(d) got up on the wrong side of the bed

Q.632. It takes two to tango

- (a) Two people are required for a couple dance
- (b) To fight fiercely
- (c) For an argument both parties are equally responsible
- (d) An interesting idea

Q.633. To scratch one's head

- (a) To think hard in a puzzled way
- (b) To think about good days
- (c) To come up with an idea
- (d) To lose all the wealth

Q.634. Dead men's shoes

- (a) Making oneself available for all the tasks being assigned
- (b) A career where a lot of cheques are signed
- (c) Job that one takes over from somebody who has left unexpectedly or died
- (d) Acquiring the wealth of a dead man through malpractices

Q.635. To stretch one's legs

- (a) To leave a place without permission
- (b) To go for a party
- (c) To go for a walk after you have been sitting for a long time
- (d) To measure one's worth

Q.636. Drastic times call for drastic measures

- (a) When you are extremely desperate you need to take extremely desperate actions
- (b) Don't rely on it until you are sure of it
- (c) Something that ends at the last minute or last few seconds
- (d) Do not pull all your resources in one possibility

Q.637. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

Although Shagan was competently doing the project on her own, Pranav couldn't stop himself from **(giving her unnecessary advice)**

- (a) being a backseat driver
- (b) devil's advocate
- (c) a bitter pill to swallow
- (d) cutting the mustard

Q.638. To fly into a rage

- (a) To harm oneself
- (b) To get very angry
- (c) To make inappropriate gestures
- (d) To be very excited

Q.639. Between a rock and a hard place

- (a) Stuck between two very bad options
- (b) Willing to do anything
- (c) On the point of achievement
- (d) Avoiding the main topic, not speaking directly about the issue

Q.640. To mind one's P's and Q's

- (a) To write English alphabets accurately
- (b) To supervise something carefully
- (c) To be polite and careful in one's behaviour and speech
- (d) To make amends after a fight

Q.641. Rolling in cash

- (a) Have a large quantity of money
- (b) A business magnate
- (c) Buying things on interest
- (d) To borrow a costly attire

Q.642. Queer somebody's pitch

- (a) A secret plan
- (b) Upset someone's plans
- (c) To make an exaggerated statement
- (d) To come out successfully

Q.643. To go a long way

- (a) To become successful in life
- (b) To join a foreign company
- (c) To avoid short cuts
- (d) To go on a long drive

Q.644. In ones and twos

- (a) In small numbers
- (b) By unfair means
- (c) Large margin
- (d) To count resources

Q.645. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

He **(made an irreversible change, that will greatly impact his life)** when he got that huge tattoo on his back!

- (a) beat the dead horse
- (b) became the devil's advocate
- (c) crossed the Rubicon
- (d) put a rose on his nose

Q.646. Ethnic Cleansing

- (a) Worshiping of a certain ethnic or religious group on a massive scale
- (b) Killing of a certain ethnic or religious group on a massive scale
- (c) One who was previously unknown and is now prominent
- (d) A large number of people either falling ill or dying

Q.647. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

Don't start to think we've **(won this game certainly)**, gentlemen.

- (a) swallowed the bitter truth
- (b) held our horses
- (c) have skin in the game
- (d) got this game in the bag

Q.648. Fixed in one's ways

- (a) Something that shows potential or

- looks promising in the beginning but fails to deliver anything in the end
- (b) To establish one's rule
- (c) Not willing or wanting to change from your normal way of doing something
- (d) An aggressive attack on someone by a group

Q.649. Cold fish

- (a) A person lacking in sympathy
- (b) To make a lot of money
- (c) A dead body
- (d) To retract one's statements

Q.650. Go bananas

- (a) To become excited or angry
- (b) To win a match
- (c) To finish household chores
- (d) To feel low

Q.651. To pull your weight

- (a) To do your full share of work
- (b) To help one's relatives
- (c) To buy something
- (d) To give something

Q.652. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

They were really **(selecting from the last or worst of the resources left)** when they picked you.

- (a) scraping the bottom of the barrel
- (b) rolling the stones
- (c) pulling up snakes
- (d) going haywire

Q.653. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

Mom said these instructions are **(not understood by her)** and that we should show them to Dad.

- (a) Greek to her
- (b) smart cookie to her
- (c) pound the investment to her
- (d) full of beans to her

Q.654. Be at a crossroads

- (a) To have taken the wrong road
- (b) To be confused
- (c) To make a very important decision
- (d) To have forgotten the way

Q.655. To pick holes in someone's coat

- (a) To discharge one's duty well
- (b) To deceive someone for personal gain
- (c) To aspire for something difficult
- (d) To find fault with someone

Q.656. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

That's just like Julie - always **(coming to conclusions too quickly)** even before she knows the facts.

- (a) jumping in with both feet
- (b) raring to go
- (c) sailing in the same boat
- (d) biting her own tongue

Q.657. Rust bucket

- (a) To be absent minded
- (b) An old man
- (c) A vehicle that is old or almost broken
- (d) To be late for everything

Q.658. Hit the hay

- (a) To go to bed
- (b) To buy or sell something
- (c) To take revenge
- (d) A sarcastic response

Q.659. Select the most appropriate meaning of the bracketed idiom in the given sentence.

Let the bully have **(a taste of his own medicine)**.

- (a) A dangerous person pretending harmless
- (b) A result that is still unclear and can go either way
- (c) When you are mistreated the same way you mistreat others
- (d) A visual presentation is far more descriptive than words

Q.660. A broth of a boy

- (a) Not attached to someone
- (b) To have specific food choices
- (c) To behave foolishly
- (d) A lively, energetic young person

Q.661. The statement below has been given with bracketed text. Select the option with correct idiom for the bracketed text.

She started repaying the money she borrowed from me, but the amount she returned me is **(insignificant compared)** to what she still owes.

- (a) eat out of your hand
- (b) jaw dropping
- (c) an eye for an eye
- (d) a drop in a bucket

Q.662. Long in the tooth

- (a) The show has come to an end
- (b) Be optimistic, even difficult times will lead to better days
- (c) To be old, often too old to do something
- (d) Killing of a certain ethnic or religious group on a massive scale

Q.663. A shot in the dark.

- (a) Shooting in the night
- (b) Randomly doing something, the outcome of which is unknown

- (c) Abind man's cane
- (d) Looking at the stars

Q.664. A Bull market

- (a) A fertile field
- (b) A market where cattle is traded
- (c) To boast
- (d) Market where prices are rising

Q.665. To shake in one's shoes

- (a) To be afraid
- (b) To leave no remark
- (c) An unpleasant scenario
- (d) To fail to understand

Q.666. Slack off

- (a) To understand a hidden meaning
- (b) To ease pressure on something
- (c) To make most effort
- (d) To be very rude

Q.667. Pig in a poke

- (a) To bring something to an end
- (b) A brave man amongst all the cowards
- (c) Something that is bought without examining properly
- (d) To obstruct someone's work

Q.668. For old time's sake

- (a) To consider the options
- (b) Deliberately stop someone
- (c) To be friends with an old person
- (d) Because of sentimental memories of the past

Q.669. Water under the bridge

- (a) To be very sick
- (b) Anything from the past that isn't significant or important anymore.
- (c) A paranormal sense that allows you to communicate with the dead.
- (d) someone else who takes the blame.

Q.670. To twiddle one's thumbs

- (a) To be idle
- (b) To play safe
- (c) To waste one's resources
- (d) To show no mercy

Q.671. To sleep like a dog

- (a) To be less mindful
- (b) To be insomniac
- (c) To sleep soundly
- (d) To make noise while sleeping

Q.672. Apropos of nothing

- (a) Any difficult situation or obstacle
- (b) To be enraged
- (c) Almost everything and anything has been included
- (d) Having no relevance to any previous discussion or situation

Q.673. Neck of the woods

- (a) Neighbourhood
- (b) Barren land
- (c) Valley
- (d) Highways

Q.674. Zero tolerance

- (a) To detect someone in the group is betraying the others
- (b) Riding in the front passenger seat of a car
- (c) To escape and not have to pay
- (d) A policy of not allowing any violations of a rule or law

Q.675. To bridge the gap

- (a) To reduce differences and reconcile
- (b) To push people apart
- (c) To mend a broken bridge
- (d) To slander someone

Q.676. High and dry

- (a) Abandoned
- (b) Occasionally
- (c) Perplexed
- (d) Failed

Q.677. The whole ball of wax

- (a) Everything
- (b) Sagacious
- (c) Meagre
- (d) Complete disaster

Q.678. Method to my madness

- (a) Someone who is unpredictable and can cause damage if not kept in check.
- (b) To get someone drunk.
- (c) To state a fact so that there are no doubts or objections.
- (d) Strange or crazy actions that appear meaningless but in the end are done for a good reason.

Q.679. To lay someone by the heels

- (a) To confine somebody in prison
- (b) To gain support
- (c) To praise someone
- (d) To force someone for something

Q.680. Have people rolling in the aisles

- (a) To use false promises to pull people on one's side
- (b) Make an audience laugh uncontrollably
- (c) To have a dispute with someone
- (d) Willing to do something immediately

Q.681. To breast the tape

- (a) To shut someone's mouth
- (b) To create problems
- (c) To bring joy
- (d) To win a race

Q.682. Good grief

- (a) To dig a hole
- (b) To be very systematic
- (c) To try everything possible
- (d) An expression of surprise or Frustration

Q.683. To jump out of one's skin

- (a) To argue with someone
- (b) To feel immense pain
- (c) To show one's real side
- (d) To be extremely surprised

Q.684. Penny wise and pound foolish

- (a) Careless with large amounts, but not small

- (b) To act like a fool
 (c) An intelligent person who behaves foolishly
 (d) Dissipating money without caring about consequences

Q.685. Appeal to Caesar

- (a) An authority given to a foolish person
 (b) To expect good from a wrong person
 (c) To live in a false reality
 (d) Appeal to the highest possible Authority

Q.686. A bite at the cherry

- (a) A wrong move
 (b) An attempt or opportunity to do something
 (c) To have a leverage over someone
 (d) A dog bite

Q.687. Save your breath

- (a) To make an effort that will be futile
 (b) To hold one's anger
 (c) To work hard
 (d) To be resentful

Q.688. A beast of burden

- (a) A liability
 (b) An animal that carries luggage
 (c) A person who works hardly
 (d) A violent man

Q.689. Cast someone adrift

- (a) To leave someone without any support or purpose
 (b) To change plan suddenly
 (c) Call someone repeatedly
 (d) To blame someone for One's mistakes

Q.690. To take the veil

- (a) To help someone
 (b) To become a nun
 (c) To take a responsibility
 (d) To show interest

Q.691. To the manner born

- (a) To have high manners
 (b) To do something as though it is coming naturally
 (c) To be sophisticated
 (d) To give a ride to someone

Q.692. Be my guest

- (a) Please do it (b) Stop, don't go ahead
 (c) Be with me (d) Come with me

Q.693. To have a nodding acquaintance

- (a) To have a great experience
 (b) To neglect all the parameters
 (c) Know somebody/something slightly
 (d) To have nothing in common

Q.694. The whys and wherefores

- (a) References (b) Circumstances
 (c) Requirements (d) Reasons

Q.695. The team members seem to be**running around in circles.**

- (a) To be extremely successful
 (b) Hardly any time to breathe
 (c) To be very active but with few results
 (d) Very dynamic and hardworking

Q.696. Achilles' Heel

- (a) Irrelevant thing (b) Vulnerable point
 (c) Fast runner (d) Costly item

Q.697. In weal and woe

- (a) In sad and gloomy days
 (b) In happiness and good times
 (c) In prosperity and adversity
 (d) In despair and failure

Q.698. He was murdered in cold blood.

- (a) in cold weather
 (b) deliberately
 (c) when blood was cold
 (d) regretfully

Q.699. A skeleton in the cupboard

- (a) A popular fact which is not hidden
 (b) A popular fact to be kept secret
 (c) An embarrassing fact not to be kept secret
 (d) An embarrassing fact to be kept secret

Q.700. Fly into a passion

- (a) To be aggressive at times
 (b) To become aggressive often
 (c) To become angry suddenly
 (d) To be always angry

Q.701. Mr. Raghav racked his brain, but couldn't think where he had left the book.

- (a) thought very hard
 (b) had a series of consecutive thoughts
 (c) knew it, but couldn't quite remember it
 (d) thought he had heard something before

Q.702. By the end of the football match, feelings had reached fever pitch.

- (a) in or to many places
 (b) to get so strong that one cannot control them
 (c) be extremely serious and worrying
 (d) start well

Q.703. Cut a poor figure

- (a) In a poor state
 (b) To put a good impression
 (c) To put a bad impression
 (d) Bad physical form

Q.704. "Just add a bit of cheese to your pasta and Bob's your uncle!" Reena suggested to me over dinner last night.

- (a) It becomes easily and quickly achievable
 (b) It changes the appearance
 (c) It ruins everything

(d) It changes nothing

Q.705. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the italicised words in the given sentence.

He was sacked from his job because of a **grave error** on his part.

- (a) raining cats and dogs
 (b) minding one's p's and q's
 (c) picking holes in one's cot
 (d) Himalayan blunder

Q.706. The announcement of the new tourism policy of the government has made some people **excited or interested**.

- (a) Pull out all the stops
 (b) Run around in circles
 (c) Quicken the pulse
 (d) Reach for the moon

Q.707. Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the italicised words in the given sentence.

Some people still feel that they have very **little freedom** to be innovative in their work.

- (a) elbow room
 (b) an old lady
 (c) an old head on young shoulders
 (d) to make a pile

Q.708. When the war breaks out, all the war mongering social media activists become **yellow bellies**.

- (a) Zealots (b) Cowards
 (c) Sceptics (d) Upset stomachs

Q.709. A rolling stone gathers no moss

- (a) A person who settles for a short time and runs from place to place, enjoying his freedom
 (b) A person who does not settle anywhere for a short time, and is always searching for gold
 (c) A person who settles for a long time and leads a boring and useless Life
 (d) A person who does not settle in one place for a long time, does not gain wealth, name or fame

Q.710. Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.

The great director Satyajit Ray after receiving the Honorary Academic Award from Audrey Hepburn, _____ in his Kolkata home.

- (a) breathed his last
 (b) nipped in the bud
 (c) kept the ball rolling
 (d) dug the grave

Q.711. Take something at face value

- (a) Accept something as it looks without thinking about whether it might, in fact, not be quite what it

- appears
 (b) According to the appearance of something
 (c) Not laugh or change your expression even though you want to laugh
 (d) Show that you do not like something by making an unpleasant expression

Q.712. Cudgel one's brain

- (a) Thinking about a debate
 (b) To think hard
 (c) Not to think
 (d) To overthink

Q.713. Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.

One has to be persistent in studies if he/she wants to get his/her dream job. Success will remain unattainable if one studies _____.

- (a) root and branch (b) the three R's
 (c) in ups and downs (d) by fits and starts

Q.714. I bought some extra copies from the stationery shop. These may **come in handy** during exams.

- (a) Be useful (b) Cause trouble
 (c) Be sold (d) Bring luck

Q.715. Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.

One has to _____ the risks associated with global warming.

- (a) cook in mind (b) bear in mind
 (c) take in mind (d) break in mind

Solutions :-

Sol.625.(c) On the job - Working at a particular job

E.g. - The new programme offers on - the - job training with vocational qualifications.

Sol.626.(d) The life and soul of the party

- Person who brings lots of energy to the party

E.g. - Sarah was always the life and soul of the party, captivating everyone with her infectious laughter and entertaining stories.

Sol.627.(b) Pedal to the metal - To go full speed, especially while driving a vehicle.

E.g. - You are running late. You are going to miss the plane unless you put pedal to the metal.

Sol.628.(b) To throw up the sponge - To surrender or give up the contest

E.g. - After struggling through multiple rounds, the boxer finally threw up the sponge, admitting defeat to his formidable opponent.

Sol.629.(a) Dead ringer - someone having strong resemblance to someone else.

Sol.630.(a) Go down like a lead balloon -

To be received badly by an audience

E.g. - Despite his excitement, his new invention went down like a lead balloon when the public showed little interest in it.

Sol.631.(d) got up on the wrong side of the bed - in a bad mood

Sol.632.(c) It takes two to tango - For an argument both parties are equally responsible

E.g. - The disagreement escalated because they failed to realize it takes two to tango.

Sol.633.(a) To scratch one's head - To think hard in a puzzled way

E.g. - The riddle was so challenging that it made him scratch his head in confusion.

Sol.634.(c) Dead men's shoes - Job that one takes over from somebody who has left unexpectedly or died

E.g- He advanced quickly in his career thanks to dead men's shoes.

Sol.635.(c) To stretch one's leg - To go for a walk after you have been sitting for a long time.

E.g.- After sitting for hours, I decided to stretch my leg.

Sol.636.(a) Drastic times call for drastic measures - When you are extremely desperate you need to take extremely desperate actions.

E.g.- When faced with a major crisis, it is essential to remember that drastic times call for drastic measures.

Sol.637.(a) being a backseat driver - giving someone unnecessary advice

Sol.638.(b)

To fly into a rage - To get very angry.

E.g.- When I told her I accidentally broke her favorite mug, she flew into a rage.

Sol.639.(a) Between a rock and a hard place - Stuck between two very bad options

E.g.- He was stuck between a rock and a hard place, having to choose between betraying his friend or breaking the law.

Sol.640.(c) To mind one's P's and Q's - To be polite and careful in one's behavior and speech

E.g. - Tom's good manners impressed everyone. He minded his P's and Q's by being polite and respectful.

Sol.641.(a) Rolling in cash - Have a large quantity of money.

E.g. - Ever since she won the lottery, she's been rolling in cash, enjoying a life of luxury and extravagance.

Sol.642.(b) Queer somebody's pitch - Upset someone's plans

E.g. - The unexpected arrival of a new competitor completely queered the established company's pitch in the market.

Sol.643.(a) To go a long way - To become successful in life

E.g. - Maintaining a positive mindset can go a long way in achieving success and fulfillment in life.

Sol.644.(a)

In ones and twos - in small numbers.

E.g.-The children entered the amusement park in ones and twos, eagerly anticipating the day of fun ahead.

Sol.645.(c) crossed the Rubicon - made an irreversible change, that will greatly impact his life

Sol.646.(b) Ethnic Cleansing - Killing of a certain ethnic or religious group on a massive scale.

E.g.- During the conflict, the region witnessed the horrifying act of ethnic cleansing, with countless innocent lives lost.

Sol.647.(d) Got this game in the bag - Won this game certainly

Sol.648.(c) Fixed in one's ways - Not willing or wanting to change from your normal way of doing something.

E.g. - He is fixed in his ways. He always follows the same procedure in order to complete the projects.

Sol.649.(a) Cold fish - A person lacking in sympathy

E.g. - Ashish is a cold fish because he barely helps anyone in pain.

Sol.650.(a) Go bananas - to become excited or angry

E.g.- She'll go bananas when you tell her the news.

Sol.651.(a) To pull your weight - to do your full share of work

E.g.- In group projects, everyone must pull their weight and contribute equally for success.

Sol.652.(a) Scraping the bottom of the barrel - selecting from the last or worst of the resources left.

E.g.- They had to scrape the bottom of

the barrel to find someone willing to do the job.

Sol.653.(a) Greek to her - not understood by her .

Sol.654.(c) Be at a crossroads - To make a very important decision
E.g. - After completing her education, she found herself at a crossroads, unsure of which career path to pursue.

Sol.655.(d) To pick holes in someone's coat - to find fault with someone.
E.g.- She constantly finds faults in his work, no matter how much effort he puts in.

Sol.656.(a) jumping in with both feet - coming to conclusions too quickly

Sol.657.(c) Rust bucket - A vehicle that is old or almost broken
E.g. - I couldn't believe my eyes when I saw him driving that old rust bucket of a car.

Sol.658.(a) Hit the hay - To go to bed
E.g. - After a long day at work, I was exhausted and decided to hit the hay early.

Sol.659.(c) A taste of his own medicine - when you are mistreated the same way you mistreat others

Sol.660.(d) A broth of a boy - a lively, energetic young person.
E.g.- He's a broth of a boy, always full of energy and mischief.

Sol.661.(d) A drop in a bucket - insignificant compared to the required amount.

Sol.662.(c) Long in the tooth - To be old, often too old to do something.
E.g.- She's still a great dancer, but she's getting a little long in the tooth.

Sol.663.(b) A shot in the dark - Randomly doing something, the outcome of which is unknown.

E.g.- Ram took a shot in the dark when teacher asked him for trigonometric formulas.

Sol.664.(d) A Bull market - Market where prices are rising
E.g. - From April 2003 to January 2008, the Bombay Stock Exchange Index in India was in a bull market trend, rising from 2,900 points to 21,000 points.

Sol.665.(a) To shake in one's shoes - To be afraid
E.g. Harry was shaking in his shoes when he saw the ghost.

Sol.666.(b) Slack off - to ease pressure on something.
E.g.- Do not slack off in your studies.

Sol.667.(c) Pig in a poke - Something that is bought without examining properly
E.g.- Be careful about buying that old car. It might turn out to be a pig in a poke.

Sol.668.(d) For old time's sake - Because of sentimental memories of the past
E.g.- Let's go back to village for old time's sake.

Sol.669.(b) Water under the bridge - Anything from the past that isn't significant or important anymore.
Yes, we did have our disagreements, but that's water under the bridge.

Sol.670.(a) To twiddle one's thumbs - To be idle.
E.g. I arrived early for the meeting so I was twiddling my thumbs for half an hour.

Sol.671.(c) To sleep like a dog - To sleep soundly
E.g. He slept like a dog, sixteen hours a day, rising to eat and smoke, and then falling back in his bunk, where he coiled himself very much like a hibernating bear.

Sol.672.(d) Apropos of nothing - Having no relevance to any previous discussion or situation.
E.g. So, apropos of nothing, I need to ask you about one last thing.

Sol.673.(a) Neck of the woods - Neighbourhood
E.g - I haven't been in this neck of the woods for years.

Sol.674.(d) Zero tolerance - A policy of not allowing any violations of a rule or law
E.g. I need zero tolerance in the recruitment process.

Sol.675.(a) To bridge the gap - To reduce differences and reconcile
E.g. The idea was to bridge the gap between citizens and the Union's institutions.

Sol.676.(a) High and dry - Abandoned
E.g - They pulled out of the deal at the last minute leaving us high and dry.

Sol.677.(a) The whole ball of wax - everything related to a particular situation; the whole thing.
E.g - He came back from Chicago with the contract for the whole ball of wax.

Sol.678.(d) Method to my madness - Strange or crazy actions that appear meaningless but in the end are done for a good reason.
E.g. He keeps talking to himself loudly, but he insists there is a method in his madness.

Sol.679.(a) To lay someone by the heels - To confine somebody in prison.
E.g. Superior forces laid the invaders by the heels.

Sol.680.(b) Have people rolling in the aisles - Make an audience laugh uncontrollably.
E.g. The comedian made the audience rolling in the aisles.

Sol.681.(d) To breast the tape - To win a race
E.g.- Goutam is able to sprint ahead and breast the tape.

Sol.682.(d) Good grief - An expression of surprise or frustration
E.g. Oh God, good grief we are again stuck in a traffic jam.

Sol.683.(d) To jump out of one's skin - To be extremely surprised
E.g. My friends made me jump out of my skin on my birthday.

Sol.684.(a) Penny wise and pound foolish - Careless with large amounts, but not small.
E.g- someone who will drive across town to save five cents a gallon on gasoline but just recently purchased a BMW that he or she cannot afford could be said to be "penny wise and pound foolish."

Sol.685.(d) Appeal to Caesar - Appeal to the highest possible authority
E.g. Paul appealed to Caesar for justice.

Sol.686.(b) A bite at the cherry - An attempt or opportunity to do something.
E.g. I got a bite at the cherry after my first attempt at the task.

Sol.687.(a) Save your breath -To make an effort that will be futile
E.g. If you tell someone to save their breath, you mean that they should not bother saying something, because you will not agree to it or you do not want to hear it.

Sol.688.(b) A beast of burden - An animal that carries luggage
E.g. One beast of burden is not enough to pull the cart. Get another one.

Sol.689.(a) Cast someone adrift - To leave someone without any support or purpose

E.g. His parents cut her adrift after they found drugs in his room.

Sol.690.(b)

To take the veil - To become a nun

E.g. The young woman took the veil after her fiancé died.

Sol.691.(b) To the manner born - To do something as though it is coming naturally

E.g. She took to her new life as to the manner born.

Sol.692.(a) Be my guest - Please do it

E.g. Do you mind if I use your phone? sure, be my guest.

Sol.693.(c)

To have a nodding acquaintance - Know somebody / something slightly

E.g. I have a nodding acquaintance with Jack's novels.

Sol.694.(d)

The whys and wherefores - Reasons

E.g. She explained the whys and the wherefores of the sudden price increase.

Sol.695.(c) Running around in circles - to be very active but with few results.

Sol.696.(5)

Achilles' Heel - vulnerable point.

E.g. Varun is trying to cut the body fat but desert is his Achilles' Heel.

Sol.697.(c) In weal and woe - in prosperity and adversity

E.g. Rahul is my best friend, I can count on him to be there in weal and woe.

Sol.698.(b) In cold blood - deliberately.

Sol.699.(d) A skeleton in the cupboard - an embarrassing fact to be kept secret.

E.g. On accepting the job, Rahul assured his employers that he had no skeletons in the cupboard.

Sol.700.(c) Fly into a passion - to become angry suddenly.

E.g. The political leader flew into a passion on being asked about the scam.

Sol.701.(a) thought very hard.

'Racked his brain' is a phrase that means to think very hard. The given sentence states that Mr. Raghav thought very hard, but couldn't think where he had left the book. Hence, 'thought very hard' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.702.(b) to get so strong that one cannot control them

'Fever pitch' is a phrase that means a state of extreme excitement. The given sentence states that by the end of the

football match, feelings had reached a state of extreme excitement. Hence, 'fever pitch' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.703.(c) Cut a poor figure - to put a bad impression.

E.g. I cut a poor figure in my last show as it was an extempore.

Sol.704.(a) Bob's your uncle - it becomes easily and quickly achievable.

Sol.705.(d) Himalayan blunder - a very serious mistake or error, grave error.

Sol.706.(c) 'Quicken the pulse' is a phrase that means excited or interested.

Sol.707.(a) Elbow room - little freedom.

Sol.708.(b) Yellow bellies - cowards.

E.g. George is a yellow-bellied guy, don't send him on such a tough assignment.

Sol.709.(d) A rolling stone gathers no moss - a person who does not settle in one place for a long time, does not gain wealth, name or fame.

Sol.710.(a) breathed his last.

'Breathed his last' means to die. The given sentence states that the great director Satyajit Ray after receiving the Honorary Academic Award from Audrey Hepburn, died in his Kolkata home. Hence, 'breathed his last' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.711.(a) Take something at face value - accept something as it looks without thinking about whether it might, in fact, not be quite what it appears.

E.g. Udit seems very sweet but be careful of taking people at face value.

Sol.712.(b)

Cudgel one's brain - to think hard.

E.g. Neha cudgelled her brains, trying to decide what had caused such a problem.

Sol.713.(d) 'By fits and starts' means something happening with irregular intervals of action and inaction. The given sentence states that success will remain unattainable if one studies irregularly. Hence, 'by fits and starts' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.714.(a) Come in handy - be useful.

Sol.715.(b) 'Bear in mind' means to remember a fact or circumstance and take it into account. The given sentence states that one has to take into account the risks associated with global warming. Hence, 'bear in mind' is the most appropriate answer.

eduquity-based pattern (ebp) Questions (716 to 762)

Q.716. Someone's heart is in the right place

- (a) Suddenly feel so excited or frightened that your heart beats faster
- (b) Change your opinion or the way you feel
- (c) Share secret worries with someone else
- (d) Someone is good even if they sometimes behave in a wrong manner

Q.717. Down the tubes

- (a) Minting money
- (b) Failing completely
- (c) Being informal
- (d) Going to swim

Q.718. I begged him to reconsider my application, but he put his foot down.

- (a) stamped his foot down
- (b) agreed to reconsider
- (c) refused to yield
- (d) did not run

Q.719. I must tell you that it all went pear-shaped after you left the meeting in the middle.

- (a) Went terribly wrong
- (b) Became very entertaining
- (c) Became tragic
- (d) Turned out fine

Q.720. Select the idiom from the given options that gives the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted text in the following sentence.

A village fair is **a place that contains many interesting objects**. People of all age groups eagerly wait for this.

- (a) Road to Damascus
- (b) Ivory tower
- (c) Aladdin's cave
- (d) Jewel in the crown

Q.721. They are rivals and cannot work together in harmony.

- (a) Potter about
- (b) Make up
- (c) Put down
- (d) Pull together

Q.722. Belly laugh

- (a) Mocking someone
- (b) Laughing with inhibition
- (c) A loud and unrestrained laugh
- (d) To be subjected to mockery and ridicule

Q.723. The mother-in-law deliberately rained on the new bride's parade when she asked her to change the dress of her



choice.

- (a) Force traditions upon someone
- (b) Make someone tearful out of viciousness
- (c) To spoil a moment
- (d) Save one from embarrassment

Q.724. At the drop of a dime

- (a) A way of saying that you are happy to see someone
- (b) Something that is not popular
- (c) Something that can happen very fast without hesitation
- (d) Extremely easy to understand

Q.725. Snowed under

- (a) Lazy (b) Silent (c) Calm (d) Busy

Q.726. He was beaming from ear to ear.

- (a) Playing (b) Smiling broadly
- (c) Criticising bitterly (d) Working

Q.727. You can ask Mr. Dinakar for anything; he would give you the shirt off his back.

- (a) is willing to do anything to help another person
- (b) is a person who makes the decisions
- (c) is a person who is selfish
- (d) is a person who is arrogant

Q.728. A lot on one's plate

- (a) To eat a lot
- (b) A lot to do
- (c) To have a serious ailment
- (d) To serve all dishes on one plate

Q.729. Ms.Tina could finish the assignment by Friday - at a push, Wednesday.

- (a) try very hard to do something, usually something nice
- (b) probably possible, but it will be difficult
- (c) make more of an effort
- (d) using whatever methods are necessary

Q.730. Select the correct meaning of the idiom in bold and italics.

Our hearts go out to the families of the victims of this terrible tragedy.

- (a) To receive or express praise for a job well done
- (b) To feel sympathy for someone when they are distressed
- (c) Well wishes for a deceased person
- (d) To wish for things does not yield to anything

Q.731. Toffee-nosed

- (a) A person who thinks he is of a high social class and looks down on people of lower class
- (b) A solid, respectable and respected member of society
- (c) Continue to live at the same social standard we have lived at, even

though we have money problems

- (d) A person who seems impolite/of low education at first, but who is usually of good character

Q.732. The evidence put forward could not confirm his guilt.

- (a) Bring up (b) Break down
- (c) Bear up (d) Blow off

Q.733. The family's meeting on property dispute begins today and I'm just sitting down with a cup of coffee, enjoying ____.

- (a) the better of
- (b) the corridors of power
- (c) the calm before the storm
- (d) the bottom line

Q.734. Sometimes doing something that makes it impossible to return to the previous situation later strengthens you.

- (a) Painting the town red
- (b) Knocking your socks off
- (c) Burning your bridges
- (d) A red - letter day

Q.735. Up in the air

- (a) Something that is tossed up in the air
- (b) Something that is certain and decided
- (c) Something that is unknown entirely
- (d) Something that is invisible and unattainable

Q.736. The dacoit was shot from up close by the police officer.

- (a) Milksop (b) Smell a rat
- (c) Point blank (d) Bullet proof

Q.737. Get on like a house on fire

- (a) Like someone immediately
- (b) Get on extremely well with someone
- (c) Feel a lot of affection for one particular person, often without knowing why
- (d) Do something good for someone you have done something bad to in the past

Q.738. So far so good

- (a) Not impressed with how things are
- (b) Things are going well so far
- (c) No improvement in the work being done
- (d) Good things can go far away

Q.739. Hang in there

- (a) To remain unresolved
- (b) To give up completely
- (c) To spend time with people
- (d) To persist in a difficult situation

Q.740. Left, right and centre

- (a) To have been happening for a long time and there is a lot of activity
- (b) Happening in a lot of places or to a

lot of people

- (c) Start well
- (d) The news went from one person to the next

Q.741. To beat a retreat

- (a) To make a situation
- (b) To leave a situation
- (c) To solve a situation
- (d) To face a situation

Q.742. The judgment was rejected by the Chief Justice.

- (a) Seen through (b) Stand out
- (c) Set aside (d) Run in

Q.743. Be hard hit

- (a) An extreme struggle
- (b) To speak something unpleasant
- (c) Severely affected by something unpleasant
- (d) To hit someone hard

Q.744. I took a quick trip to my cousin's house before going on vacation to Africa.

- (a) Break the journey
- (b) Paid a flying visit
- (c) Lived out of a suitcase
- (d) Float one's boat

Q.745. As good as gold

- (a) A person who is obedient and well-behaved
- (b) A person who loves gold
- (c) A person who is good like gold but not better
- (d) A golden person

Q.746. She brought new ideas for the innovative promotion of the product.

- (a) Draw on (b) Swept off
- (c) Came up with (d) Carry off

Q.747. Select the correct meaning of the idiom in bold and italics.

Look, ***the devil is beating his wife***. Do you think we'll see a rainbow?

- (a) One who presents a counter argument
- (b) If you have nothing to do, you are likely to do some mischief
- (c) The sun is shining while it rains
- (d) When someone comes in unexpectedly while being talked about

Q.748. fight shy of

- (a) to invite (b) to avoid
- (c) to challenge (d) to perform

Q.749. clam up

- (a) to be upset (b) to be frustrated
- (c) to become silent (d) to lose temper

Q.750. all in all

- (a) having all authority (b) first in line
- (c) completely lost (d) every person

Q.751. cut a sorry figure

- (a) render an apology
- (b) make a sculpture
- (c) create a poor impression
- (d) break a record

Q.752. All eyes turned to him because he was the only person who could **stave off** the impending war.

- (a) draw (b) invoke
- (c) prevent (d) provoke

Q.753. His grandfather always **laughs like a drain**.

- (a) Laugh bitterly (b) Laugh fearfully
- (c) Laugh silently (d) Laugh loudly

Q.754. In his speech on dowry, he **set forth** his views at length.

- (a) ran (b) started (c) explained (d) hid

Q.755. The rope **gave way** while the workmen were hauling up the iron pillar.

- (a) repressed (b) lulled
- (c) stifled (d) snapped

Q.756. Clear the air

- (a) To deal openly with misunderstandings to get rid of them
- (b) To switch off fans
- (c) To use aroma to sweeten the air
- (d) To reduce pollution

Q.757. Nothing ventured, nothing gained

- (a) Nothing can be gained with ventures
- (b) Doing nothing is the best thing
- (c) One has to make every effort in order to achieve something
- (d) Through hard work one can receive nothing

Q.758. The question **came up** before the Municipal Corporation last week.

- (a) cleared up (b) was raised
- (c) was left (d) departed

Q.759. Chew the scenery

- (a) To understate
- (b) To act overly emotional
- (c) To beautify
- (d) To mismanage

Q.760. To foot the bill

- (a) To reveal a secret (b) To be friendly
- (c) To hold grudges (d) To make payment

Q.761. My elder brother is so innocent that winning an argument against him is like **shooting fish in a barrel**.

- (a) Indulge in an illegal activity
- (b) Exceptionally easy to do
- (c) Asking for charity
- (d) Making someone uneasy

Q.762. Ron added a **feather in his cap** by winning that international tournament.

- (a) To feel well and healthy

- (b) An achievement to be proud of
- (c) To take advantage of one's position
- (d) An expression of extreme annoyance

Solutions :-

Sol.716.(d) Someone's heart is in the right place - someone is good even if they sometimes behave in a wrong manner.

Sol.717.(b)

Down the tubes - failing completely.

E.g.- All the hard work of Tushar for the project went down the tubes.

Sol.718.(c)

Put his foot down - refused to yield.

Sol.719.(a) Went pear shaped - went terribly wrong.

Sol.720.(c) Aladdin's cave - a place filled with a great number and variety of strange or precious items.

Sol.721.(d)

Pull together - work together in harmony.

Sol.722.(c) Belly laugh - A loud and unrestrained laugh

E.g.- His childish joke caused a belly laugh.

Sol.723.(c) Rain on the new bride's parade - To spoil a moment

Sol.724.(c) At the drop of a dime - Something that can happen very fast without hesitation.

E.g.- The game can start at the drop of a dime, you just need to say the word.

Sol.725.(d) Snowed under - Busy

E.g.- Manju is snowed under with work.

Sol.726.(b) Beaming from ear to ear - smiling broadly.

Sol.727.(a) Give you the shirt off his back - is willing to do anything to help another person.

Sol.728.(b) A lot on one's plate - a lot to do.

E.g.- My father works 60 hours a week, and he is taking care of my grandparents, so he always has a lot on his plate.

Sol.729.(b) 'At a push' is an idiom that means something is probably possible, but it will be difficult. The given sentence states that it is probably possible, but it will be difficult for Mrs. Tina to finish the assignment by Wednesday.

Sol.730.(b) Heart go/goes out to - to feel sympathy for someone when they are distressed.

Sol.731.(a) Toffee-nosed - a person who thinks he is of a high social class and looks down on people of lower class.

E.g.- Rahul is a toffee nosed boy as he mistreats his juniors in the college.

Sol.732.(c) 'Bear up' is an idiom that means to support, encourage something. The given sentence states that the evidence put forward does not support his guilt. Hence, 'bear up' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.733.(c) 'The calm before the storm' is a phrase that means a period of unusual tranquillity or stability that seems likely to presage difficult times. The family's meeting on property dispute begins today and I'm just sitting down with a cup of coffee, enjoying the calm before the storm. Hence, 'the calm before the storm' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.734.(c) Burning your bridges - doing something that makes it impossible to return to the previous situation later.

Sol.735.(c) Up in the air - something that is unknown entirely.

E.g.- If Harsh hasn't decided whether or not to give a final attempt for the exam, it's up in the air

Sol.736.(c)

Point blank - shot from up close.

Sol.737.(b) Get on like a house on fire - get on extremely well with someone.

E.g.- I was worried that they wouldn't like each other but in fact they're getting on like a house on fire.

Sol.738.(b) So far so good - things are going well so far.

E.g.- It's been so far, so good with the colleague and I hope it stays that way.

Sol.739.(d) Hang in there - to persist in a difficult situation.

E.g.- We know you're worried, but hang in there the police will find out who did this.

Sol.740.(b) Left, right and centre - happening in a lot of places or to a lot of people.

E.g.- Priyanka has been spending money left, right, and centre.

Sol.741.(b) To beat a retreat - to leave a situation.

E.g.- When the criminals saw the police arriving they beat a hasty retreat.

Sol.742.(c) Set aside - declare a legal decision or process to be invalid.

Sol.743.(c) Be hard hit - severely affected by something unpleasant.

E.g.- The seaside town was hard hit by storms this year

Sol.744.(b)

Paid a flying visit - took a quick trip.

Sol.745.(a) As good as gold - a person who is obedient and well-behaved.

E.g.- Sheila has been as good as gold all morning.

Sol.746.(c) 'Came up with' means to suggest or think of an idea or plan. The given sentence states that she suggested new ideas for the innovative promotion of the product. Hence, 'came up with' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.747.(c) The devil is beating his wife - the sun is shining while it rains.

E.g.- Today, the devil is beating his wife in our city

Sol.748.(b) Fight shy of - to avoid

E.g.- My friends always fight shy of me when I need them the most.

Sol.749.(c) Clam up - to become silent

E.g.- Teenagers should always clam up in a heated argument.

Sol.750.(a) All in all - having all authority

E.g.- He has all in all powers to amend this rule.

Sol.751.(c) Cut a sorry figure - create a poor impression

E.g.- For five years, he took drugs, drank, hosted friends, and cut a sorry figure as a father.

Sol.752.(c) Stave off - prevent or delay something bad or dangerous.

All eyes turned to him because he was the only person who could stave off the impending war.

Sol.753.(d)

Laugh like a drain - Laugh loudly

Sol.754.(c) Set forth - explained

Sol.755.(d) Gave way - snapped or to break

Example - I finally gave way to their pleas and let the kids have ice cream for dinner.

Sol.756.(a)

Clear the air - To deal openly with misunderstandings to get rid of them.

Example - I had a massive argument with Sue, but at least it has cleared the air.

Sol.757.(c) Nothing ventured, nothing gained - One has to make every effort in order to achieve something.

Sol.758.(b) was raised

Come up - raised

Sol.759.(b) Chew the scenery - to act overly emotional.

E.g.- If the group wants to perform a perfect play, the performing actors must not chew the scenery at any moment during the act.

Sol.760.(d) To foot the bill - to make payment.

E.g.- Jay's parents footed the bill for his college education.

Sol.761.(b) Shooting fish in a barrel - exceptionally easy to do.

Sol.762.(b) Added a feather in his cap - an achievement to be proud of.

E.g.- Himesh added a feather in his cap by clearing the UPSC examination.